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FINAL REPORT

Sixteenth Annual Meeting
of the
General Service Conference
of
Alcoholics Anonymous

Roosevelt Hotel, New York City

April 18-23, 1966



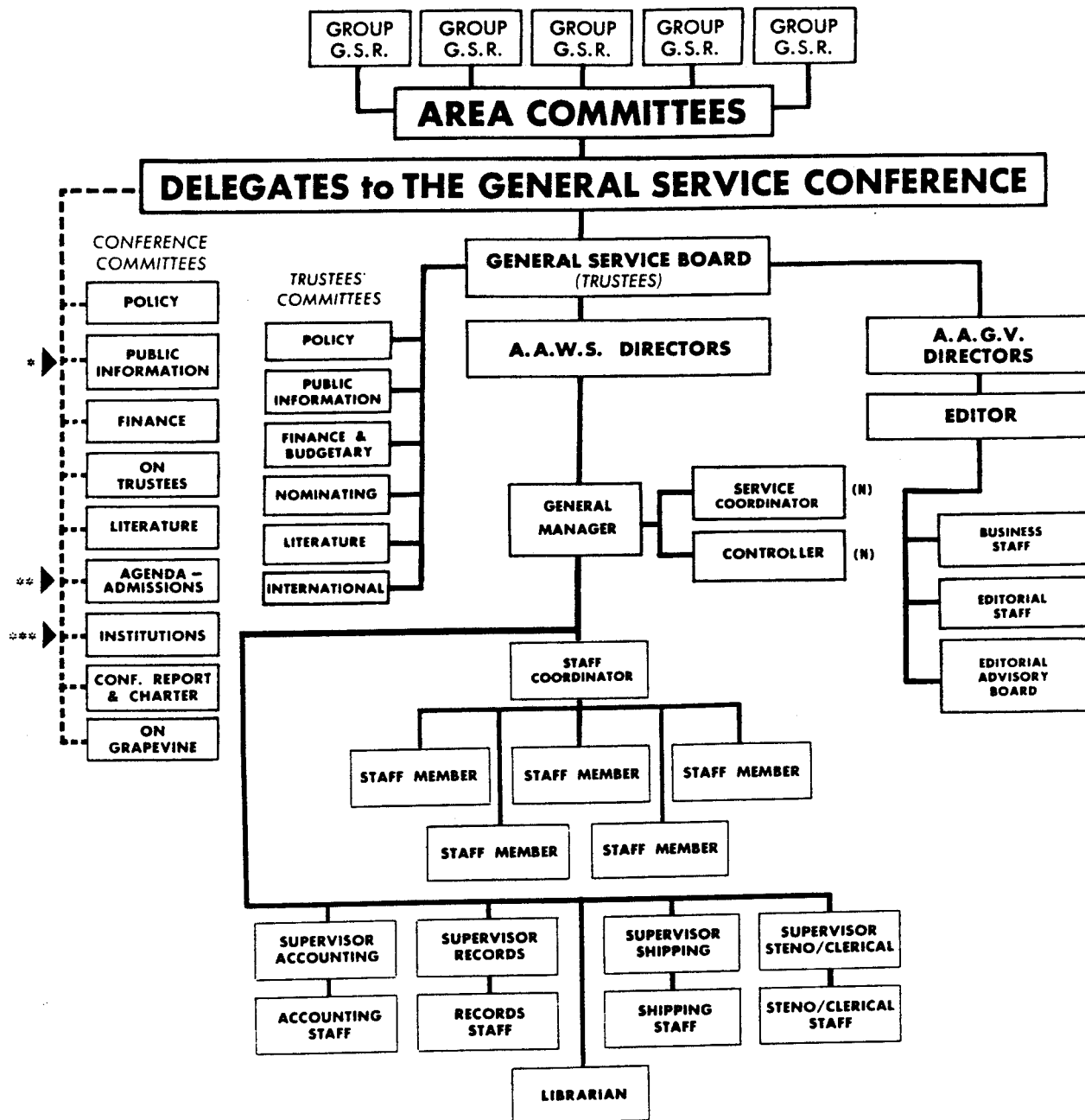
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**Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
P. O. Box 459, Grand Central Station
New York, N. Y. 10017**

STRUCTURE OF THE FELLOWSHIP



* NAME CHANGED BY 1966 CONFERENCE

** COMBINED BY 1966 CONFERENCE

*** CREATED BY 1966 CONFERENCE

(N) ESTABLISHED BY A.A.W.S. IN 1966

1966 FINAL REPORT

Sixteenth Annual Meeting

General Service Conference of A.A.

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Two Themes Guide 16th Conference Actions

Conference Accepts Board Change

Wed., Apr. 20—The General Service Board of A.A. will be changed into a body of 14 A.A. (Class B) and 7 nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees, members of the 16th General Service Conference decided today by accepting a Board re-structure plan.

Putting A.A.'s for the first time in the majority on the Board is historic, because ever since the Board (then called the A.A. Foundation) was first formed in 1938 with five members, nonalcoholics have always been in the majority by one.

The change-over from the present Board alignment (10 nonalcoholics, 9 A.A.'s) to the new one will take effect gradually, according to Dr. John L. Norris, Rochester, N.Y., non-alcoholic Chairman of the Board who presented the new plan at the 1965 meeting. Nonalcoholic trustees on the Board now are not affected by the plan, and trusteeships will change only as there are resignations and retirements.

IN MEMORIAM

We of the 16th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous here assembled do lovingly inscribe upon our annals this testament of our gratitude for the life and works of our departed friends, Dr. Harry M. Tiebout, Sister Mary Ignatia, and Ebby T.

The Conference voted 92 to 24 in favor of the 14-7 ratio, then unanimously recommended eight regional A.A. trustees, six from the U.S., two from Canada. Also, six "General Service" Class B trustees (chosen for business skill) — four from the N.Y.C. area, one from Canada, one from anywhere in the U.S.

Each new Class A trustee will be elected for a three-year term, which may be followed by two successive three-year terms. A.A. members on the Board will continue to serve four years. Any trustee can be elected Chairman of the Board, although this has customarily always been a nonalcoholic. (See also Page 11)

'Principles' and 'Responsibility' Reflected

"The voice of the Fellowship" — the 16th annual meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous at the Hotel Roosevelt, New York City, April 18-23, 1966 — expressed over and over again two A.A. sayings.

The twin ideas of "principles before personalities" (the official Conference theme, from Tradition Twelve) and "I am responsible" (from the 30th Anniversary Declaration) seemed to guide Conference members in all their sessions in behalf of the 31-year-old Fellowship.

All General Service Board members, G.S.O. and Grapevine Staffs, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and 88 elected Area Delegates (42 Panel 15, 46 Panel 16) from U.S. and Canadian Groups form the Conference.

They deliberated, listened, talked, and meditated almost around the clock to take "Advisory Actions," reach decisions, or voice the consensus of the Fellowship on —

G.S. BOARD — Structure changes proposed by the trustees in 1965 were accepted with modification (see story at left).

PREAMBLE — Wording of "no dues or fees" was left unchanged. (See Page 44)

1970 CONVENTION — Miami and Chicago were favored for a 35th anniversary international convention. If Miami proves unacceptable, Seattle will also be considered. (See Page 50)

CLUBS, REHABS — Reaffirmed A.A.'s policy of "cooperation but not affiliation" with such facilities, as spelled out in Tradition Six. (See Page 27)

INSTITUTIONS — Recommended establishment of a Conference Institutions Committee to encourage more feeling that "we are responsible for alcoholics behind walls." (See Page 13)

A.A. IN SMALL COMMUNITIES — Area G.S. Committees can encourage more visits among Groups, public meetings, and contacts with clergy, police and physicians to help Loners become Groups. (See Page 18)

CENTRAL OFFICES — To bring local Intergroups even more into the Third Legacy communications network, a G.S.O. Staff Member will be assigned "Services to Central Offices" and Delegates will work at the local levels. (See Page 24)

LITERATURE — Publication of a hard-cover "reader" of excerpts from Bill W.'s writings was approved, and a "Guide for Leading Beginners' Meetings" is to be issued. (See Page 21)

ATTRACTION — Growth of Public Information work within our Traditions was hailed as good Twelfth Step work. (See P. 45)

ANONYMITY IN A.A. — Regard for others' anonymity is essential; *within* A.A. anonymity (but *not* secrecy) permits life-saving personal relationships and places principles before personalities. (See Page 51)

GRAPEVINE — Continuing improvements in contents, appearance, and circulation were commended. (See Page 32)

DIRECTORY — Reaffirmed it is not for commercial solicitation use, even for so-called "A.A." pins, tokens, etc. (See P. 52)

FINANCING — Value of the Regular Contribution Plan for Group support of world services was reaffirmed. A bequest of not more than \$100 from any A.A. member may be accepted by G.S.O. (See PP. 34 and 39)

NEW A.A. SIZE

Based on reports to G.S.O., Spring 1966

	Groups	Members
United States	7,821	133,786
Canada	1,241	17,180
Overseas	2,136	43,239
In Hospitals	569	10,774
In Prisons	677	26,157
Internationalist . .	—	341
Lone Members . .	—	(628)*
Totals	12,444	232,105

(including "non-reported" members, actual membership is estimated at more than 350,000.)

* These members included in Area totals.

Principles Before Personalities

Bill, Lois, Jim M. and Delegates' Chairman Keynote Opening Sessions

Four fine speakers launched the 16th Conference cleanly into orbit its first day. Bill W., A.A.'s surviving co-founder, his wife Lois ("first lady of Al-Anon"), Frank R., Mass. (Class B Trustee), and Mike P., Oklahoma Delegate, spoke at the "regular A.A. meeting," chaired by Frank C., S.E. New York Delegate, which followed the opening night dinner.

Earlier Jim M., Calif. (Class B Trustee), and Bob P., Newfoundland, Area Delegates' Chairman, had stirred up their hearers. Jim, by popular demand, repeated the questions and answers he used at the 1965 session — essentially, is the Conference the voice of A.A. — or is it a rubber stamp? Why? (See pages 14-16 in the May, 1966, Grapevine.)

Bob, Lois and Bill all stimulated so much thought and imparted so much wisdom about "principles before personalities" that condensed transcriptions of their remarks are presented.

Part of the whole

You are about to witness the pulsating heart of the movement in action. You will be increasingly amazed at the dedication of the Staff, Trustees and Delegates. You will receive masses of paper, and the question will arise, "How am I going to present all this to those back home?" The Greater Power that brought you here will also provide you with intelligence to give a good account of the proceedings you are about to take part in.

How do we feel about this, we might ask ourselves. Do we feel a sense of prestige at being elected to this office? Or do we feel a deep sense of humility, and a genuine desire to serve?

Early in A.A. I had a tremendous experience. I was bursting with ideas which I imparted in an increasing stream of oratory. I honestly thought that I was God's gift to the Group. I received a nasty shock when a member told me unhappily that he had been elected to tell me to "shut up."

After I recovered, I had sense enough to take the problem up with God, as I understand Him.

His answer came into my mind in the form of a parable: "A grain of wheat is insignificant. But a ton of wheat is of great value, as it means food and nourishment to the multitude. Yet important as a ton of wheat is, it could not exist without that tiny insignificant grain. That tiny grain becomes of great importance when it is a part of the whole."

As part of the Group I can be of some importance. I realized that the only true way to serve was not in attempting to be the whole, but in being part of the whole.

This then is our main responsibility, to see how we can become more effective, not as individuals, but as a whole. May we too keep our Second Tradition foremost in our minds, and invoke the help of God in our deliberation.

—Bob P., Newfoundland

Lois: The early days

In the early days of A.A. there was no book or literature and the only way to communicate with other people was to go and tell them. So that's what we did. We were a Fellowship without a name — a nameless bunch of drunks trying to help each other. All of the meetings were held in the homes of those lucky enough to have a home. Anybody that did have one kept it wide open to anybody the boys brought in. Our houses, the Smith's in Akron and ours in Brooklyn, and several in Jersey were always filled with drunks of one sort or another — either still drinking or stopped temporarily or on the way to real sobriety.

Many sad things happened, many very humorous ones, and many inspirational things. Bill, as you know, came from Vermont, and somebody had sent him some maple syrup in a whiskey bottle. One of the boys saw this good looking bottle in the kitchen and he was so drunk at the time that he drank the whole bottle of syrup! We finally made a rule that no one could come into the house when he was drinking. When we wouldn't let one of the boys in, he opened the coal chute and got into the cellar. He was quite fat but somehow he made it. This same fat man one night tried to take a bath in the wash tub down in the basement. Once he got in, he couldn't get out, so one of us (and I think it was me) pulled him out. Another man committed suicide in our house after having pawned our best clothes. Bill then had evening clothes and I had an evening cape, and we've never had any since!

Families and everybody did what they could to help. The families were included in all meetings. The children came, too, vitally interested in everything that went on. They learned the Twelve Steps and they were really trying to live by them. Everybody used to visit every other Group. The New York Group would go to Jersey or Greenwich or Philadelphia or Washington or even Cleveland or Akron. If anybody had a car, a bunch would all pile in.

So the families were really just as much a part of A.A. as the alcoholics. After a while, the A.A.'s thought they should have at least one meeting every week of just alcoholics only, so they could really get down to business.

When this occurred the wives thought they'd meet together, too, at the same time. At first these little gatherings of wives didn't have any particular characteristics. Sometimes we'd play bridge and sometimes we'd gossip about our husbands. We'd do a variety of things.

But then a few of us began to see that we really needed the A.A. program just as much as the alcoholics did. The case of my throwing a shoe at Bill started me wondering about myself and realizing that I needed to live by the Twelve Steps just as much as Bill did. He was getting way ahead of me and I always thought of myself as being the moral mentor in the house. But Bill was certainly growing spiritually while I was standing still or going backwards. So I decided I'd better live by the Twelve Steps, and Annie Smith and a number of other people came to the same conclusion.

So whenever we visited another Group we would tell the other wives and families how we had found what we needed in the Twelve Steps. So little Groups of wives and families all over the country began to feel the same — that they needed to have something for themselves so they could help themselves from being the frustrated people they were and be real, integrated human beings.

That's really the way Al-Anon started and we followed A.A. in every way we could. I want to thank A.A.'s so very much for showing us the way. Without your leading us we would still be the frustrated folks that we were.

In 1950 Bill travelled all over Canada and the United States, and discovered quite a few of these groups of the families of alcoholics. He thought they should have a central office just as A.A. did, so they could be unified. Everyone would know what they were, where inquiries could be sent, where publicity and knowledge of Al-Anon could go forth. So a friend of mine and I started a little office up in Bedford Hills. A.A. had had by then inquiries from 87 wives wondering if they could register with A.A. A.A. wasn't equipped to help the families of alcoholics so they handed over this list and we wrote to them. We got 50 Groups started in 1951. Today there are over 3,000. Our potential for growth is simply terrific. I think we've just barely started to scratch the surface.

—Lois W.

Bill: Personalities in Framework of Principles

With you I join in gratitude for what we have seen, heard and felt in this marvelous hour. As Lois spoke her lines touching upon the old days, I am sure you apprehended some things she did not say. She stayed in a cave until the darkness was complete and did not lose her faith. Thus she symbolizes so many of our partners sitting here. And she has kept faith ever since in many respects as I have never been able to do. So, Lois, I express to you the thanks of the whole movement and yours truly.

As Lois evoked images of old times and the atmosphere of those early Groups, I got a fresh reminder of how intensely we then tried to practice the principles that would save our lives and subdue our obstinate personalities.

In the very early times this was not so much virtue as necessity. We knew that we had been and might soon again be victims of one of the most hopeless compulsions that mankind knows. The stakes were survival, the stakes were new lives that we had just tasted. Could we go on?

In those days things were very simple so we attended very closely to this business of staying sober and doing what it took to stay sober.

We were surrounded by suicides and failures. So we shared the bread and our love and our companionship to an extraordinary degree, considering our state of development. After three years went by most had come, looked, and gone away, but there was a hard core who felt and behaved as I have described. There were no complications; survive we must; enlarge upon the joys and the gifts we had received, we must. Then we found that we were doing these things because they were right, because we ought to do them. Many had found in our simple principles a new way of life.

So far so good, but we only numbered 40 and the number of alcoholics in the world were 20 millions and in the U.S. and Canada 6 millions. What was our obligation to them? This meant a new great step in responsibility and as we began to shoulder that responsibility we came into harsh contact with those elements in our former lives that had sucked us under.

Lois mentioned books as a source of inspiration. Surely that has been the record of our book. Strangely enough, that volume of inspiration was created by a group of people who pretty much reverted to the cult of personality, because the book brought up questions of money. It brought up questions of prestige.

FORTY DRUNKS AND A BOOK

Looked at in one way, the book project was an unseemly brawl from one end to the other. And from where we were then and from many rational points of view it was a piece of lunacy. Who would expect 40 drunks to produce a book about ourselves and our experiences? Who would expect that we would somehow publish it ourselves and keep it for the benefit of the movement? These were not rational expectations and for that reason 90 per cent of us by and large were against the project. We said, "Let's keep it simple."

Then a hard core of what I shall call a personality cult, more or less headed up by me, got very insistent that we have this book. People said how are you going to do it and who is going to write it? So a couple of chapters were drafted. Then it was suggested that only foolish authors tried to publish themselves so the book had better be taken to a publisher.

And the cult of personality said, "Why give it to a publisher and have them control our literature? Shouldn't this movement control its own literature?"

Then we had to get into the money angle. Some of us who had real experience at promotion learned this book could be printed for one tenth of its retail price. It would cost 35¢ a volume and we figured on selling it for \$3.50. We went to some of our fellows and said here are a couple of chapters and this is the profit margin. We even made up sort of a Wall Street prospectus — not the kind put out by the better houses! We showed what you could make on 10,000 just for starters. Then what you could make on 100,000. I had a friend helping me, an even greater promoter, and he insisted on half a million.

I'm afraid those we solicited were not very enthusiastic. They very rightly said, "Why do you think we would buy stock in a book that isn't yet written?"

It was a good question, and something had to be done.

About that time, our Trustee arrangement had been set up, including a friend of Mr. Rockefeller's, so we thought if we went to the *Reader's Digest* and told them of the great chain reaction that was now beginning, one of the greatest movements of all times (40 members!), and for respectability's sake we rang in Mr. Rockefeller's name, the *Digest* might print us a piece advertising not only the society but also the new book, price \$3.50.

Hitting 12 million readers this would produce volume on the book by car loads. Well, that began to fetch the money, even from those who were frugal, and little by little it began to dribble in and we actually peddled shares in the book not yet written — \$25 a share, paid for at \$5 per month.

Those collections kept my promoter friend and me and that wonderful gal that helped us, Ruthie Hock, first secretary in our office, in groceries. We also borrowed some money from old Charlie Towns, all on the credit of the *Reader's Digest* and John D. Rockefeller.

Finally the book was done, but not without great travail. One chapter at a time was put together. And over in the parlor on Clinton Street those chapters were taken apart and put together again and again. On one side we had the conservatives who wished to produce an almost theological book, and on the other side my promoter friend and Jimmy B. were saying, "The hell with the God business, spring it on them after they arrive, give them a psychological book."

QUITE A HOT SPOT

This was quite a hot spot to be in.

I remember getting as far as up to Chapter 5. We had some preliminary chapters and I finally got to the point where it had to be said how this thing worked. So the idea occurred of taking the six principles that we had and busting them up into smaller pieces so that the distant reader drunk couldn't wiggle out in between. And when they were numbered the Steps came to Twelve and I thought I had done "a good work."

Just then in came a couple of recent customers. They took one look at the Twelve Steps, well larded with God, and said this will never do. So then ensued a prodigious row over the Twelve Steps, and I had ulcers of the stomach, and the contributions on the stock went down. But they could always be revived by the vision of the *Digest* and carloads of books.

Finally we got down to the last five hundred bucks, and that was just enough to pay the printer a down payment of 10¢ a book on 5,000 books.

The great day was here. The book was in the press, the pre-publication copy had gone and we go up to the *Reader's Digest* and we call on one of the editors we had earlier seen, who had promised us a piece. And we gaily said, "Well, Mr. Payne, we are ready to shoot."

His memory being a little dim, he said, "Shoot what? Oh, yes, I remember about the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous, and that book. You know actually we canvassed this quite carefully in our editorial meeting, and we came to the conclusion that this subject was too controversial. I forgot to tell you."

Well, the stockholders were sucked in; the book was broke; everybody said we told you so; Lois and I got evicted from our house (the bank that owned it had become tired) and things were in an awful fix.

Now you see, personalities ran ahead of principles lots of times in all this. So why then did the project pan out at the end? It panned out because as nutty and self-seeking as some of us were, and this includes yours truly (I was out of groceries, you know, too!), the great under-current of principle was still there. This message had to be carried, and this book could be a prime agent of its carriage.

So the grace of God plus the enormous suffering we knew to be going on within gunshot around us, easily overwhelmed the cult of personality.

(continued on P. 39)

Digest of Agenda

MONDAY, APRIL 18

Registration and Tour of G.S.O.
Welcome Session and "In Memoriam."
Staff Reports. Review of Conference Agenda and Committees.
Opening Dinner: Regular A.A. Meeting.

TUESDAY, APRIL 19

Joint Meetings of Board (Trustees) Committees and Conference Committees.
Conference Committee Meetings.
Reports by General Service Board and its Committees.
"Area Delegates Only" Dinner and Meeting.

WEDNESDAY, APRIL 20

Re-structuring the General Service Board.
Institutional Groups and Committees.
Help for A.A. in Small Communities.
How Central Service Offices and General Service Work Together.
Clubs, Rehabs, and A.A. Traditions.
Workshop and Sharing Sessions: "Conference Structure, Conference Reporting, and Area Activities."

THURSDAY, APRIL 21

Grapevine.
Reinforcing Our Tradition of Self-Support (Proposed Change in Preamble).
Financing G.S.O. and the Regular Contribution Plan.
Interview Time.
Conference Committee Meetings.
A Good Look at A.A. Attraction.
Film: "Bill's Own Story."

FRIDAY, APRIL 22

Conference Committee Reports, Discussion, and Action.
Report on 1965 Convention in Toronto.
A.A.'s 35th Anniversary International Convention.
Anonymity within A.A.
World Directory — Use and Misuse.
Literature.
Principles Before Personalities.

SATURDAY, APRIL 23

Closing Brunch.
Stepping Stones Visit and Picnic.

"AREA HIGHLIGHTS": Each day time was set aside to hear Area Delegates of Panel 16 report on A.A. in their territories. Excerpts from these are carried on Pages 15-17.

"ASK-IT BASKET": Questions submitted anonymously from the floor were discussed and answered at various times. Summaries of these are found in appropriate places in this Report.

"INTERVIEW TIME": Six specific questions were put to Delegates in six separate sections. Summaries of their answers and suggestions are reported in appropriate places in this Report.

IN MEMORIAM



— Sister Ignatia —



— Dr. Tiebout —

Special tributes to the memory of Ebby T. (Bill's sponsor), Dr. Harry M. Tiebout and Sister Mary Ignatia — all of whom died shortly before the 1966 Conference — were delivered by Bill W., A.A.'s surviving co-founder, at the opening session of the 16th Conference.

(An account of the life and works of these three greatly loved friends of A.A. is published in the June-July 1966 "Exchange Bulletin." Bill's personal tributes will appear in the June, July and August 1966 "Grapevines.")

With Dr. John L. Norris, G.S. Board Chairman, presiding, Conference members then approved with a moment of silence the following memorial resolutions offered by Bill:

In Memoriam: A Resolution

We of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous here assembled do lovingly inscribe upon our annals this testament of our gratitude for the life and works of our departed friend, Sister Mary Ignatia, the saintly nun of the Sisters of Charity of St. Augustine who in partnership with Dr. Bob at St. Thomas Hospital in Akron brought recovery to thousands in our early days and until her recent death. No brighter recollection than this shall we ever know.

... And of our departed friend, Dr. Harry M. Tiebout. As the first of the psychiatric profession ever to hold up our hands for all men to see, we know that his memory will be imperishable among us.

... And of our departed Ebby who had been enabled to bring Bill the gift of Grace because he could reach him at depth through the language of the heart. He pushed ajar that great gate through which all in A.A. have since passed to find their freedom under God.

A MOMENT OF SILENCE

With a deeply felt interlude of silence, members of the 16th Conference also paid tribute to the memory of two deceased Delegates: Ed M., Washington, and Harry H., California (Southern). In Dr. Jack's words, "their contributions were highly valuable and they will be sorely missed."

PRESENTATION

Principles Before Personalities

Exploring ever more deeply the ramifications and applications of the Conference theme, "Principles before personalities," and measuring Conference activities against its ideal, four speakers contributed their thinking to close the deliberations. Summaries of their remarks follow.

A foundation for other truths

I suggest to each of you that when you return home you find a few quiet minutes and honestly search yourself as to your own principles, and see how they stack up against personalities.

Make your own little inventory. Put it down on paper. Some of you may get as big a shock as I did.

I believe that practicing the 12 Steps in our every day living, to the best of our ability, is the foundation for the truths that became our principles. And as each of us applies them to his own life, they should become more important to us than personalities.

In the Conference we have seen a basic principle at work — each of us in his own way striving to do what he thought was best for A.A. as a whole, regardless of how other Delegates were thinking.

I always like to give a new person coming into the program a warning — don't tie your A.A. sobriety too closely to your sponsor or any other personality, we all have feet of clay.

Clubs in many areas are a real asset and fulfill a need. But I have seen many fine Groups start clubs and become so engrossed that they lost sight of the principles upon which the Group was started. Money the Group had been using to support a Central Office and G.S.O. is now channeled into the club, with the result that all three have been hindered.

My aim as an individual I hope coincides with the purpose of all A.A. Groups, Central Offices and G.S.O. We are all working toward a common principle — of being responsible. So that all of us in the Fellowship can say, "I am responsible."

This is a principle, a truth that can be the foundation for other truths, if we try.

—Walter T., Florida.

Man, the rational animal

In Alcoholics Anonymous we have one primary purpose, which is sobriety. In our efforts to protect our sobriety we must be constantly guarding against bad emotions and attempting to use our good emotions.

The reason for this theme of "Principles Before Personalities" is the same as any other Step or Tradition or slogan we have in A.A., to help us to remain in a state of happy sobriety. The principles which we have in this program are good, and if applied and worked on, will bring out the best of emotions and acts in all of us, since they embody all the principles of the Golden Rule and all the good things we learned as children from our parents and clergy.

When one puts personalities before principles, either at the individual level, Group level or Area level, it can very well cause irreparable damage in many instances. If applied at the individual level, it very well could cause some individual to lose his sobriety. At the Group level it could engender dissatisfaction, anger, and many times the breaking up of a Group, which, had it stayed in existence, might have been the anchoring point for suffering alcoholics that may have come along, whose lives may have been saved.

Generally, the lack of putting principles before personalities by one or two individuals will work out on the whole. As always you will find coming to the fore the group conscience and a stronger and more closely knit Group or Area. The discussion brought about by these actions often causes more knowledge and understanding of our wonderful Fellowship.

—Bill C., Massachusetts.

Personal experiences

I certainly want to offer my congratulations on the choice of the 16th Conference theme. Personalities will come and go, but the right kind of principles will go on forever and it is up to us as individuals to start spreading sound and good principles.

Shortly after I came to A.A., I became very active in our local Group. In meetings I made statements such as: "I never lost my appetite, was never away from home at nights, never stopped praying or lost my faith in God and had not had a desire to take a drink." There were criticisms and statements were made, such as, "I had better go back and take the Fourth Step and learn about the honesty part of the program." Again I had to accept things that I could not change and place principles before personalities.

I think that some A.A.'s like us as individuals and others for what we really believe in. I had some pretty rough things said about me by a few members of my own Group, but one night I said this was my Group and no one could ever drive me away from it. I had to put principles above personalities.

During the past year, where I have attended meetings as the Delegate, I ran into misunderstandings as to the duties and operation of our G.S.O. After discussing these matters, I discovered that the reason was lack of knowledge, and that in several Groups they were familiar with the Twelve Steps and knew very little about the Twelve Traditions. Many times I have said, "Follow the principles as set out in our program, and accept them, and a thorough study of the Traditions would help personalities be replaced by principles." —Tom P., Iowa.

Synonyms for God

Principles, Webster says, are a source or origin; an original faculty or endowment; a fundamental truth; synonyms for God.

By the exercise of free will, gradually but persistently, through surrender to alcohol, within my ego there occurred a disunion of soul from body. Consequently there came about a complete abandonment of principles, which temporarily left survival to personality. With an unsane intellect to direct will, it wasn't long before personality was shattered and life became completely unmanageable.

Awakening in a hospital room, with four walls and myself, on the bedside table was my salvation, the Big Book. For four days I read and pondered its contents. The drinking problem I had, or I wouldn't have been there. So, I deduced, all that was needed was to stop drinking and all my problems and worries were over.

Released from the hospital, why not take a whirl at going to this A.A. meeting, I wondered — of course with reservations. How vividly that first meeting stands out in my memory.

Having reached the decision that I had a desire to stop drinking my curiosity led me back week after week — in between reading everything I could get my hands on having to do with alcoholism, psychology and man himself.

Up to my advent into A.A., egotism and personality submerged me in the power of alcohol. One day at a time, nurturing ego, to balance the gift of intellect, brings about a dependency on principles, subdues personality, to the acts of charity, of the heart, that is.

So long as principles are given first priority, in my daily living, no longer do I have to promote for rewards.

Your being here, anonymous, representing the conscience of A.A., is the spiritual foundation, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities.

—R. Fay B. (Class B) Trustee, North Dakota.

Conference Action

Three More Regional Trustees To be Added to Board

Beginning with the election of three Regional Trustees (A.A. — Class B) at the 1967 Conference, the General Service Board will be increased to conform with Conference wishes, as reported in the "Board Change" story on Page 6.

This will bring Regional trusteeships to eight — six from the U.S. to fill its six regions and two from Canada. Canada will determine for itself how its two regions are to be set up. At an informal session of Canadian Delegates and Trustees, it was agreed that for Trustee election purposes Canada be divided into two regions at the Manitoba-Ontario border.

The first new General Service Trustee will be elected from the U.S. Two new General Service Trustees are to be added,

one from the U.S. and one from Canada. Upon motion of Dr. Dancey of Montreal and Tom B. of Manitoba, the Conference agreed that the first new General Service Trustee was to come from the U.S., the second from Canada. When both are elected, there will then be six General Service Trustees — four from the New York commuting area as in the past, and the two new General Service Trustees.

A motion to change the Bylaws to restrict Board Chairmanship to nonalcoholics was not carried.

These actions to effect Board changes are the latest in a series of steps taken throughout A.A. history to keep A.A.'s world services abreast of the growing, evolving Fellowship.

REPORTS

Four A.A.'s, three non's, welcomed to Board in '65

Three Class A trustees were welcomed to the General Service Board during the past year: Dr. Travis Dancey, Montreal, Canada; Dr. Vincent Dole and Mr. Robert W.P. Morse, both of New York. Mr. Leonard Harrison, after many years of devoted service, became a Trustee Emeritus.

Four new Class B trustees were welcomed to the Board. They are the three Regional trustees selected at the last Conference: Tom B., Fay B., and Frank R., plus Charles E. L. (Chairman of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.), a General Service trustee.

The Board meets the last Monday of each April, July, October, and January.

At the April 1965 meeting the Board voted unanimously to accept the 1966 advisory actions of the Conference. Some of them were:

1. That the Trustees' program for structuring the Board be received for study in the Areas during the coming year, with the understanding Delegates will vote at the 1966 Conference.

2. That the two-year term of Delegates remain in effect.

3. That non-A.A.'s should not hold office in regular A.A. Groups and that Groups which include non-A.A.'s as members should not include A.A. in their name.

The July meeting was held in Toronto, immediately following the convention, the first time the Board has met outside the United States.

Some of the recommendations approved by the Board at the regular October and January meetings were:

1. That "Principles Before Personalities" be the theme for the 1966 General Service Conference.

2. That the suggested changes in the wording of the Preamble be presented to the Conference.

3. That ex-trustees be available as advisers to boards and committees at the discretion of the Chairmen and members of these boards and committees.

4. That ex-trustees not be elected or re-elected to A.A. World Services, Inc., or to the Grapevine board.

5. That an omnibus piece that would incorporate useful information from several pamphlets (such as "The G.S.R.," "Inside A.A.," "Structure and Services," and "Your Role in the General Service Conference") and the Structure Chart, be considered.

6. That item #4 of the article "Dependence on Barbiturates and other Sedative Drugs" from the *Journal of the American Medical Association* (August 23, 1965) be included in the next printing of the "Sedatives" pamphlet after approval by the Conference Literature Committee.

—John L. Norris, M.D. (Class A), Chairman,
General Service Board.

Nominating Committee welcomes new Trustees, files slates

Some of the committee's actions during the past year include:

1. Reviewed resumes of new Class A and Class B trustee candidates and recommended for election at the July 1965, General Service Board meeting: Charles E.L. (Class B) and Robert W.P. Morse (Class A). Their election followed a mail poll of all Conference Delegates.

2. Reviewed two recommendations from Conference committees, but deferred recommending Board action until after discussion with the Conference Committee on Trustees. The Nominating Committee did

- (a) Look with favor on the suggestion that "within 75-mile radius of New York City" not be excluded from the Northeast Class B Trustee Region.

- (b) Look with disfavor on the suggestion that any A.A. member employed professionally in the alcoholism field be barred from candidacy for Class B trusteeship.

3. The committee advised the Board it would welcome ex-trustees as advisers to boards and committees. Also, that this Committee does not look with favor on election of ex-trustees to the Grapevine or A.A.W.S. Board of Directors.

4. Expressed gratitude to Mary B., Class B trustee, who completed her four-year term as of January, 1966.

5. Reviewed General Service Class B trustee candidates and decided to defer recommendation of any nominee.

6. Recommended that the following be elected trustees of the General Service Board:

CLASS A

Dr. Travis Dancey
Dr. Vincent Dole
Austin MacCormick
Robert W.P. Morse
Hon. John Murtagh
Dr. John L. Norris
Archibald Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith

Professor Harrison Trice

CLASS B

Tom B.
R. Fay B.
Eugene K.
Charles E. L. Jr.
D. Bruce M.
Jim M.
Frank R.
Murray W.

7. Recommended the following officers of the General Service Board be elected at the annual meeting of the Board in April:

Chairman — Dr. John L. Norris

1st Vice-Chairman — Bernard B. Smith

2nd Vice-Chairman — Murray W.

Secretary — Charles E. L., Jr.

Asst. Secretary — Midge McF.

Treasurer — Archibald Roosevelt

Asst. Treasurer — Robert W.P. Morse

—Eugene K., Chairman, General Service Board
Nominating Committee.

REPORT

Policy Committee helped Board

The Committee met in April, October and January on the Sunday before the Board meetings. All Trustees, Directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine Staff, Public Information and International Committee members are invited to these meetings. Usually 30 to 35 are present, and the meetings continue for four hours or more. This "town meeting" format provides a wealth of A.A. experience.

Reports are presented from A.A.W.S., Grapevine, Public Information and International Committee, Trustees and Staff. The Committee discusses A.A. policy, and makes recommendations to the Board.

Action taken by this group is reported in other committee reports.

Some of the subjects discussed at length were:

The possibility of changing the Preamble to delete the phrase "no dues or fees" and the word "politics."

That the words "attraction" and "promotion" should be more clearly defined and included as a Conference discussion subject.

Effectiveness of discounts on bulk literature sales. It was determined that there is now a 20% reduction on regular literature "discount" packages.

A more equitable distribution of Delegates' expense allowance. This was referred to the Conference Policy Committee.

Reevaluated the regular meeting schedule of the Board.

As the 1965 Conference recommended, the chairman of the January meeting drew Panel 16 Delegates by geographic lot for Conference Committees. This should prove to be time-saving as well as helpful to the Delegates, as they can come to their first Conference with some preparation for committee work.

The voting members of the Policy Committee now number twelve — five Regional Trustees, two Class A, the Chairman of General Services and the Treasurer of A.A.W.S., a Grapevine Trustee and two Staff Members. A Regional Trustee is chairman.

—Jim M., Calif., Chairman,
Policy Committee of G.S. Board.

Conference Action

Conference Reviews and Revises Qualifications For Class B Trustees

Three more actions taken by the 1966 Conference (in accepting the report of its Committee on Trustees) reaffirmed the importance of "principles before personalities." Members present declined to exclude certain A.A. members from consideration as Class B (A.A.) Trustees, by approving:

(1) An A.A. member professionally employed in the field of alcoholism should not be excluded from service on the G.S. Board, solely for that reason, but it is desirable that the Board and its Nominating Committee "maintain the

guardianship of Alcoholics Anonymous on a non-professional level."

(2) No A.A. member living within a 75-mile radius of New York City should, for that reason alone, be excluded from service on the G.S. Board as a Regional Trustee.

(3) No rigid time-of-sobriety requirement should be established in advance for "General Service" (A.A.) Trustees, but the Board should consider both service experience and "stability of sobriety" in naming such members.

REPORT

Conference Committee on Trustees

(Excerpts)

1. The Conference Committee on Trustees does not look with favor on the suggestion that members employed professionally in the alcoholism field be barred from candidacy for Class B Trustees. We place no restrictions or limits on the Nominating Committee of the G.S. Board in selection of Class B Trustee nominees, but we ask that the Committee be aware of our desire and the necessity to maintain the guardianship of Alcoholics Anonymous on a non-professional level.
2. We favor the suggestion that the "75-mile radius of New York City" restriction affecting Regional Class B Trustees be eliminated.
3. We recommend the following Trustees of the General Service Board be elected at the annual meeting of the Board:

CLASS A

Dr. Travis Dancey
Dr. Vincent Dole
Austin MacCormick
Robert W.P. Morse
Hon. John Murtagh
Dr. John L. Norris
Archibald Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith
Prof. Harrison Trice

CLASS B

Tom B.
R. Fay B.
Eugene K.
Charles E. L.
D. Bruce M.
Jim M.
Frank R.
Murray W.

4. We recommend the following officers be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board:

Chairman — Dr. John L. Norris
1st Vice-Chairman — Bernard Smith
2nd Vice-Chairman — Murray W.
Secretary — Charles L.
Asst. Secretary — Midge M.
Treasurer — Archibald Roosevelt
Asst. Treasurer — Robert W.P. Morse

* * *

10. We feel that the length of sobriety for qualification as a Class B General Service Trustee should be left to the discretion of the General Service Board, taking into consideration the stability of the candidate's sobriety and his or her service experience.

* * *

13. Elected Chairman of this Committee was Ed L., Delegate from Saskatchewan.

—Jack M., Colo., Chairman,
Conference Committee on Trustees.

Conference Action

Conference Declares 'We Are Responsible' For Helping Alcoholics in Institutions

The 16th Conference formally established a Conference Institutions Committee to encourage A.A. members to assume a responsibility to help sick alcoholics in institutions who cannot of their own free will seek A.A. help.

"We have to go to them, since they cannot come to us," one Delegate after another pointed out. Unanimously the members of

the Conference accepted the recommendation of the Conference Policy Committee for formation of a Conference Institutions Committee, to be composed initially of members of the former Admissions Committee (its functions were combined with those of the Agenda Committee—see Page 48.)

PRESENTATION

More Work Needed

In an attempt to learn how well we are carrying our message to those who cannot come to us, we sent out a questionnaire in December to all Delegates. About 40% were returned.

The primary need is to find more A.A.'s willing to become involved in carrying the message to those who cannot come to us. That A.A. in institutions is valuable is attested to by hospital and prison administrators everywhere, and most of all by those A.A.'s, now free, who first heard and got the message in an institution. These people are some of our most productive members and are tireless in their efforts to do for another alcoholic what was once done for them.

Our ability to do a good job at G.S.O. is dependent upon you who are in touch with what's really going on, and who take the trouble to share this knowledge with us. In many ways, we in the office have a kind of experience with Institutions different from yours. For instance, the inmate member of a prison Group who corresponds with us, as an individual or as Group Secretary, has passed through the hardcore, resistant phase and

has become accepting, thanks to your efforts. Because the turnover in hospitals is so great, we rarely hear from any except long-term patients who are still seriously disturbed. As you can see, we are really not able to get the whole picture from the institutions Groups themselves.

We are learning of Municipal Court Groups and Parole Groups. In fact, we get enough inquiries to warrant preparation of a piece of service material on this subject, we think.

We hope you will discuss all possible ways that we can help make institutional work even more productive. For instance: (1) Does every state prison and every state hospital have a Group? (2) Is institutions work improved when institutions are a part of the Assembly or Area Conference structure, with a percentage of funds allotted for supplying A.A. literature? (3) If so, what percentage would you suggest? (4) Would our work be more productive if we had a Conference Institutions Committee? (5) How would it function?

—Cora Louise B., G.S.O. Staff.

Los Angeles A.A.'s work

The Los Angeles Institutional Committee holds regular meetings in over eighty city, county, state and federal institutions. It was formed in 1947 to coordinate scattered individual efforts and to provide a responsible committee which could see that the rules and regulations of the institutions were followed and that meetings were held as scheduled.

The Committee, which is autonomous, is composed of members of regular A.A. Groups interested in carrying the A.A. message into institutions.

Staff includes the Director, Assistant Director, Secretary, Treasurer, Entertainment Chairman, Historian, Central and General Service Representatives and "Sounding Board" Editor, in addition to:

(a) "Buck-of-the-Month" Chairman, responsible for collec-

tion of funds and purchase of literature. Contributions are from monthly pledges by A.A. members. Annual purchases are approximately \$4,000.

(b) Institutional Relations Chairman, responsible for negotiations of major problems with officials.

(c) Intergroup Institutional Representative, who coordinates activities with the Ventura County, Harbor, Inland, Orange County and San Diego Committees. Meetings in outlying, isolated institutions may be a joint effort of several committees.

(d) Information Panel, which, when invited, explains institutional Committee operations at regular A.A. Groups.

—Jack O., Calif.

Indiana State Prison

In March, 1943, what we believe to be a second A.A. program in a maximum security prison was begun at the Indiana State Prison. Today there are approximately 290 "card-carrying" A.A. members inside the walls. These members have a choice of 9 different Groups that meet on Saturday afternoon for two and one-half hours in various rooms in the educational building inside the prison. On Sunday afternoon an open meeting generally attracts about 100 to 150 inmates and outside visitors.

When a prisoner is first admitted to the prison, he isn't sent out into the prison population. He is sent for four to six weeks to an admission and orientation unit. Here is the best place to call an inmate's attention to the part alcohol has played in his

present situation. A program of charts, films, and lectures by other inmates and myself is presented to the new prisoners on a weekly basis.

This is not an A.A. program, but we are at this point attempting to show new inmates that alcohol brought them here. We know this to be true with about 85% of them. So, when he leaves the admission and orientation unit he is better ready to be attracted to one of the six A.A. Groups that await him.

The institutional committee has the responsibility of informing administrative personnel about A.A. so that they will be attracted to it as a help in the rehabilitation of persons for whose security they have charge.

—Ross I., Indiana.

North Florida individuals

For the most of our area, Groups who have institutional Groups in their areas have sponsored the forming of the Group in that institution. The outside Group furnishes literature, and selects a person to act as sponsor of the Group.

By giving the primary responsibility to one person, and letting him enlist the assistance of others we secure a closer linkage with the supervisory personnel. If we are to play the game in their house, we must obey their rules, in order for us to do our most effective work; and we need not have any fear, if we keep in mind at all times that our primary purpose is to stay

sober and carry our message to those who want sobriety.

We always keep faith with these Groups by fulfilling all engagements. We let these inmates realize that we have a sincere interest in their recovery; also demonstrate to the supervisory personnel that we have this sincere desire to help those who have a problem with alcohol and want help. In this way we find no stumbling blocks placed in our path. We find understanding people, who greatly assist us in carrying our message.

—Bert L., Florida.

Ontario A.A.'s active

Ontario does not have a regional Institutional Committee, but depends on the three Sections to assume responsibilities in this service.

Most eastern Ontario areas have Institutional Committees, and there is an overall Section Institutional Committee responsible to the Ontario General Service Committee.

The Ontario G.S. Committee issues a pamphlet with a pie-plate diagram of where the member's dollar is going. In the last few years the percentage of the dollar being used for institutional work has been approximately 13%. At least 15% of Ontario's 1966 budget of approximately \$5,000 will be used to service the 27 institutional Groups within its boundaries.

One service is the showing of the film "Bill's Own Story" to as many institutional Groups as possible. During one week this film was shown every night in an institutions Group in the city of Kingston, through the co-operation of the Regional Institutional Chairman and the Area G.S.R.'s. It is intended to obtain the film again and again, until all institutional Groups have the same opportunity to view it as those of us on the outside.

In some of our institutions, during the last three months of an inmate's term, he is allowed to visit the outside in the company of a guard (in plain clothes, of course) and many visit nearby city Groups. A certain quota are allowed to attend a nearby Conference, or even an open-to-the public meeting. These visits

are considered valuable in carrying the message back to the Groups in institutions, and giving inmates an opportunity to see how the outside Groups work.

One of our most effective means of carrying the message into institutions is literature. It is supplied free-of-charge by the Ontario G.S. Committee. The Institutional Chairman is authorized to order, stock and distribute all literature needed for this purpose. He is the only person allowed to do so and receive the full financial support of the Ontario Committee. Therefore, all requests for literature are referred to the Chairman by Institutional G.S.R.'s or contacts and these requests are filled as quickly as possible by supplying a standard package of literature.

It is well to remember that no matter how many Institutional Committees are operating, no matter how much literature is provided, there is no substitute for the actual personal contact between the A.A. member on the outside and the A.A. member on the inside. Attendance, participation, example, encouragement, and persistence are some of the attributes required. This type of service can be exhausting, frustrating, unrewarding, fruitless, exasperating, baffling, costly, and yet, strangely, with all this, no one will come flatly out and say it is not exceedingly worthwhile and necessary. And best of all, it works!

—Alf M., Ontario

REPORT

36,000 members behind walls need our help

Problems and challenges of institutional A.A. are not new; they are just new to me. The prime need is the continuing one of finding more A.A.'s willing to do this work. We have a heavy responsibility to institutionalized alcoholics; they are unable to come to us for help, so we have to go to them. A good job is being done, but no one feels we have fully discharged our responsibilities in this area yet.

G.S.O. services to A.A. Groups in institutions are: (1) complimentary literature to new Groups; (2) the *World Directory*; A.A. *Groups in Correctional Facilities*, and A.A. *Groups in Hospitals and Rehabilitation Centers* to all institutional Groups each year; (3) *Exchange Bulletin* to institutional Groups and spon-

sors; (4) special literature packages at reduced rates (\$4.50 worth of literature, sold for \$3.00) for hospital and prison Groups. A jail package (valued at \$3.00 and sold at \$2.00) was also made available this year. The Grapevine, ordered with an institutional discount package, may be had for \$3.00 a year; (5) personal correspondence with Groups, members, administrators, sponsors, and Institutional Committees sharing the experience of other A.A.'s; and (6) free literature supplied to Groups who have no other means of obtaining a regular supply: back issues of Grapevine, books and publications from other institutional Groups.

— CORA LOUISE B., Staff Member, Institutions.

ASK-IT BASKET

Q. Please discuss submitting Institutional listings through the Delegate.

A. We would be happy to so list institutions in Directories if the Institutions chairmen submit listings to

G.S.O.

Q. Why can't literature for hospital and penal facilities be provided by the institutions themselves? Nearly all such facilities speak of A.A.'s help, most of them have funds for library material and such a plan would relieve local Groups of an ever-increasing financial responsibility.

A. Many institutions that have the money do purchase A.A.

literature. One Area holds a public meeting twice a year, passes the hat and uses this money for buying A.A. literature for inmates. Groups are encouraged to save Grapevines and pamphlets to forward to institutional Groups. In one penitentiary, a magazine is published bi-monthly and money from its sale is used for A.A. literature. Rather than suggest that all institutions provide the necessary funds, we try to look at each institutional Group's individual situation.

Q. What is an Institution?

A. A facility where people live within the confines of walls and from which they are not free to come or go at will. An Institutions Group is an A.A. Group meeting within the walls of an institution.

Area Highlights

ALASKA — In 1949 the Big Book was found in an old oil drum two miles from Anchorage. Shortly a Group was formed. In 1952, it had 14 members. Today Alaska is 586,000 square miles, with 325 members in 26 Groups, and nine Loners . . . one Group (listen, Texas) per 22,540 square miles. I have driven 80 miles at sixty degrees below zero to a meeting. I know that, like the lichen that grows on our cold, barren rocks, A.A. in Alaska will continue to survive and flourish. —O.C. (Pav) P.

ALBERTA — "I am responsible." But does it give me the right to act when other realms in the alcoholism field are hurting more than helping? We are supposed to act if something is threatening A.A. as a whole. If you find much being done to hurt in the alcoholism field, do you have a responsibility to voice an opinion? We have Traditions, we neither endorse nor oppose, we cooperate, not affiliate. We have to take some of responsibility. —Ted K.

ARIZONA — In Arizona almost everyone has found inspiration from the responsibility declaration. It has not only inspired us in reaching out to take the hand that needs us, but also to face many other responsibilities. The financial needs of the Group, the Intergroup, and our General Service Office — for those we are responsible. In all our Institutions A.A. has grown. To help keep the A.A. program growing — for that we are responsible. —Paul R.

CALIFORNIA (Northern Interior) — As soon as this lectern settles down I want to talk about confusion. On the agenda I read, "Area Highlights, Ken K." It should read, "Area Accident, Ken K." Out in our area, we get newcomers. We read to them. They say, "Hurray it doesn't cost anything, you don't have to do anything." We spend the rest of our time trying to convince them it isn't exactly so. I'm confused. —Ken K.

CALIFORNIA (San Diego) — "Progress is our most important product." This is not an original remark, but using it is in the oldest tradition of A.A.: "If it applies, swipe it!" We have about 100 weekly meetings, and an equal number of hospital, institutional, beginners', and rehab house meetings. The most gratifying development is Young Peoples' Groups, and the tremendous number of "under 35's" accepting A.A. Numerous Groups have grown up in small communities. —Rosa B.

CALIFORNIA (Southern Coastal) — I represent 250 Groups between Los Angeles and San Diego. There are three Central Offices and three Institutional Committees. In my own district we have grown from five Groups to over 20 in five years. We have a Desert A.A. Roundup to inform the members what General Service is. The attendance was 125 in 1960, and we expect over 3,000 this coming June. Hazel will talk, and the Governor has informed us he will attend if possible. —Joe K.

DELAWARE — We have 24 Groups. To tell the still suffering alcoholic where meetings are, we publish an A.A. calendar of Groups and it lists the Group, the address where it meets and the date and time. We include five meetings in Pennsylvania, two in New Jersey, and nine in Maryland. We want to make A.A. easy to find. This is our way of trying to keep the faith. —Grover S.

GEORGIA — Our State Assembly meetings used to be held at our state conventions, but we decided to hold them outside the conventions, on the basis that we didn't need a convention to attract those who truly desire to serve A.A. Our state has been re-districted into Areas, with Committee Members elected from each. We are now holding monthly Area meetings. An Institutional Committeeman works with our Area Committee Members on any institution. We have 110 Groups in Georgia, each with an active G.S.R. —Virgil W.

IDAHO — I bring the greetings of Arnold A., the ex-Delegate. Also, I would like to express my thanks to all the Staff for the fine job they have done and are continuing to do. I am delighted to say that Eric B., Delegate from Washington, has invited me to their Conference and I find this a great privilege. I am delighted to be here and hope that I will be able to carry the message of this Conference back to my area. —Wilford W.

ILLINOIS (Northern) — Alcoholism Information Centers, national publicity, a more enlightened view by the clergy and medical people, and more acceptance of A.A. by the general public are all advantageous to A.A. But, they may be the reasons we are meeting a type of prospective A.A. member different from the newcomer of several years ago. His outlook regarding the First Step is vastly different: —Bud W.

INDIANA (Southern) — Not only is our membership growing; there is more awareness by the general public about A.A. Some of this is due to radio, TV and press publicity and A.A.'s speaking before community facilities. Many alcoholics are referred or pressured into coming to us; our Group was actually started at the joint request of the clergy of a small community. The Director of the Division on Alcoholism of the Indiana Mental Health Department, a nonalcoholic, attends our State Committee meetings. —Bob W.

KANSAS — We have four halfway houses, operated by A.A. members through corporations, but not identified with A.A. The Kansas Board of Health pays the bills. The State Vocational and Rehabilitation Service purchases the services of the facility for rehabilitation of alcoholics. State funds are acquired on a federal government sharing program for this service. The federal government pays 60% and the state 40%. The state pays the rehab facility \$20 per week per resident, for a maximum of five weeks. The state also pays for a physical examination and for a Big Book. —Hank E.

KENTUCKY — Quarterly weekend meetings are held in January, April, July and October. Five hundred to 600 people travel as far as 300 miles to attend. We ask Groups to invite anyone interested in our Fellowship to this open meeting. G.S.R. meetings are held at breakfast following the quarterly meeting. We finance this meeting by our own contributions. We pay speaker's expense from the kitty, keep \$100 in the bank, and send the balance to our Central Office. —Bernie S.

MAINE — This program and the grace of God have worked for me 4,478 twenty-four-hour-days without a slip. As Delegate, so far I have visited 22 Groups. This year our District #1 will hold an open meeting for the state and profits will be forwarded to G.S.O. The state committee will sponsor a picnic this summer, and the proceeds from this, too, will go to G.S.O. —Gordon P.

MANITOBA — A.A. came to Manitoba 21 years ago. The 1965 Directory lists 1,193 members and 61 Groups, and the 1966 Directory will show an increase in Groups. Today there are 15 Groups within 50 miles. Cooperation with professional alcoholism agencies is good all over Manitoba, and the referrals made by these wonderful friends of A.A. are largely responsible for the Fellowship's growth in the province. —Jim P.

MARYLAND — Is our responsibility limited to the suffering alcoholic who reaches out to us for help? What about the alcoholic who has had sobriety in A.A. for several years, and appears to be losing interest in A.A.? Does not our responsibility obligate us, as sober alcoholics, to share our knowledge and experience of the pitfalls and the great danger of wandering away? Are we not all sponsors of each other? I believe we are, and have a definite responsibility to each other. —Ginny D.

Area Highlights

MASSACHUSETTS (Western) — One Sunday morning attending the Institutions Committee meeting, I heard these words: "This day we are sober! This morning we express our gratitude! This day we accept our responsibility! This day the hand of A.A. is here!" Now I knew that the "I am responsible" declaration was taking affect. I've known of the hard work a few dedicated A.A. members put in on this committee. I suggest that other committees open their meetings with the declaration. —Roger L.

MICHIGAN (Western) — "Responsibility before personalities" is the thing we must keep foremost in our minds. When we are no longer capable of running our lives, are bankrupt in every department, we turn to A.A. We can be very grateful that such a Fellowship exists. Thank God, as we understand Him, that a Group was a hand in our community when we so desperately needed it. Let's keep the door open with our continued service. We must make A.A. available to every person who still suffers. —Clarence K.

MINNESOTA — My heart and my mind desire to talk to you but my body and my nerves do strongly protest. When I came to A.A. for help there were three Groups in St. Cloud. After about five years of haggling, we decided to build our own Alano Club, and we have blossomed into six Groups. Of the 54 Groups in my area about 75% have G.S.R.'s and only about 50% of them are active in their own Groups and in Assembly work. We average 15 to 20 G.S.R.'s at our Assembly meetings. —Arno A.

MISSISSIPPI — We are the only dry state left in the Union, so if you plan on coming to Mississippi for a slip, bring your bottle with you. It's as hard to get down there as your nearest telephone. We even collect black market tax on whiskey, and we have over 130,000 alcoholics. We have a fine State Assembly organized by our past Delegate, Bish M. We solved the problem of attendance by holding our little Convention each three months. We ask an out-of-town speaker, and we have good crowds. It has caused a lot more enthusiasm. —Tyson L.

MONTANA — I represent about 550 A.A. members in 36 Groups, and a dozen Lone members in an area of 147,000 square miles. To see the closest Group I drive about 25 miles; the farthest is about 425 miles away. We hold each year two state conferences and Intergroup meetings in five different areas. I am trying to reorganize the "Shock Troop," six or seven members willing to go any place, any time to carry the message at a public meeting, help a new Group, pep up an older Group, or just call on a sick alcoholic. Past Delegates will help. —Earl P.

NEBRASKA — It is only through A.A. that I am in this room today — not down on the Bowery where I was ten years ago. The message I leave with you is: I don't believe we're doing enough in A.A. to "let them know of our being!" I think it is time we stopped hiding behind "no promotion." I firmly believe we should better inform the public of our program. But they'll never hear us if we don't start telling them! —Kerry L.

NEW BRUNSWICK — PRINCE EDWARD ISLAND — With two areas in the Atlantic Provinces and addition of a second Delegate, growth of new Groups and membership is very evident. Monthly district meetings, and quarterly Area Round-Ups have helped. The Toronto theme, "I am responsible," has been spurring our whole area to get up and go. A monthly publication also helps. *Third Legacy* procedures are strictly followed throughout the Area. —Russell S.

NEW HAMPSHIRE — Because of small population and our geography, we are very dependent on the few other Groups within driving distance. Just as no man is an island, no Group is an island. In New Hampshire not only is each member dependent on others for strength — so are Groups dependent on each other.

To be closely united we have to put principles before personalities. We try to remain constantly aware of this because by necessity our sobriety and our lives depend on it. —George J.

NEW JERSEY (Southern) — A.A. has grown plenty since I came in over 17 years ago. Some Groups have folded, more have stuck. Two years ago we had our first conference; last year, our first convention. Not all Groups participated. I think some people forget when they were in need of help someone called on them. The same goes for speakers; only a few participated. When the Conference Delegate wants to talk, it is hard to get time. We have Area meetings, and Committee meetings, but not many turn out. Public Information, it is hard to say. —Paul H.

NEW MEXICO — We have eight Areas in New Mexico; Area 3 holds special monthly Intergroup meetings; Area 4 holds their meeting in a different town in the Area each month; and in the past year three other Areas have initiated this type of meeting. A fourth has reactivated their Intergroup meeting. Groups are taking more responsibility for carrying the message in cooperation with the State Alcoholic Commission workshops. Members have participated in a radio program devoted to alcoholism once a week. —Bob F.

NEW YORK (Hudson-Mohawk-Berkshire) — The Mohawk-Hudson-Berkshire Area is the largest geographically in New York, and takes in part of Vermont and Massachusetts. With our present system of automatic succession, it could happen that a person could be elected to the Committee, then just sit back and automatically ascend to the delegacy. There would be more interest in service work if our Area were broken down to districts and there was a contest for the delegacy every two years. —Joe C.

NEW YORK (Western) — Many speakers in our area now close their talks with, "I am responsible." This has had its effect. Members show more interest in a stranger in the meeting. Twelfth Steppers now try to get a new person to a meeting. More members are willing to hold office and work. It's easier to get speakers. Collections are better. There seems to be more unity. There is better attendance at Intergroup business meetings. More members are willing to serve. —Johnny H.

NORTH DAKOTA — Group isolation is our Number One problem, caused by distance and travel time. We hope Area meetings will improve this situation. We are suggesting that secretaries and G.S.R.'s plan a sharing session in conjunction with social events such as Group anniversary dinners or special meetings. Our A.A. horizons have widened considerably since our own R. Fay B. was elected to the Board. —Milly I.

OHIO (Northeastern) — MICHIGAN (Southeastern) — What are principles? Webster says, "rules of morality." What is a personality? Webster says, "Distinctive personal character — individuality as no two of us are alike." What are the A.A. principles? They are Twelve Steps of recovery, Twelve Traditions of unity, Twelve Concepts of service. This will eliminate the character defects that cause frictions, unhappiness, discontent, intolerance, and even the bleeding deacons in our Groups. —Elmer L.

OHIO (Southwestern) — KENTUCKY (Northern) — We have had many cases where Groups elected their G.S.R.'s through a volunteer method: is anybody willing to be it this time? But an interesting change is taking place, thanks to the phrase, "I am responsible." We now see young people showing up as G.S.R.'s, and they make an honest effort to report to their Groups. Along with this enthusiasm comes a new problem. These G.S.R.'s begin to wonder what they are supposed to do. Is it possible to put a G.S.R. section in the *Exchange Bulletin*? —Bill J.

Area Highlights

ONTARIO (Western) — Great stress is placed on the G.S.R.'s being kept informed of all General Service activities and keeping his Group informed. Committee Members are urged to hold regular G.S.R. meetings and to make them interesting and informative. Assemblies are held each spring and fall, attended by Committee Members, G.S.R.'s and chairmen of special committees (P.I., Institutions, etc.). The annual Western Ontario Conference has been held for 13 years in London. —Clare G.

OREGON — In 1959 our Groups adopted the Third Legacy procedure. Committee officers are elected to serve one-year terms, after having served at least one year as members. Last year, A.A. history in Oregon was put into booklet form. Over 60 copies of *The Oregon A.A. Newsletter*, a monthly publication, are distributed monthly. The film, "Wisdom to Know the Difference," was shown at a public meeting; 170 people in attendance, 40 of them non-A.A.'s. —Ed D.

PUERTO RICO — During the past year in P.R., an Intergroup office was established. A Thanksgiving dinner held for all Groups was successful. The annual A.A. convention was held at Fajardo, with representatives from all Groups. During the year four new Groups were formed. Over 100 new members joined. Doctors, priests, ministers, social workers and the government Alcoholism Information Center became very much interested and referred all cases to various Groups. —Guillermo C.

QUEBEC (English-Speaking) — We the English-speaking are primarily from the Metropolitan Area and have very few Groups outside. I don't believe we are letting ourselves become known as well as we should. A few years ago we had a spot on radio once a week. For some reason it stopped, though the response was good. We intend to try this again. I believe we should let A.A. become known through every media possible. I believe we should hold more open meetings. —Belle H.

QUEBEC (French-Speaking) — We have 265 Groups, mostly French-speaking, an increase of 100 in two years. We owe this to the sponsorship of English Groups, the translating into French of A.A. Conference-approved literature, G.S.O. service material and film strips, and the French magazine, *La Vigne A.A.* In the past year we have had six G.S. meetings, three Sharing Sessions, information meetings on every branch of service, and our Provincial Bilingual Conference. —Teles B.

RHODE ISLAND — In 30 eventful years I finally wound up a lush in a plush suite in this very hotel, on the very floor I'm now living on. But here I am now, a very grateful Delegate from Rhode Island. We have 28 Groups, about 400 members. We too have our confusions, and if we don't know the answers, we know where to find them — here at G.S.O. We have a Central Office, paid secretary, telephone answering service, and a P.I.C. We cover prisons and all other institutions. —Hiram L.

SASKATCHEWAN — Saskatchewan is 220,000 square miles, which makes communication difficult. Four years ago we decided to operate within the suggestions laid down in the THIRD LEGACY MANUAL. Principles are now in the forefront and our Committee is functioning smoothly. The province is divided into eleven Areas. After quarterly meetings, Committee Members call meetings of their G.S.R.'s who pass information to their Groups. —E.A.L.

SOUTH CAROLINA — South Carolina schools have alcohol education as a mandatory part of the curriculum. A.A. members, doctors, nurses and others are invited to speak. Many boys and girls after hearing my story ask how they can get their parents to join A.A. Today many of our hospitals and doctors are ac-

cepting the alcoholic as a sick person. We have a Rehabilitation Center and an Alcoholic Information Center. Not only is the alcoholic reached, his family is also. —"Squire" J.

SOUTH DAKOTA — In 1948, I was trying to hang onto sobriety. I found myself borrowing many thoughts, beliefs and suggestions from other people. One of these was a dear friend, Tommy. He first acquainted me with the Traditions. Last Saturday, at a state hospital, I met Tommy again. He had "graduated" from A.A. after five years, and finally wound up in Chicago, eventually at the state hospital in South Dakota. I know this: I owe him, Bill W., and thousands of others, for the part of each one that has become a part of me. —Marty C.

TENNESSEE — Tennessee has recently set up a division on Alcoholism of the State Mental Health Department. Many A.A.'s, acting as individual recovered alcoholics, not A.A. members, were active in getting it. Councils on Alcoholism are now functioning in Memphis, Jackson, and Chattanooga. Many A.A.'s as individuals helped create these Councils. Information Centers are referring clients to A.A. Groups, and A.A. is growing in these cities. —Ray D.

TEXAS (Northwest) — Our Area (350 by 400 miles) has been organized into four districts. Two Committee meetings have been held. The "Roundrobin" (Sunday p.m. meetings once a month) are held twice a year in each of six towns. The 18th annual Top O'Texas A.A. Roundup at Amarillo was a huge success; the 4th annual El Paso Jamboree was excellent, with about 210 paid registrations. —Joe C.

TEXAS (Southwest) — At a meeting of G.S.R.'s in March the conference agenda was our workshop agenda. All took active part, and the Delegate feels he got the thinking of the membership. Many say they for the first time learned what G.S.O. was all about, what it did, and why money is needed. It made them realize we are all *really a part of G.S.O.* Nine new Groups are being formed in the area. There has been good cooperation between A.A. and other agencies, and full compliance with the Tradition of keeping A.A. out of these activities, but members individually give time, services and money. —Phillip S.

VERMONT — Winooski is an Indian Chief's name and it means "onion" and I stink too. Bill left Vermont and I'm transplanted from Western Mass. I thought there wasn't any booze in the hills, but soon found out Bill didn't take it with him. Vermont is a conservative state; since the Interstate Highway system started in 1950, we now have 60 miles completed. A.A. is progressing at the same speed. I'm not proud like you people. I've heard wonderful success stories this week. —Lee B.

WISCONSIN (Northern) — MICHIGAN (Upper) — There was a time when I believed we couldn't force an alcoholic to go to A.A. — it just wouldn't work. I have come to see that opinion is not in keeping with the facts. I have seen alcoholics forced or pressured into A.A. and make it. At one of our meetings, only two of 22 members had requested help. We can raise the bottom through knowledge, encouragement and understanding. —Bert C.

WYOMING — Being a lone member in 1948 was really frightening. The closest other members were 110 miles away. My old boozing friends thought I was a nut, because I staggered for 10 months after I quit drinking. The one thing that helped me most was the *World Directory*. People going through our town would call on me, and I visited meetings. My good wife, Bessie, to whom I have been married for 47 years, and our two sons all worked the program as a family deal. So I know a Loner, furnished with A.A. tools, can make it. —Ben B.

Conference Action

Who is Responsible For Helping A.A. Grow in Small Communities?

To help A.A. grow in small and rural communities both local Area G.S. Committees and G.S.O. should try to furnish specific services in addition to those already provided, the 16th Confer-

ence suggested.

Many concrete ways in which this can be done were pointed out in the Presentation and Discussion on the subject.

PRESENTATION

First Loner, first Group

G.S.O. encourages Loners to start Groups, and helps new Groups through literature and correspondence. When advice is sought or questions asked every effort is made to make suggestions and share the experience of successful Groups. The most frequent question from small communities is how one can make the availability of A.A. known and still remain anonymous. There are also requests for material for newspapers, radio and television as aids in carrying the message.

The most encouraging thing an A.A. who is faced with the problem of trying to start a Group, or hold together a small struggling Group, can do is to reread the Big Book—particularly the chapter, "A Vision for You." Once again we are reminded that Bill W. was the first lone member of A.A. It was his need for another alcoholic that eventually led him to Dr. Bob, and then there were two, and so A.A. grew.

There is much material at G.S.O. available to help "carry the message." A new pamphlet, "Alcoholics Anonymous in your

Community," can be of inestimable value to a crossroads in Manhattan or an isolated hamlet in British Columbia. This pamphlet was designed to give information to non-A.A.'s in the community about A.A. and just what it is, what may be expected of the Fellowship, and what A.A. does not do.

It could be mailed to every doctor, clergyman, social worker, and anyone else in the community who might contact alcoholics. Attached to this could be a printed or mimeographed list of meeting times and places in the state or county. Above all some form of local A.A. contact should be available. Perhaps a P.O. Box number or a telephone answering service.

Material is available at G.S.O. for suggested editorial pieces in local newspapers, as well as radio and television material. Here again, it is important to provide a local contact, keeping within the tradition of anonymity, of course.

—Midge M., G.S.O. Staff.

Rural A.A. in Washington

White Salmon, with a population of 1,590, had no A.A. when Shorty arrived in 1957, so he soon contacted G.S.O. and became a Loner. As a result of his experiences in getting a Group started and keeping it going, Shorty became convinced that small communities need special help that should come in part from G.S.O. through pamphlets and other means, and help might also come from Area Assemblies and Regional conferences through special workshops on the subject.

Shorty has been active during the years and we credit him with this subject being discussed at this Conference.

In the beginning, there must be a way for the sick alcoholic to get in touch with A.A. Therefore, the A.A. member must be willing to sacrifice his anonymity by notifying clergymen, doctors, judges and other law enforcement people that he as a member of A.A. is available, and how he can be reached. There is certainly precedent for this when we remember how Bill W. originally contacted Dr. Bob through a clergyman. Yet at the same time, the new man must feel that his anonymity will be preserved.

Okay, now we have a Group, and we must find a way to make it live and grow. Every guy or gal who is keeping a Group alive in a small town stresses: *Have a regular meeting place and*

time each week. Keep at least one person at that meeting each and every week.

Some of the biggest difficulties concern how to let the people in the community know help is available. Here are a few suggestions:

1. A box number in the daily or weekly paper. (The problem here is mostly the delay in getting the 12th Step call.)
2. Telephone listing. (Use your own telephone number in an ad in the paper and pretty soon all anonymity goes.)
3. Use a friend's telephone number in an ad, one who would make a referral, is not an alcoholic, but is sympathetic. This is an idea that has not been tried.
4. Put a notice in a church bulletin.
5. Write a letter to the editor of the local paper.

Everybody in a small town reads these.

Part of the solution lies in the hands of the Area Committee. I think the biggest link in this whole chain is the Committee-man. In our Districts where small-town A.A. flourishes, there are active Committeemen. Again, we see the need of a person accepting the responsibility that goes with it when he accepts a job, whether it be G.S.R., Committee Member, or Group Secretary.

—Eric B., Washington.

Smalltown, Mo., A.A.

My home Group the past six years has grown from three members to 16. Our county has around 10,000 population, our town around 2,000, so you see we fit in the small-town classification. I have contacted many small town Groups and members to get a cross-section of views, so let's consider two problems that beset a Group in Smalltown, U.S.A.

Problem #1 seems to be not enough meetings, particularly for the newcomer, and not enough Twelfth Step calls to keep the Group perked up. Many Groups have only one closed meeting per month. Small Groups have difficulty in maintaining a variety of meetings, and are lax in planning meetings. One person said, "We have all heard each other's story and version of the Twelve Steps so many times that we each know exactly just

what he is going to say."

Problem #2 exists in all small communities. *There is a much closer personal relationship with the entire community.* Our lives are pretty much an open book, and I do not consider malicious gossip to be a factor of any importance.

Our friends in Smalltown lack knowledge of what we are trying to do for ourselves and for the alcoholic that still suffers. Our friends are not at fault. LET'S TELL THEM WHAT WE ARE TRYING TO DO. LET'S TELL THEM HOW WE ARE TRYING TO DO IT. LET'S ENLIST THEIR HELP. LET'S THROW OUT SOME A.A. LOVE TO THE COMMUNITY AND WE WILL REAP BACK LOVE.

—Keet R., Missouri.

Isolated Ontario Groups

One of the major problems in getting a Group started in a small community is the lack of someone who will assume responsibility. Which brings to my mind one village where a businessman was having some success in staying sober with the Big Book only. In 1964 an active member moved from Sudbury to this community and contacted the parish priest to see if he knew of any other member, or anyone who had a drinking problem seeking help.

The priest arranged for these two to meet and this was the beginning of a Group. In December, I received a call asking what our Committee could do to help. They had four members. They were sent information on how to arrange a meeting open

to the public and in December, such a meeting was held. The Group is still active.

We can encourage exchange visits between isolated Groups. I can remember very well when we only had one group in Sudbury and the nearest Group was North Bay, 82 miles away. How it would perk us up to have a traveler drop in, or exchange a meeting with North Bay! We sent out invitations for Group anniversaries or anyone having an A.A. birthday. In doing this we were sharing, giving, participating and endeavouring to discharge the responsibility everyone in A.A. owes to himself and the suffering alcoholic.

—Garfield K., Ontario.

Arkansas Groups

Regular visits from members of larger Groups give an added attraction and spur activity in small communities. And the problem (if any) of anonymity for the small community member is of no real consequence... as everyone in a small community is known; that he is a member of A.A.; that he is an alcoholic; that he attends meetings, and all of just what is going on.

We feel that G.S.O. has well served our Group. We are in constant contact, and receive news of world-wide A.A. activities and program arrangements or suggestive aids. This is a real

boon to our Group and to the smaller community that helps enlarge a member's or Group's potential interests.

Several years ago, we in Arkansas set up an Intergroup activity (named the "Grand Prairie Groups") consisting of some 12 or 15 Groups. A member-host Group of the Grand Prairie Fellowship takes turn each three-month period in presenting a dinner and a special speaker. These bring forth some 200 to 300 smaller Group members every three months, and serve to cement fellowship among A.A. members and their families and friends.

—Hollis A., Arkansas.

REPORT

630 Loners helped by G.S.O. and sponsors

Over one-half of our 630 known Loners live outside the U.S. and Canada; 116 are Spanish-speaking.

Many have never attended a meeting. They found their way to A.A. through a piece of literature, or the suggestion of a doctor or clergyman, and wrote to P.O. Box 459.

Many of them maintain sobriety under very difficult conditions... such as the twelve Loners in Viet Nam, unable to contact one another.

A new Loner receives a letter with "Suggestions for the Lone Member," a package of literature, a *World Directory* and the list of Loners. He is encouraged to write to other Loners as well as to correspond with G.S.O. Each Loner receives bi-monthly, with

the *Exchange Bulletin*, the *Loners Meeting* — a two-page bulletin we prepare using excerpts from Loners' letters.

We have a Loner-Sponsor list of nearly 300 Group members who sponsor via mail. Each time Loners are mentioned in the *Exchange Bulletin* many members want to join the Loners Group, or become Loner-Sponsors.

For some A.A.'s there seems to be an emotional as well as a geographic aloneness. Some seem quite content, and do not make any effort to form a Group. But every effort is made to help them "carry the message" if the opportunity arises. Many flourishing Groups today were originally started by one Lone Member.

—Midge M., G.S.O. Staff.

REPORT

Group Services at New Peak

Service to Groups is our first consideration. Groups write about perplexing problems; each one is carefully researched and individually answered with the shared experience of other Groups. Each new Group receives a letter of welcome and free literature as soon as it becomes known to us and is also put on the mailing list to receive the *Exchange Bulletin* and other G.S.O. mailings.

A mailing list of over 16,000, including U.S., Canadian, and overseas Groups, prison and hospital Groups, Central Offices, Lone Members, and Internationalists, makes a sizable correspondence for each of the six Staff Members. During the past year we were ably helped by secretaries who composed letters without full dictation.

Service material and lists are checked, updated and rewritten constantly. The Staff is always alert for ways to improve our services and we welcome your suggestions.

Staff Members visited 30 areas in 1965, participating in state and regional gatherings. This gives us an opportunity to visit with a great many A.A.'s and to learn firsthand of A.A. growth and problems. Each Staff Member brings back much information to share after each visit.

Since sharing is most important at G.S.O., Staff Members read all correspondence which circulates in daily folders. The Staff meets together weekly and a new piece of service material or a new form letter may result from their discussions. Whatever the problem, we all gain by the experience and ideas of others. We work through the group conscience.

More than one thousand A.A.'s, their families, and friends visited G.S.O. in 1965. We hope all members will visit us whenever possible.

—Midge M., G.S.O. Co-ordinator, Group Services.

ASK-IT BASKET

Q. Can an A.A. member belong to more than one Group if he desires?

A. Questioner was referred to the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group" (Page 31). When this question was asked in the

Exchange Bulletin, most who wrote in believed a member should belong to only one Group.

Q. Any objection to raffling A.A. items not approved by the Conference?

A. Sense of the meeting was that this is a matter for local autonomy.

Q. What is a Group?

A. Questioner was referred to Page 3 of the *World Directory*.

Q. There seems to be quite a difference around the country as to what an "open meeting" is. In our Area it means we can bring anyone interested in A.A. In other Areas, it seems to be limited to wives and relatives. Does G.S.O. have a definition? What is experience around country?

A. Discussion of an "open meeting" and kinds of meeting programs can be found in "The A.A. Group."

Q. When will program of sending literature and correspondence to G.S.R. for Groups be put into effect?

A. This is being done right now, as the 1965 Conference recommended, if we have the G.S.R.'s name and address. G.S.R.'s have now become the mail contact for about 50% of the Groups.

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REPORT

'Exchange Bulletin' reaches 12,000 Groups

The *Exchange Bulletin* really began in November, 1940, when the first "service bulletin" was mailed out from New York. There were then only 50 Groups to receive it.

In 1956, at the direction of the Conference, many different service bulletins were combined into one and the present name was chosen.

The *Exchange Bulletin* shares worldwide A.A. news with all Groups. The present mailing list is 16,000, including individual subscribers and 12,000 Groups. Bulk rates for Group subscriptions are available.

Items for the *Bulletin* are submitted by all Staff Members. The editor relies heavily on correspondence received from members and Groups.

The *Bulletin* strives to keep the membership informed about news of A.A. events around the world; trends in A.A.; current news about Public Information, Institutions, Loners and Internationalists; information about new literature; Group problems and activities; reports on service structure, the Conference, and A.A.'s finances; and coming attractions in the Grapevine.

—BETH K., G.S.O. Staff.

Interview Time

How Groups use 'Exchange Bulletin'

"How do your Groups arrange for individual members to read the *Exchange Bulletin*?" Delegates were asked in Interview Time. Here is a summary of the ideas recorded:

1. Delegate makes sure each Group has bulk subscriptions so there is a copy for each member.
2. Distribute on literature table (Group has bulk subscription) with other A.A. literature.

3. Post on bulletin board.
4. Discuss contents at meetings.
5. Read aloud to Groups.
6. Discuss it at Assemblies.
7. Special meetings to discuss it.
8. Chairman, Secretary, or G.S.R. make special announcement about one item in each issue.
9. Use in Sharing Sessions.

REPORT

A.A.W.S. handles 250,000 pieces of 12th Step mail

PUBLISHING: Publishing sales fell behind in the first seven months of 1965 while the last five months showed normal gain. For the year, sales were 2.7% below 1964. The publishing operation paid its own share of overhead and contributed \$41,000 to the General Fund where it was used to pay the cost of other services.

In 1965, A.A.W.S. authorized free distribution of 99,270 pieces of literature with an actual value of \$3,650, plus shipping costs. It went to new Groups and to the public as part of our information service. Of this, \$750 worth was in non-English literature and the balance was in English.

SHIPPING: This department is the first to feel the extra work that a growing fellowship involves. Last year, the Shipping Department again carried a record load. Al Cryan, supervisor, directed 7 full-time and 3 part-time men in the handling of 82,866 incoming letters and 83,745 outgoing. Bulletins (*Exchange*, *Loners*, *Round Robin*, etc.) brought outgoing mail up to nearly a quarter of a million pieces.

Book and pamphlet orders (and *Directory* mailings) accounted for 37,793 packages, shipped to all parts of the A.A. world. An important part of this department's work is the maintenance of the address-stencil file — now in excess of 20,000. Mimeograph work is completed in this department — last year to the tune of 850,000 copies.

CLERICAL/STENO: Kleina Jones has 14 girls in her department. Eight girls, two of them Spanish translators, handle steno and transcription. Two work in the file unit and there are also the receptionist, the switchboard operator and clerk-typist.

A new procedure for answering correspondence not requiring detailed explanation was established. The Steno girls have written over 1,000 letters regarding orders, contribution information, routing of films, tapes, etc., thus relieving Staff Members of some routine matters and allowing them to concentrate on more important correspondence.

(continued on page 21)

(continued from page 20)

ACCOUNTING: Supervised by Dennis Manders and ably assisted by Charlie Columbia and a crew of four, this department has effected a considerable change-over in systems in the past year. In line with the Monthly Contribution Plan, all Groups are notified on a quarterly basis the total of their contributions. During 1965, 13,300 contributions were received and recorded and 11,685 orders were processed for shipment.

RECORDS: The Records Department continues to grow to meet the demands of a larger fellowship. Today it has five full-time

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ASK-IT BASKET

- Q. What percentage of our G.S.O. employees are alcoholics?
- A. Eleven out of 52, or 20%, and no suspects.

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Conference Action

Conference Authorizes New 'Bill' Book, and Beginners' Meeting Pamphlet

A new hard-cover book containing excerpts from Bill's letters, books, Grapevine articles and other writings, will be published by A.A.W.S., the 16th Conference decided by approving the recommendation of its Literature Committee (Ray F., Nevada, chairman). Its title will probably be something like **THE A.A. READER, or SELECTED WRITINGS BY BILL.**

Also authorized was publication of a new pamphlet, "Guide for Leading Newcomers' Meetings." In addition, the Conference urged further development of a "cartoon" format for some A.A.

employees including Rose Failla, its new and competent supervisor. An additional burden has been the change-over to the G.S.R. as the mail contact for G.S.O. Group Information cards returned show the G.S.R.'s name in about 50% of the cases.

The Department also maintains many special mailing lists such as: Loners, Internationalists, Armed Forces Groups, Spanish-speaking Groups, etc. This year we set up a second Varityper to help with the job of publishing the *World Directory* and two *Institutional Directories*.

— HERB M., Chairman, A.A. World Services, Inc.

REPORT

460 tapes distributed

1. During 1965, 460 tapes were sold. In 1964, 399.
2. G.S.O. has eight tape recordings available at \$2.50 apiece. Each is a 7-inch, 2-track, 3¼ speed tape. A side does not exceed one hour.

We plan to add three more tapes soon.

—BETH K., G.S.O. Staff

PRESENTATION

Purpose and story of A.A. literature

A.A. literature plays a vastly important role in A.A.'s Twelfth Step work around the world. Bill started it all by giving us the Big Book in 1939. By the time the new edition of the Big Book was ready in 1955, A.A. literature had become essential in Group activities and in the growth of the Fellowship.

The first pamphlet, issued in 1944, was spoken of as a "door opener." That is, the pamphlet slid under the door, and the door opened for the entrance of the Big Book.

TWELVE STEPS AND TWELVE TRADITIONS was published in 1953. It was written to fill the need for the fuller sharing of experience in Recovery and Unity—experience which up to then had been covered only in the Big Book and in our pamphlets.

Some day Bill had hoped to write the full history of A.A. But by 1955, A.A.'s 20th Anniversary Year, he had come to feel that it was too big a project for him, and perhaps it might be best for some objective historian to tackle the job.

A.A. COMES OF AGE was the logical result of these decisions. It records, as of 1957, essential points of history—points that might be inaccurately portrayed at some later date. And it marks the St. Louis Convention as a historical one, the scene of the co-founder's turning over, and the Fellowship's acceptance of, the Third Legacy of Service through the General Service Conference. This accounts for the special format of **A.A. COMES OF AGE** and it is our only history book. It is well indexed, answers any question on historical events, people, and places.

Suggestions for new pamphlets usually come to the Staff. A good many pamphlets we currently publish have come as suggestions from Delegates.

literature in the hope it will reach alcoholics who cannot read well or those who just don't read much at all.

(Don R., member of the Trustees' International Committee, was thanked for his presentation on this subject. His committee feels such a format would be well received in some non-English-speaking countries.)

Phillip S., Texas, was elected new chairman of the Conference Literature Committee.

For instance, Groups in prisons were coming along more rapidly than anyone expected. Many Delegates were working with institutions and others had great interest in what was happening in this phase of A.A. In the beginning, only outside sponsors carried meetings into prisons. In a short time, it was proved that inmates in many prisons could handle their own meetings with minimum help from visitors.

We had mimeographed material for these Groups. And then the pamphlet "Correctional Officials Evaluate A.A." sometimes opened the door of correctional institutions to A.A., but gave no help on forming and conducting a Group in these facilities. It served a purpose, but it contained little more than some "pats on the back" for A.A.

We gave sponsors and members more to go on with the new pamphlet, "A.A. in Prisons." It took the following route before completion:

1. Need discussed by Staff.
 2. Some A.A.'s active in institutional work were consulted as to need, and contents of such a pamphlet.
 3. Taken to, and discussed by Directors of A.A.W.S. for need (it is their responsibility to run our publishing company).
 4. To the Trustees' Literature Committee.
 5. Then to the Literature Committee of the Conference.
 6. Need for established, and a writer assigned.
 7. Drafts then went back through the same channels.
 8. When final draft was approved and pamphlet printed, it was priced by A.A.W.S., everyone was notified and it was then listed on the Order Blank.
- (continued on page 22)

HOW REVISIONS COME ABOUT

Hardly before a newly printed pamphlet gets into distribution, suggested revisions are coming in from Delegates and Literature Committee members — things we all missed in the drafts.

Any pamphlet is open to discussion, and it seems the one that got the most discussion was "Tranquillizers, Sedatives and the Alcoholic." The Trustees' Literature Committee felt that a new look should be taken at A.A.'s position on medication as it was portrayed in the pamphlet. Dr. Norris appointed a committee of three A.A. doctors. They actually wrote the pamphlet, working together with the Literature Committee to prepare "Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic."

Non-Conference-approved literature has served a purpose from way back. It was prepared because it was originally needed in a Group or area. It is not the business of G.S.O. to censor non-Conference-approved literature, or to tell a Group what kind of literature to use.

What is Conference-approved literature? (a) it is literature (books and pamphlets) written to fill an overall A.A. need; (b) it is approved by the Fellowship through the Conference Structure; (c) it insures a consistent interpretation of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions.

What does the General Service Conference "Seal" mean? Conference and Trustees' Literature Committees have carefully gone over every draft of the pamphlet before giving approval.

—Waneta N., G.S.O. Staff.

What books and pamphlets Groups use, and how

(Survey made by Delegates)

REPORT

LITERATURE DISTRIBUTED — 1965

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	29,900
Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions (Reg. Edition)	10,935
Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions (Gift Edition)	3,831
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	3,299
30th Anniversary Book — A.A./30.	1,468
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish Edition.	813
Total	50,246

PAMPHLETS

This Is A.A.	117,367
44 Questions & Answers.	96,523
Is A.A. For You?	136,633
Partners in A.A. (discontinued)	14,413
Young People in A.A.	42,049
A.A. For The Woman	42,927
Memo to an Inmate.	28,277
A.A. in Prisons	15,065
Questions & Answers on Sponsorship	27,323
Alcoholism the Illness.	56,832
The Alcoholic Husband	58,977
The Alcoholic Wife	35,832
A.A. & The Alcoholic Employee.	28,544
A.A. & The Medical Profession	27,254
Sedatives, Stimulants & The Alcoholic	59,140
A.A. Tradition — How it Developed	19,061
A.A. — Helpful Ally in Coping with Alcoholism.	49,908
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	31,721
Fortune Reprint	22,313
Good Housekeeping Reprint	34,957
The Third Legacy Manual & Concepts.	2,305
Inside A.A.	16,578
The Fellowship of A.A.	55,517
G.S.R. Folder.	16,068
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	24,147
The A.A. Group (new)	9,937
A.A. in Hospitals (new)	2,223
Foreign Translations.	52,800
Total	1,123,691

MISCELLANEOUS

Tapes of A.A. Talks	459
Wallet Cards — 2 Fold	210,770
Wallet Cards — "I Am Responsible".	35,514
Parchment Scrolls.	1,521
How it Works	52,757

Last Fall Delegates were asked to cooperate in a study of Group use of literature, both Conference-approved and other. So far, 400 Groups have been heard from out of 9,000. There have been no reports from 22 states and 3 provinces.

Four hundred Groups are hardly enough for anchoring any broad conclusions, but the information, even within its present limits, can prove useful.

For example, we learn that 88% of these Groups order books or pamphlets or both from New York, direct or through their Central Offices. Nearly four out of ten Groups take advantage of the discount package to get books and pamphlets cheaper.

Nine out of ten Groups display books and pamphlets on a literature table or up front on the speakers' table. Seven out of ten use literature in their discussion meeting programs.

BOOKS. As might be expected, most Groups have the Big Book available. Nine out of ten have this on hand regularly. A lesser number (84%) have **TWELVE AND TWELVE** and only 66%, **A.A. COMES OF AGE**.

Groups were asked how they introduced newcomers to the Big Book and the replies were significant. Better than four out of ten sell the Big Book to new people, about one-quarter of these on an installment basis. Another four out of ten loan the Big Book to the "pigeon". Only one out of ten made an outright gift of the Big Book, whether on a Group or personal basis we do not know.

Raffles for the Big Book are held by nearly two out of ten.

PAMPHLETS. Distribution of Conference-approved pamphlets runs considerably below book distribution. For example, the most popular pamphlets are "This is A.A.," "Is A.A. for You?" and "44 Questions." Yet these were carried by only four Groups out of ten. However, two to four Groups out of ten distribute the next nineteen most popular pamphlets.

The remaining thirteen pamphlets could be found at the meetings of fewer than two Groups out of ten.

Do Groups charge for pamphlets? Twenty-three Groups said "yes" — or 6% of those answering the question.

Do Groups display pamphlets? Better than nine out of ten do — on a literature table or up front on the speakers' table.

Comments on Conference-approved literature were uniformly laudatory. They ran from "good" to "indispensable." The majority of those commenting stressed the importance of sound literature in working with new people.

OTHER THAN CONFERENCE-APPROVED. Seven items appeared most frequently in Groups' replies. These had distribution ranging from 24% to 2% of Groups reporting:

24%	distributed	"Twenty Four Hours a Day"
17%	"	"Little Red Book"
7%	"	"Who — Me"
5%	"	"Stools and Bottles"
4%	"	"A Guide to Twelve Steps"
2%	"	"Just for Today"
2%	"	"Upper Room"

THE LESSON. What can we learn from the reports of these 400 Groups? First, we must bear in mind that these 400 volunteered to fill out the questionnaire. They may represent Group

who are more active in literature distribution than the average, and may not be in any way typical of Groups across the U.S. and Canada.

But whether these Groups are typical or not, we find in literature distribution our old problem of *communication*. No Groups carry all the pamphlets available; few Groups have even seen all the pamphlets.

So Groups will know what is available, we send out descriptive order forms twice a year. We review new pamphlets and older pamphlets in the *Exchange Bulletin*. All this helps. We changed the format of the Order form to emphasize new books and pamphlets. This is not for the purpose of pressuring Groups into buying — but in making sure that they *know* what help is available in their Twelfth Step work and in their relations with their communities.

Perhaps more urgent measures should be taken to keep Groups informed. If Delegates think so, I hope they will express it.

PUBLISHING. Our whole publishing activity is a most important one. First, because it carries the message of A.A. in a consistent, accurate manner year after year. Second, because publishing net is important to the support of other services to Groups. This year, publishing will carry its share of overhead and will, in addition, contribute 12% or better to the service budget.

It is very important that we keep a close watch on this activity. To insure that its growth follows the growth of the Fellowship and to insure the right kind of communication with Groups all over the world. For this is truly the voice of A.A.

—Herb M., G.S.O. Staff

Pamphlet for nurses?

Pamphlets can be sent through the mail when it is impossible to have other types of inter-action with people basically interested in alcoholism. They are used widely by educators. When a speaker or a film is used, distribution of pamphlets at the closing of the meeting always relays a parting word which can be carried home and studied at leisure. Many people who have a personal interest in alcoholism are somewhat shy in meetings and often do not ask questions that need answering. For this reason, pamphlets fill a real need.

Pamphlets reach the hidden alcoholic who would not otherwise attend meetings, and can be used for bulletin boards and displays. Copies tend to disappear before the meeting is over.

In my work as a Health Educator at Jacksonville State Hospital, I have many requests — not so much from professional and business people, but mostly from school children and college students. There seems to be a lot of interest in this area

and Alcoholics Anonymous. Many theses and other school papers are written in this area. Clergymen show the most interest.

During Mental Health Week each May, we have Open House for all State Mental Institutions. I have material available not only from the Division of Alcoholism, but also from the Alcoholics Anonymous Groups of my area. I find most of the pamphlets are used, and the ones picked up mostly are Alcoholics Anonymous contributions to the problem of alcoholism.

I think one area we possibly could cover more with literature is nursing. We have on an average of 60 to 80 student nurses every three months, and it is gratifying to see the interest they take in alcoholism and especially in Alcoholics Anonymous. They become active in our open meetings in the hospital. They are hungry for information on A.A., and I have no material outside of "44 Questions and Answers" I can give to these girls. Possibly we could have a pamphlet directed to this area.

—Wes J., Illinois.

Literature truly attracts

With past Delegates and G.S.R.'s I have discussed the use of Conference-approved literature to carry A.A.'s message whether it be to the individual, Group or public, so the true image of what A.A. is and A.A. stands for cannot be misconstrued.

The Trustees' Committee on literature and staff handling literature have done a tremendous job fulfilling needs to date.

We have asked for and received literature that would attract

rather than promote. Would you not agree that our pamphlets are truly attractive and eye appealing?

But this is only the frosting on the cake. The true attraction is the message of sincerity, love and understanding for our fellow man who reaches for the extended hands of A.A.'s all over this world.

—Clarence T., Wisconsin.

Meetings in print

A few years back the theme of the conference was "Communication" and I believe it was decided then that the written word is one of our strongest and most effective means.

It is in many instances the sole pipeline for the Loner and the real grass roots of our Fellowship.

A meeting in print is of paramount value in keeping our First Tradition, and invaluable to the new comer.

I am speaking, of course, of Conference-approved literature which insures a balanced and consistent interpretation of the A.A. program.

In traveling around, I found that each Group had a different method of distributing literature. From the great variety of displays I saw, and from many conversations with elected Group servants, I found that in general most Groups follow the same procedure in handling literature.

Discount packages are frequently ordered. This seems to me a great boon for institutional A.A., for new Groups and particu-

larly for gifts. Most Groups I visited keep the Big Book, A.A. COMES OF AGE, and TWELVE STEPS AND TWELVE TRADITIONS on hand at all times. The books are frequently used as part of the meeting and especially in discussion meetings. Grapevine subscriptions are given after certain periods of sobriety.

In most places pamphlets are displayed on a rack, or at the speakers' table, and, of course, are free for the asking, either for personal use, or as a aid in making a Twelfth Step call.

In a majority of districts it has become the policy not only to introduce the newcomer to God at an early stage, but to indoctrinate him into our literary wealth as well.

Our literature, next to the administration of our General Services, is the most important way of carrying the message, and the responsibility for this lies on our shoulders.

—Jim H., Alabama.

The miracles we see

For 30 years A.A. has proved beyond a doubt that our most valuable credentials are *success*. Have we not seen the wholesale recovery of our sick and defeated brothers and sisters?

I do not consider myself a religious person. However, since I have become sober, it has been my privilege to read about the many wonderful miracles performed by Christ. How He made the blind to see and the lame to walk, and cured the awful disease

of leprosy. How wonderful it would have been to have lived and witnessed these great acts of mercy.

May the gift of the Lord's Prayer be considered Conference-approved material! By the Grace of God we have seen wholesale miracles become a reality through our beloved Fellowship. I am conscious of this as I see you Delegates.

—Earl F., Virginia.

REPORT

Two new pamphlets and new ideas on A.A. literature

The Literature Committee of the Board has in 1965/66:

1. Completed and distributed two new pamphlets: "A.A. in Hospitals" and "The A.A. Group."
2. Referred to the Public Information Committee the pamphlet "A.A. in Your Community," to replace "Helpful Ally."
3. Decided not to publish a pamphlet on "Psychotherapy and Alcoholism."
4. Reviewed manuscripts of two non-A.A. pamphlets for the semi-literate. It was felt, however, that such material might carry the message of A.A. The Conference Literature Committee has been asked: (a) Should we consider picture or cartoon formats, such as those used in Canada, for A.A. literature? (b) Should a simpler type of prose-and-illustration be explored for alcoholics who cannot read well, and also for those who just don't read?
5. Agreed with the Policy Committee that the "Preamble" should be revised and referred it to the Conference Literature Committee.

6. Agreed with the suggestion that an "Omnibus" General Service pamphlet, using material from existing pamphlets and filmstrips, be prepared.
 7. Studied "Dependence on Barbiturates and other Sedative Drugs" from the *Journal of the American Medical Association*. One paragraph was referred to the Conference Literature Committee for the "Sedative" pamphlet.
 8. Turned down a request that we publish Chapter Five of the Big Book as a booklet. It might retard readership of the Big Book, rather than aid it.
 9. Studied again the suggestion that "A Guide for Conducting Newcomers' Meetings" be published. Appointed a task force to study material available.
 10. Authorized research on material and format for a hard cover book containing excerpts from Bill's writings.
 11. Appointed Murray W. co-chairman of the Trustees' Literature Committee.
- Austin MacCormick (Class A)
Chairman, General Service Board Literature Committee.

Interview Time

Suggestions for getting A.A.'s to read A.A. literature

"How are members in your Area encouraged to read A.A. books and pamphlets?" G.S.O. Staff asked Delegates during Interview Time. Here are some of the answers they gave:

1. Display pamphlets in literature racks purchased from G.S.O.
2. Pamphlets given free to all members.
3. Chairman announces availability of literature at each meeting.
4. One pamphlet discussed at each meeting.
5. A.A. books and a Grapevine description raffled.
6. Donate A.A. literature to lending libraries.
7. Each member of the Group gets a copy of each new pamphlet published.

8. Given free to each newcomer.

9. New A.A. literature discussed at Assemblies, so G.S.R.'s can tell Groups.

10. Pamphlets and Big Book always taken on 12th Step call.

11. Distribute pamphlets to clergy, police, hospitals, prisons.

12. Keep good supplies of literature at home, each member is advised.

13. One member is Librarian of each Group, to be sure there is always enough literature on hand and to encourage reading.

14. Delegates make special announcements on new literature.

15. Talk about new literature in Group bulletins and newsletters.

Conference Action

Conference Asks for More Services to Central (Intergroup) Offices

New monthly "information sheets" on local Intergroup (or Central) office activities will be compiled and mailed monthly by G.S.O., and one G.S.O. Staff member will be assigned to coordinate this service.

These step-ups in communications and services for local Central (or Intergroup) offices were recommended by the 16th Conference in its discussion of "How Central Offices and Gen-

eral Service Work Together."

Conference members also urged Area G.S. Committees to work even harder at bringing local Intergroup (or Central) offices into the Third Legacy communications network at the local level.

Many specific ideas for doing this were spelled out in the following Presentation.

PRESENTATION

From one A.A. friend to another

What problem? Maybe an oversight, a matter of semantics, a few bruised toes, a question of local status; but no problem, only a situation, and all situations have answers through fairly simple adjustments.

"How Central Offices and World Service Work Together?"

To me, it seems very simple — they don't! They operate best as separate entities. The more efficiently each of them does its job, separately, the better they operate together.

Possibly some Areas find it difficult to operate *together*, because they are not sure exactly how to operate separately. Could it just be that some of us in this "World Service Informational Pipeline" are not exactly hep to what we could and should do to improve our relationships with Central Offices?

Who has seniority in A.A., Central Offices or General Services? Is it necessary to duplicate a local service that has been operating effectively for a long, long time? The questions depend on the Area, the Delegate, and the people involved.

Many Intergroups do feel left out of the informational stream on a regular, up-to-date, and dependable basis. Whether a local question involves literature, meetings, conference, public relations, traditions, finances, policy, world services, or General Services, odds are that 40 of 50 questions will be asked of the local Central office, and not of the Delegate or G.S.R. This is probably the way it should be, and always will be.

Much information never reaches the local member, because he has no motivation for asking questions. We might say,

Delegates were doing their job, the entire membership would be completely informed.

If we expect them to answer questions about World Service adequately; then to refer certain questions to the Delegate, or G.S.R.; local publications to include material on worldwide activities; offices to be well stocked and informed on literature, pamphlets, *Exchange Bulletins* and *Grapevines*; then it behooves us to provide them with up-to-date information.

Before your next world service meeting, why not pick up the phone and call your Central Office? Don't just take it for granted

ed that they will be there, or that they already know about it. Let your conversation go something like this: "We are having a World Service meeting, and wonder if you would do us a favor of being there? We need and want your help and experience."

It sounds corny, but having personally tried it, I know that they showed up and stayed late.

Maybe we have no real problem. Maybe for a starter all we need is a small postage bill, and a personal telephone call, from one A.A. friend to another.

—Jim M., California, Class B Trustee.

It all comes out service

The first thing that made us aware that we had a problem in the Central Offices was the fact that the two services were getting mixed up. Members were calling the Intergroup Office for General Service information, and they were contacting our G.S. Committee for Central Office information. So we prepared a script and slides to show the separate, different kinds of services performed by the two.

Then we went to the Intergroup Office to find out what kind of problems they had.

They told us they were having trouble with some clubs, and with some young people that wanted to start their own Groups. They had an Institutional Committee they wanted to work, but had no information.

I sent to New York for all the Service Material available on the problems that existed, and I took it to the Intergroup Office. We made a little headway.

In the meantime, we had 25,000 mimeo copies made of a list of all the services of the Central Offices. I flooded my area with it — 278 Groups. They had a lot of people calling the Central Office about a lot of things they had to answer.

The General Service Committee and Central Office are working together on communication with doctors, social workers, clergy. We will make communication by personal means rather than by mail. We want to try large public meetings sponsored jointly by the General Service Committee and Central Office. I think General Service and Intergroup can collaborate on one-minute talks to be given at all A.A. meetings by G.S.R.'s on the functions of General Service and Central Offices.

I think cooperation among all services is necessary, because when you throw it all together it still comes out "service."

—Chuck G., Ohio.

Improvements in St. Louis

The 1965 Convention Theme, "I Am Responsible," has helped to bring the General Service Office and Central Office on a closer relationship with one another. This hasn't always been true in St. Louis.

Many Groups are interested more than ever in just what G.S.O. can do and is doing for us. I know this to be true because they are asking questions more and more.

The old saying used to be "Don't let G.S.O. touch our Central Service Office. We don't want outsiders trying to tell us what to do, just leave us alone and we'll handle things our own way."

But we must remember that G.S.O. has at its command the experiences of many who have trod before us. No doubt had we not been so prideful we could have availed ourselves of these services and saved ourselves quite a few problems.

We need to know what advances are being made in the larger metropolitan areas and what are the best methods of handling

larger numbers of people.

Central Service Offices should be encouraged to take advantage of Delegates more, to use the knowledge they have learned by attending these Conferences.

Upon returning home last year, I was invited by three Groups to give a report on just what G.S.O. is and what they are doing. There are over 58 Active Groups in our Metropolitan Area.

So I ask this Conference what can be done to encourage our local Central Service Offices to want to communicate.

How can we let these areas know that we want to associate, but not infiltrate? That G.S.O. does not want to run their business, but only to serve in any way that is requested?

St. Louis is hosting the Young People's Convention this year, August 11-13. We have planned an excellent three days for you, so I hope to see all who can possibly come.

—Jim B., Missouri.

Good sharing in D.C.

Cooperation and communication between our General Service Committee and Assembly and the Washington Area Intergroup Association have been among the brighter spots during the tenure of the present Delegate.

The Assembly invited a past Chairman of W.A.I.A. to act as liaison between the two, and attend the regular G.S.R. meetings. At each meeting he is asked to report or to make any comment which he feels would be of interest to G.S.R.'s on the activities of the Intergroup Office or its problems. This has served to keep both service areas well-informed as to A.A. activity, and to share the progress and the problems.

The Intergroup Chairman has, in turn, asked the Delegate to sit in on its monthly meetings. The Executive Committee of W.A.I.A., empowered to act for the entire board, has invited the Delegate to attend its meetings from time to time. In addition the Delegate receives all bulletins from W.A.I.A., the minutes of its monthly meetings, and its financial report.

Intergroup publishes a monthly "W.A.I.A. Reporter," which has been most cooperative in printing information about G.S.O. Last year it ran a series of articles about G.S.O.: what it is, how it functions, and what happens at the Conference.

—Hal P., Washington, D.C.



Q. Some people want to operate a Twelfth Step Room with our Intergroup Office, manned by volunteers from member Groups working with very new people. Has anyone successfully operated this kind of operation?

A. The sense of the meeting was that this kind of operation would not work out.

Q. How about discounts on literature to Central Offices?

A. G.S.O. has available packages of literature at discounts, providing close to 20% savings. Central Offices are the largest purchasers of these packages. (A California Delegate referred to a breakdown of literature orders from the Los Angeles Central Office, which itemizes pamphlets that sell quickly and those that are called for less frequently. He will make a copy of this for G.S.O. for their information.)

COFFEE BREAK

An Informal Report on the 1966 Conference

Off the record at the 16th annual G.S. Conference meeting in New York April 18-23 some of the best A.A. tips and laughs happened around the coffee wagons.

Probably none of us will forget that bright, warm spring Monday morning in New York as we found the old loft building at 305 East 45th Street (G.S.O.) and spotted the "Welcome Delegates" sign in the lobby. Then the wait for the automatic elevators, and everybody wondering who would push the 18th floor button.

("Eighteenth? No building in my town is higher than 10 stories," one Delegate said. "I may not make it.")

Registration was highly informal in the meeting room — where world maps show A.A. worldwide, and the Serenity Prayer in two languages. Hazel R. greeted everybody, and the pretty "civilian" clerical staff briskly produced badges and big heavy brown kits for everybody. (Whatever happened to the Trustees' Badges????) Dennis Manders was handing out what one Delegate called "relief checks," to help cover expenses.

A pretty heart-faced member named Anne was snapping pictures of everybody's hands... old friends greeted each other with whoops of delight and hugs and kisses... and the Staff all complained of being nervous about having to give reports.

At 1:20 p.m. Monday the Terrace Suite in the Hotel Roosevelt began to take on its permanent decor for the week when the Canadian, U.S.A., and Puerto Rican flags were put on the dais, and the large banners saying "16th General Service Conference" and "I Am Responsible" were hoisted into place.

As early arrivals straggled in, Herb M. was already seated up front, testing his stop watch and that dam' bell. As usual, no one wanted to sit at the first row of green-covered tables (except Midge!). And Bill W. had to be rounded up and beckoned to the dais to get the session going... then when he began to tell about a drunk he and Ebby had shared, we knew we were home. It was real A.A., the heart of the matter, pumping hope and help out for alcoholics all over the world.

Average number of years of sobriety of 1966 Delegates was eleven. The range was 5 years to 21.

It took some of us days to figure out that names in red on badges were those of Panel 16 Delegates, blue, Panel 15.

It was nice to see gallantry prevailing in the agreement that women Delegates should open Conference sessions. Milly I. (N. Dak.) read the Twelve Steps; Ginny D. (Md.) the Twelve Traditions; Belle H. (Que.) the Twelve Concepts of Service; and Rosa B. (Calif.) the Warranty of the Conference.

Luncheon and Breakfast table conversations sounded like the usual A.A. -over-coffee-cups. Pills, quitting smoking, who went where last night (and who WAS the Delegate seen directing traffic in Times Square after midnight one night?), and other momentous topics were aired.

Few surprise drinks topped the story of Frank C. (New York) and his glass of guppies. Few of us admitted even to ourselves that probably Mike R. (Okla.) worked harder to understand the Third Legacy than most of us. We can read the Manual. Mike, almost blind, has it read to him over and over by his lovely wife Mary Alice. Few of us failed to laugh in deep identification with Frank R. (Class B Trustee — Mass.) when he told about learning that A.A. offered a new way of life, but admitted, "If I'd have seen it coming, I would've probably ducked!"

Who was really the biggest cigarette moocher at the Conference? George D. (N.J.) swears someone even topped him.

Did the folks who kept passing around books for autographs really get them back?

To the surprise of Staff Members, Delegates this year revived the custom of presenting small gifts to Staff and other G.S.O. employees who worked so hard during the Conference. New costume jewelry now sparkles all over the 18th floor.

It was also a surprise when Delegates revived the informal "crying towel" awards for those members who, in their opinion, had done the most mike-hogging. Unluckily singled out were Rosa B., Bill C., George D., and Clarence T. Some members deplore this practice, say feelings get hurt; others insist the high-

jinks are all in good fun and demand sportsmanship—"an informal kind of Group conscience," one fellow called it.

Maybe the biggest laugh came when Joe C. used his own oversize watch to outwit the chairman's stop-watch. Or was it when Hollis A. couldn't read his manuscript, swore his fiancée wrote it?

Many jaws ached—not from jawing, but in sympathy—when Ray M. came down with the mumps and had to leave early. What Joe C. had wasn't mumps—it was a tooth that acted up the day before the Conference began.

Who left a THIRD LEGACY MANUAL in the dining room all covered with doodles about dollars? Did anybody ever see more exotic hair-do's than those the stenographers wore in each morning?

Earliest arrival: Butch C., Hawaii. Earliest departure: Kale P., Finland.

On their one night off Delegates, as usual, went to an A.A. meeting in New York! Many turned up at Park-Madison, others scattered about the city.

It happens every time: one day no one could find a copy of the Twelve Steps in the whole hotel!

Both Austin MacCormick and Dr. John L. Norris dashed across town two days to attend a suddenly-called conference on law enforcement as guests of New York's Gov. Nelson Rockefeller. (Dr. Jack is chairman of the Governor's Advisory Council on Alcoholism.)

It was nice to see Ivan Underwood, former Class A Trustee who did so much good work for A.A. overseas, at the opening dinner. And Allan B., too. And didn't all those dressed up spouses of Delegates look grand! Especially the silver-haired doll in American Beauty red—Lois.

Seated at the table with Lois was Mrs. Mary S., chairman of the General Service Board of the Al-Anon Family Groups. (Their Conference met the same week, separately, of course.) Dinner also was a 30th wedding anniversary celebration for Bob and Alma W.

Norman C., member of the International Committee who just completed with four other members a tour round the world (the first round-the-world Group) on the Gripsholm, had some fascinating lunch stories about A.A. in Barcelona and Bombay.

Big debate: who was the biggest eater at the Conference, Scotty S. or Beth K.? Did hardboiled eggs ever disappear faster, even in a bar? Which Trustee knows more Latin and has more marbles, the distinguished ("secret non-drinker," he says) Austin MacCormick or the distinguished Archibald Roosevelt?

Should only those without cameras be allowed to vote on picture-taking at the Conference (there must have been *somebody* without one!)? Is "Hi!" really an A.A. slogan? Who wore the most jazzy sport shirts, Bob or Butch?

Did anybody ever learn to pour hot coffee out of those hot pots without scorching his mitts? Did anybody ever get to see those exhibits he meant to see? Did anybody ever pick up everything he wanted off those back tables?

Ray F. had beautiful company for a sukiyaki dinner one evening at one of Manhattan's good Japanese restaurants.

Did any Delegates' spouses ever get fancier V.I.P. hospitality than Joel B., Majorie P., Margaret B., Jean R., Fannie S. and their helpers provided? Museum tours, receptions with celebrities, Macy's, Lincoln Center, television shows, a visit to Mr. John's (hat emporium), the famed churches, lunch at the U.N., visit to *Seventeen Magazine*, and the boat trip.

Seen outside the Conference room: Ruth M., wife of former Mississippi Delegate Bish, and Jim H., ex-Delegate from Alabama.

Hotel Roosevelt security guards seized two men found roaming the halls, who could not speak English. Guillermo C., Puerto Rican Delegate, translated for them and we learned they were two San Salvador A.A.'s who had saved their money for over a year to come to New York to see Bill and G.S.O. Those

(continued on P. 39)

Conference Action

Sixth Tradition Guide for A.A.'s Who Run Clubs And Rehab Centers

When a center run by A.A. members for A.A. members gets known in the community as "an A.A. Club" or "an A.A. Halfway House," misunderstandings of the purposes of A.A. can arise in the community, the 16th Conference acknowledged.

However, since such places are "outside enterprises" — set up separately, outside of A.A. Groups, can our Traditions be imposed on them?

PRESENTATION

Over the years many facilities such as clubs and rehabilitation centers have come into existence to help the alcoholic. Some of these function completely outside of A.A. (such as government sponsored rehabilitation centers, etc.) but we are interested today in the ones managed by A.A. members and available to A.A.'s only.

The question has arisen, "Are these facilities bound by A.A.'s Traditions even though they are set up separately from A.A.?"

Rehab centers and clubs have become known in communities as "A.A. activities." Therefore, it seems impossible to separate them from the community's picture of A.A.

To clarify what we mean, here are two articles sent in by our clipping service:

Brighter surroundings for alcoholics to help them stay on the road to sobriety are planned at the Alcoholics Anonymous Club. Donations to remodel the rooms are asked. Checks made out to Alcoholics Anonymous may be sent to

After long discussion, the Conference agreed that running such enterprises is not the primary purpose of an A.A. Group, but that Tradition Six clearly shows how A.A. members should be guided in helping such facilities.

Specific examples were brought out in the following Presentation.

Guidance asked on two questions

(address given).

The newly established A.A. halfway house will benefit from the special meeting opened to the public. All donations collected will be used for food, clothing and bedding. Donations of articles—men's clothing, shoes, sheets, blankets, etc.—may be taken to the halfway house....

These are examples of how the A.A. name has been used for public solicitation of articles and funds. This is considered highly dangerous because it gives the impression that A.A. is affiliated with these other enterprises, and that we ask the public to give us money.

So, we are asking guidance on two questions:

1. Should facilities managed by A.A. members and available to A.A.'s only adhere to A.A. Traditions—especially those involving the A.A. name and self-support?
2. Should Groups be asked to assume responsibility for such business ventures?

—Beth K., G.S.O. Staff.

Lessons learned in N.Y.

We have 10 clubhouses, seven of which are true clubhouses and three of which are luncheon clubs only, functioning as a place for local members to gather for lunch and good A.A. talk. They are ideal — in the business districts for new members who have to establish new habit patterns.

All of our clubs function pretty much within our Traditions. They are supported by the A.A. Groups who meet in them through collections when the basket is passed, and by individual pledges from A.A. members. In no instance do I know of any club that accepts outside contributions. The 24-Hour Club (on 26th Street) has a dance every Saturday night. They have brunches at 11 in the morning, all to further good fellowship.

We have no Rehab Centers as such in the metropolitan area, although we do have 85 Groups holding 96 meetings a week in hospitals. However, there are 12 outlying rest homes.

We have three Rehab Centers operated by A.A. members and

available to A.A.'s only, and all run in accordance with Tradition; they do not include "A.A." in their name and all are self-supporting, declining outside contributions.

I was among the members who started a 12th Step House in Brooklyn. It was there I first became aware of the Traditions because we broke so many of them! Inmates were told to come to Sponsor House upon their release and we would clothe them, feed them, and keep a roof over their heads.

Alcoholics got their 35¢ carfare when released, went to the first liquor store and bought a pint of wine and forgot about Sponsor House. Some did make it and one of them, together with several other members in Westchester, started another Sponsor House in White Plains. They apparently have profited by past mistakes, for it is functioning beautifully, strictly in accordance with the Traditions.

—Frank C., New York.

Cooperation short of affiliation

We have a 12th Step Club, Inc. supported by various A.A. members of various Charlotte Groups. We think it serves a good purpose. It helps get the drunk off the street. He can stay as long as he isn't drinking, when he is hung over. A lot of people have got sober there.

We also have a Flynn Christian Fellowship Home, designed to house an alcoholic who normally would be in the street. We try to get him a job. The Directors are all members of A.A., and we have seen some very good results.

At the outset we received help from the outside financially, but the primary source of funds was the ABC Board. In North Carolina 5% of ABC income is set aside by statute for rehabilitation. Now with the residents paying \$15 per week the home is self-supporting.

In our area general hospitals still will not admit an alcoholic, so we have had for many years a special hospital named Willmith, Inc. (after our co-founders). Recently we moved into a fairly big new unit. Everyone on the Board of Directors is a member of A.A. and we have A.A. literature throughout the hospital. Of course we have the problem of repeaters, but if it weren't for the repeaters I don't know whether the hospital could stay open. A lot of people only go once or twice, then after contact with A.A., don't have to go back.

When we built this hospital we put a large room in the basement for regular meetings. Various Groups support these meetings, and I have seen men come in there with their bathrobes on and never take another drink.

—Harry B., North Carolina.

Rehabs in Houston, Tex.

We have three rehabs or drying-out houses for men in Houston. Two have been operating over 12 years. The skid-row alcoholic center, known as "Jimmy's," is the larger. It has a state charter, operated as a non-profit organization, and is the home of the Congress St. Group of A.A. Both of these operate as closely as possible in the framework of A.A. Traditions. Although it is chartered, or a separate organization from the A.A. Group, they do co-operate. Jimmy's has recently moved, and now has beds for about 70 patients, nine in the "shake" room.

(They had a sign in the sick room that said, "Will patients please not stand while room is in motion.")

We do not know the percentage of men from Jimmy's that have attained sobriety, but 3,700 have spent their five days in the "shake" room.

This center is financed by voluntary contributions of various Groups and small rents for the room which they rent out to the alcoholic. It is really a valuable and useful asset in our area.

The other center is actually part of a club and the Forest

Hills Group. It is called a 24-Hour Club. They handle about nine patients, and the patient can only go through one time. He can stay 10 days with no cost at all.

The third 12-Step House we have is for women. It is called the Turning Point, and they have excellent results in percentage of people who stay sober at least six months after 15 or 20 or 30 days there.

This outfit is supported by the voluntary contributions of quite a number of Groups and they do not have the financial support they need.

We have had several 12-Step Houses or Rehab Centers start up, and then due to personalities, and financial difficulties, they have all folded. They were commercial ventures, and did not follow the A.A. Traditions. They twisted and beat them.

Past experience has proven that if the facility operates within the A.A. Traditions, they have much better luck both financially and in helping the sick alcoholic.

—Jerry W., Texas.

WORKSHOPS AND SHARING SESSIONS

Conference Structure, Conference Reporting and Area Activities

As was announced at that time, material gathered during these sessions is being separately compiled and will be distributed to all Delegates and local Area G.S. Committees for comment. Eventually it is hoped this can become the basis for a new chapter or two in the THIRD LEGACY MANUAL.

Among the questions discussed were:

1. Should basic procedure now described in the MANUAL be retained or revised? What exceptions should be made?
2. Eleven Areas do not have Committee Members. How do they function?
3. No qualifications for Committee officers are named in the MANUAL. Should any be suggested?
4. The line of communication is now G.S.O. to Delegate to Chairman to Committee Member. Is this satisfactory? How

can it be improved?

5. What is usually on the agenda for an Assembly? Who prepares it?
6. Does the well-organized District Meeting seem to offer the best service opportunities for the future, leaving the Assemblies for once-a-year elections?
7. How do P.I. Committees and Institutional Committees fit Third Legacy structure on the local level?
8. How are districts established and Committee Members elected?
9. How do you form Workshops in local areas and obtain subjects? Is literature available on this subject?
10. Where interest in Delegate's Conference report is low, what can be done to make it attractive?

'I Am Responsible' spurs local activities

The voices of 58 Delegates and 15 A.A.'s from round the world stirred the hearts of 10,000 present in Maple Leaf Gardens the evening of July 3, 1965 declaring in unison "I am responsible . . . When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I AM RESPONSIBLE."

As Conference Secretary, I am grateful to report the past year has been busy and productive. Communication has improved and Area Conference service has expanded. To list just a few examples:

1. Many Delegates have visited all Groups in their Areas.
2. Reports on the 15th Annual Conference meeting were given to Assemblies, District meetings, Committee meetings, Conferences, Conventions and to Group meetings.
3. Delegates have used the two G.S.O. filmstrips, the 15th *Final Conference Report*, the *Conference Digest*, Service material from G.S.O., the *Exchange Bulletins*, Sharing Sessions, the literature and "Inside A.A." displays, "Bill's Own Story" on film and many other available tools to share the message of service.

4. Many Area Public Information activities have come into being and cooperation with alcoholism agencies and other interested non-A.A.'s has improved.
5. Delegates have assisted in healing local "growing pains," bringing the benefit of their service knowledge.
6. Institutional A.A. has been aided with speakers, sponsorship and literature. Many Areas now allocate funds for Institutional literature.
7. Many state, province and area conferences and conventions have grown out of Assemblies.
8. Many Groups have been Twelfth Stepped, and new Groups started, because the Area Service Committee kept in touch with the Area needs.
9. Central Service Offices are being brought into Conference communication, if they indicate a desire.
10. Through discussions and mailings, all Groups were given an opportunity to discuss this year's Conference agenda.

Progress? Yes. More to be done? Yes. But the Conference is fulfilling its primary purpose, "To assure A.A.'s survival."

— HAZEL R., Conference Secretary.

ASK-IT BASKET

Q. Are many Areas compiling histories?

A. *Montana, Arizona, New Jersey, Washington State, Oregon, Western New York, S.W. Texas and an area of Ohio are or have.*

Q. When will we have a new G.S.O. filmstrip? Our committee would like to see more personal events such as the start of A.A. in India, as in filmstrip No. 1, instead of so many pictures of pennies. These films are very helpful.

A. *We try to make each filmstrip tell a different G.S.O. story. In a future filmstrip, hopefully available by next Conference, some other aspect will be stressed. Although Filmstrip #2 stressed money, it was well-received. (First two filmstrips, with sound track, \$4.50 each from G.S.O.)*

Q. Can we get copies of the "A.A. Growth Chart"?

A. *Yes, G.S.O. will make reproductions available.*

Conference Action

Conference Sets Qualifications For Overseas Observers

Hereafter, when A.A. Groups or service boards overseas wish to have an observer present at the Conference, they are requested to send someone who is an A.A. member and also a legal resident of the country wishing representation.

The 16th Conference approved this as part of the recommendations of its Policy Committee (Mike R., Oklahoma, chairman) which had studied the procedure at the request of the G.S.

Board's International Committee.

It was the thinking of the International Committee that its members might be considered as filling the role of overseas observers to the Conference. It is the intention of its chairman to make available information about the Conference which would seem pertinent to our overseas Groups (and in their own languages).

REPORTS

840 Latin American, 770 European Groups helped

The 1966 *Directory* lists 14,205 members of 770 Groups in Europe. In Central and South America, 19,611 in 840 Groups.

In work with overseas Groups, we try to share experience, when consulted, so the Groups can become independent, self-supporting and responsible for their own service needs.

Order blanks are available for material in Afrikaans, Finnish, French, German, Hungarian, Italian, Norwegian, Portuguese, Spanish, and Swedish.

A Spanish Bulletin is sent bi-monthly to all Spanish-speaking Groups. Portions of "The A.A. Group," a new G.S.O. pamphlet, have been included. A new French Bulletin made its first bi-monthly appearance this March and goes to all French-speaking Groups outside the United States and Canada. (French-speaking Groups in Canada are well taken care of through the French Literature Council in Montreal.)

We have one Group and a Loner registered in an Iron Curtain country. The Group was formed by a doctor who visited G.S.O. Since the word *anonymous* in the native tongue has the overtones of secret or conspiratorial, a word meaning *unknown* is used instead.

Holland and Belgium. Flemish-speaking Groups in Belgium are continuing to translate material. The Big Book in Flemish is made available to Groups in Holland, pending translations into Dutch. Publication of the Flemish book was made possible through a loan made by A.A.W.S. to the Algemeen Dienstbureau in Antwerp.

Finland. A fine Central Office in Helsinki distributes Conference-approved literature and an excellent magazine. About twenty Finns attended the Toronto Convention, among them the hardworking Central Office Secretary. Doctor Earle M.'s visit to Finland was reported in the December 1965 Grapevine.

Norway. Our information about Norway is always up-to-date,

thanks to Hart S., a Norwegian living here but making regular trips to Norway.

Sweden and Denmark. The Central Office in Stockholm continues to service nine Swedish Groups. The first pamphlet in Danish is being printed in Copenhagen. Denmark has only three Groups and a few Loners.

Italy. Growth is slow in Italy. The International Committee is trying to provide information to the Vatican through *Osservatore Romano*, the Vatican newspaper.

France. There are now approximately 400 members in France, almost all of them French. A.A. in France has its own service board and committee, but has not so far been able to assume the responsibility of literature distribution.

Colombia. Groups in Colombia formed an interim service board last December. G.S.O. helped by providing guide lines. This April, Group representatives will elect their permanent Board and two Committees, one for a magazine similar to the Grapevine, and a committee similar to A.A. World Services, Inc.

Peru. Plans are being made in Peru to translate the talks given in Toronto, for further work with prisons and hospitals, and for more public information to let Peruvians know about A.A.

Costa Rica and Chile. There are still difficulties here in understanding that Abstemious Clubs, though identical in aim, are different in practice from A.A. Correspondence and a visit with the founder of the Abstemious Clubs in Chile will, we hope, clarify our Traditions.

Brazil. "How A.A. Starts and How It Grows" and "Sponsorship" are new Portuguese pamphlets. Brazilians already have "This Is A.A.," "44 Questions and Answers," "Fortune Reprint," "Traditions" and "Is A.A. For You?"

— ANN M., Staff Member
Overseas Groups (European and Spanish-speaking)

Growing pains of A.A. overseas recall mistakes we have made

Many Groups overseas have the same problems A.A. had here in the early days. When such Groups accept government support, or do away with anonymity, we have work to do. We look for new ways to solve old problems, new methods to carry the same message.

We tried to help set up General Service Offices in Colombia and Germany.

Problems in other areas include anonymity in Japan, unity and outside support in Brazil and affiliation with outside agencies in Korea.

We are preparing a pamphlet, "Mistakes We Have Made," showing problems we had here with money, anonymity and unity, among other things. It will show overseas Groups specific examples of how to avoid mistakes.

Growth of A.A. has been spurred by articles such as the Jack Alexander story here and the Kessel series in France. So we are looking at public information overseas.

We want to see what materials they have, how effective they have been, and whether or not we can help. We are also looking into the possibility of supplying filmed materials with "dubbed-in" sound. We are working on a pamphlet to show overseas Groups how to make their locations and activities better known to alcoholics and their friends — in the phone book, through classified ads, by leaving pamphlets and a number to call at hospitals, police stations and social service agencies.

Your International Committee is made up of A.A. members who specialize in language and communications, and who visit different countries. We need more such travelers, to provide first-hand information, help strengthen communications between the Office and overseas Groups, and help Groups overseas carry the message.

Along with G.S.O., the International Committee enables each A.A. in the United States and Canada to be there, "when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help."

— Dr. VINCENT DOLE (Class A) and NILES P., co-chairmen,
General Service Board International Committee.

German, U.K., South African A.A.'s now take care of own Groups

It is now no longer necessary for G.S.O. to provide complimentary literature to new Groups and Loners in Germany, the United Kingdom and South Africa.

When members in those regions say, "I am responsible," they really mean it. They are now relieving the North American G.S.O. — and that means all of us — of great responsibilities, since A.A. in those countries has now come of age enough to shoulder its own Twelfth Step work. This will reduce our expenses for overseas literature.

United Kingdom (North Ireland, England, Wales, Scotland and Republic of Ireland). The Development Committee of the General Service Board for the United Kingdom has established a General Service Conference, to meet the first time at Manchester, England, October 29-30, 1966.

Their publishing company now assumes responsibility for all free literature sent to new Groups and Loners in that area.

South Africa. The General Service Office moved from Pretoria to Johannesburg and now furnishes literature in English, Afrikaans, Sesutu, Xhosa and Zulu. There is no paid staff, so members of the Committee meet on weekends to fill orders and handle other services.

Although the A.A. Groups in Rhodesia are not affiliated, the South African Committee offered them literature on indefinite credit until their currency difficulties are cleared up. This news warmed our hearts.

Australia. No final agreement was reached at the Fifth Annual Convention, Brisbane, 1965, on establishing a Board of Trustees, G.S.O. and publishing company. They decided to prepare a new constitution and present it to the Australian Service Council at the 1966 Convention in Hobart, Tasmania. Meanwhile, the

Sydney Central Service Office prints and distributes some Conference-approved pamphlets.

New Zealand. The third New Zealand Conference was held at Palmerston North, February 5-6, 1966. They have a Steering Committee, responsible for all New Zealand services, and four assemblies: Northern, Waitomo, Central and Southern. There are three Delegates from each area and an extra Delegate representing Loners.

Korea. A nonalcoholic minister printed with financial assistance from A.A.W.S. Inc., the pamphlet, "This is A.A." It has always been our feeling that A.A. should be available in any language for alcoholics who seek it. With the kind help of one of Dr. Vincent Dole's technicians, a Korean, this pamphlet was found not to be representative of A.A.!

Japan. "This is A.A.," combined with "Is A.A. for You?" was translated by Rev. Bufo Yamamuro, one of the founders of Danshu Kai, a society for recovered alcoholics. Danshu Kai members were using the A.A. program combined into five steps, and, according to Rev. Yamamuro, are now willing to follow the Twelve Steps. The translation is good, and time will reveal if the Danshu Kai Groups will become typical A.A. Groups.

India. There are Groups in Bombay, Calcutta, New Delhi and Mangalore. Many inquiries reached G.S.O. as a result of an ad placed in the newspapers in Madras by an Internationalist, Ben L. We now have Loners and should soon have Groups there. At a conference in Bombay, July 2-4, 1965, Calcutta and New Delhi A.A.'s participated.

Pamphlets in Hindi and Marathe are available through the Bombay Intergroups, and the Calcutta Groups are now printing "Is A.A. for You?" in English.

— WANETA N., Staff Member
Overseas Groups (English and German Language)

Observers Thank Conference

2,000 FINNISH A.A.'s

Regards from the 2,000 A.A. members in Finland. About half have their sobriety at least one year, our oldest, 16 years. Fifty participated in the 30th Anniversary Convention in Toronto.

At the end of 1965 we had 121 A.A. Groups, plus 31 in institutions. Last year there were 244 meetings every week in Finland. Almost every Group in Helsinki has female members, too, though male alcoholics have in all Groups absolute majority.

Translation of A.A. literature into our mother tongue is still one of our main tasks, though we have already translated the best part of the Conference-approved literature. We publish a Finnish A.A. journal, issued every other month. This year we are supporting Al-Anon Family Groups and A.A. in prisons and hospitals.

In order to prove the liveliness of A.A. in Finland, I can mention that Finnish A.A. Publishing had 15 meetings, the Finnish Service 14 meetings, and common meetings, these two had 5 in 1965. Besides, we had five conferences for Finnish A.A.'s in various cities last year. I hope those examples express that A.A. has been successful in Finland last year, when 224 new members got his or her first anniversary.

We have tried to carry our message to alcoholics who still suffer. In spite of our efforts, we have very much to do. Alcoholism is a serious problem in Finland. Finns stand alcohol very badly. The manners of drinking are bad, too. We do not drink, generally speaking, very often, but very much every time. This method of drinking makes a man an alcoholic very quickly. Besides, we drink mostly strong drinks. Therefore we Finnish A.A. members try to intensify our activities at the level of press, radio and TV. We had, in TV last week a film, made by some Finnish A.A.'s. More information of A.A. is needed in Finland and therefore all good ideas of carrying the message are welcomed.

I want to express towards American A.A. the gratitude of Finnish A.A.'s for everything we have got. Thank you.

—K.J.P., Observer for A.A. in Finland.

2,000 NORWEGIAN A.A.'s

A.A. in Norway during 1965 was getting settled down to an improved working basis. The number of Groups remains about 80. Membership may be estimated at about 2,000, active and nonactive, the latter being those not associated with any Group.

The National Secretariat (Landssekretariat) consists of seven members and is the national A.A. office. It's voluntary and the weakness has often been too apparent: delay in answering letters, not attending to shipments of literature promptly, etc. To remedy matters two new members were elected to the Secretariat at the 1965 National A.A. Conference of Norway (A.A. Landskonferansen) in Oslo, both of them experienced office men.

In 1963, of the Norwegian Big Books, there were 516 copies, hard back; 92 paperbacks bound and 1,100 unbound. At the end of 1965, the 516 copies were all sold, and about 124 copies of the newly bound paperbacks, a total of 650 sold. During 1965 portions of *THE THIRD LEGACY* were translated and distributed among the Groups. Translation of *TWELVE STEPS & TWELVE TRADITIONS* is now almost completed. A.A. in Norway has translated and distributed five of our pamphlets for many years. Printing of "Partners in A.A." is almost completed.

The Oslo Intergroup moved in January. Voluntary desk duty covers the period from 5 to 9 p.m. There seems almost no chance the practice of closing meetings with the Lord's prayer will ever be generally adopted there. The spiritual basis is shunted aside in Oslo.

Bergen has always maintained efficient Intergroup activities. Our friends in west coast cities have always stressed the spiritual interpretation of A.A. Bergen recently renewed printing the periodical "Veien Tilbake" (The Road or Way Back), has translated and printed several of our A.A. pamphlets, and has renewed efforts at keeping the Al-Anon Group going.

Trondheim maintains office quarters serving as a meeting place and Twelfth Step work center.

—Hart S., Observer for A.A. in Norway.



Q. Conferences like this are being formed in other countries. Does A.A. become divided in this manner, or is there sufficient coordination to share common experiences?

A. Such Conferences could tend to unify, just as new Central Offices and Intergroups do. The International Committee can serve as a pool of worldwide experience. We can learn from overseas Groups.

REPORT

Internationalists may be afloat, but firmly anchored in A.A.

Internationalists, our seagoing members we call the "couriers of A.A.," carry the message over the seven seas.

They came into being in 1950 when Captain Jack, a seaman from Massachusetts, won three Big Books at a meeting and left two in Singapore and Shanghai and the third when his ship docked in the Persian Gulf. There are now 341 registered Internationalists. We have this account from one:

"I was ashore at the Army-Navy P.X. in Yokohama, and my Serenity Prayer and 12 Steps card fell out. The chap beside me stared at it. I asked him if he knew what it was. Believe it or not he did. He was a Japanese cab-driver who had had a lot of trouble with the saki and had been helped by a seaman. He invited me to meet some friends of his later that evening. When I got there, it was a Japanese Community Bath House! There we held an A.A. meeting. A.A. reaches everywhere...."

Internationalists travel with an *Internationalists Directory* prepared annually at our office and a *World Directory*. They always have friends in every port. One of our men describes it this way:

"I well remember the lost lonely feeling in a foreign port, making my way to my first away-from-home meeting, in Durban, South Africa, a few years ago. Then that lovely A.A. welcome and never alone ever again..."

The only continuing contact Internationalists have with A.A. is through G.S.O. Every other month, we send the *Round Robin*, a newsletter composed from their letters to us, to all Internationalists. The experiences they share are salty, hilarious, informative, and often touching. We always try to keep them abreast of A.A. news and to be the one place where they can always drop their A.A. anchor.

— CORA LOUISE B., Staff Member, Internationalists.

Interview Time

Are North American A.A.'s interested in helping 'anyone, anywhere?'

One question asked Delegates during Interview Time was, "Are Groups and members in your area interested in sharing the work of G.S.O.'s International Committee to help A.A. start and grow overseas?"

The most enthusiastically received suggestion was that G.S.O. encourage overseas Groups to write U.S. and Canadian Groups. Maybe then North American Groups would undertake to help overseas Groups (as many now help Groups in institutions) ...write them regularly, exchange tapes, keep them supplied with Conference-approved literature in their own tongue, etc.

Some Delegates said they were ashamed to admit it, but they believe most members are not especially interested in what

happens to alcoholics in other places. They are busy at home. Other Delegates offered such constructive suggestions as:

1. Groups could correspond with English-speaking A.A.'s overseas.
2. Prison Groups could write to overseas Groups.
3. Maybe American Indian Groups and immigrant A.A.'s could be interested.
4. Delegates might try to stir up such interest.
5. Armed Forces Groups and bilingual Groups might help.

Most Delegates said this question had never been discussed in their Areas, so they did not know how A.A.'s feel about overseas A.A. They agreed to discuss it upon returning home.

Conference Action

Binder for Year's 'Grapevine' May Be Issued

A stiff binder which would hold 12 issues of the Grapevine will be produced and trial-marketed by the A.A. magazine, the 16th Conference voted in accepting the report of its Grapevine Committee, chaired by George D., New Jersey.

The Conference also accepted two other recommendations by the Committee: (1) Delegates should lend their efforts toward increasing readership of the magazine in each area and (2) Delegates should search out new material — articles, stories,

anecdotes — for the Grapevine in their areas.

The possibility of raising the single-issue price of the magazine a nickel or a dime was discussed by the Committee, because of rising production costs; but no Conference action was taken. The price has been 35¢ since 1957.

Joe C., Texas, was named the new Conference Grapevine Committee chairman.

REPORT

'Grapevine' circulation, new leaflets bring solvent year

Grapevine circulation rose to an all-time high in May, 1965: 45,602. Circulation in February 1966 stands at 44,886.

At the Toronto Convention we introduced "The Best of Bill," five Grapevine articles by Bill W. Nearly 13,000 packets have been sold. Grapevine Staff attended the Convention, supervised two booths, and reported the experience in the October issue.

The Grapevine had a modest "excess of earnings over expenses" during 1965, the third year in the black. Mary B., chairman

of the Board of the Grapevine Corporation during the years of this financial turn-around, rotated out of office at the end of 1965. Charles (Ed) L. is now chairman.

In December we revised the cover design. It is our continuing effort to make the magazine fresh and appealing each month, while remembering our primary purpose: to carry the message in print.

— TOM W., Editor.

PRESENTATION

Facts on 'Grapevine' readers uncovered

[Grapevine readership may be related to stable sobriety, according to results of a recent survey among readers, Tom W., editor, told the 16th Conference. Grapevine subscribers are not usually A.A. newcomers, but are largely A.A. members with 8-14 year records, he pointed out.

[He was introduced by Ed (Chuck) L., Scarsdale, N. Y., new chairman of the Grapevine Corporate Board. Ruth W., New York City, new treasurer of the magazine, elaborated on its present financial outlook and 1966 budget (see PP. 40, 41 and 43).

[Teles B., Montreal, spoke about the French-language A.A. magazine, *La Vigne A.A.*, and distributed samples. Other highlights of the Presentation follow.]

Today we put the Grapevine before you in two questions:

1. What is The A.A. Grapevine?
2. Who reads it?

First, the Grapevine is the Conference-approved periodical, a monthly magazine for A.A.'s. Our circulation for March, 1966, was 45,199. Our all-time high, in May, 1965 was 45,602.

But a great many more read it. It is often handed by subscribers to other A.A.'s, and back copies go to prison and hospital Groups. Whole families dip into the Grapevine. So the Grapevine is read by at least 100,000 people a month.

We carry on our masthead, "The International Monthly Journal of A.A." There are often articles from outside North America.

[Lee B. read excerpts from letters from Canada, Spain, California, On Board Ship, Channel Islands, Peru, etc.]

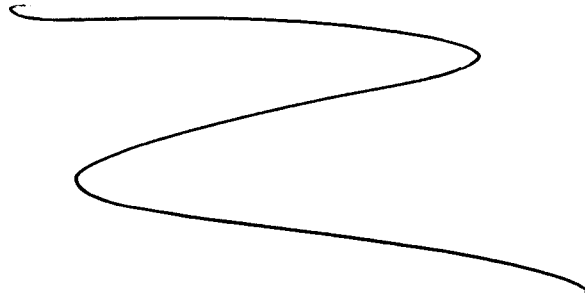
The magazine has often been thought of as a "meeting in print," or "a hip-pocket meeting" (see P. 44 of the May issue). This seems to all of us a fact: especially for Loners, the Grapevine is a way of sharing the lift of an A.A. meeting.

It seems to us that the Grapevine is a forum for A.A. opinion about A.A., about sobriety in its wide implications...open to all to submit their views, subject only to the "group conscience" of the combined Editorial Board and Staff.

Here are some other ways to characterize the Grapevine. "A Look at the Lighter Side." We try to put forward a little fun, along with sober reflections, through cartoons, humorous articles and columns.

[Paula C. paid high tribute to the late Gurney W., Grapevine editor for many years and a noted humorist. She told how the new humor column, "A Look at the Lighter Side," written by Pete S., emerged from Editorial Board meetings.]

MISSING PAGE 33



Interview Time

'Grapevine' gets praise, suggestions

"If you wanted the Grapevine to change in one important way, what would it be?" Delegates were asked during Interview Time. The change could be in either editorial or sales policy.

But there were no takers. A.A.'s monthly magazine got almost nothing but unanimous raves. However, Delegates suggested ways in which usefulness and readership of the magazine might be improved. They included:

1. Establish a Group Library for back issues.

2. Give them to churches for literature racks.
3. Send them to prison Groups.
4. Send them to public libraries.
5. Send them to doctor's offices.
6. More jokes, cartoons, and pictures.
7. Make it bigger.
8. Try harder for Group bulk subscriptions and for individual subscriptions.
9. Don't change—it's just great!

ASK-IT BASKET

Q. Would it be possible for the "Responsibility" pledge to be built into the

Grapevine format?

A. Delegates gave unanimous approval by a show of hands.

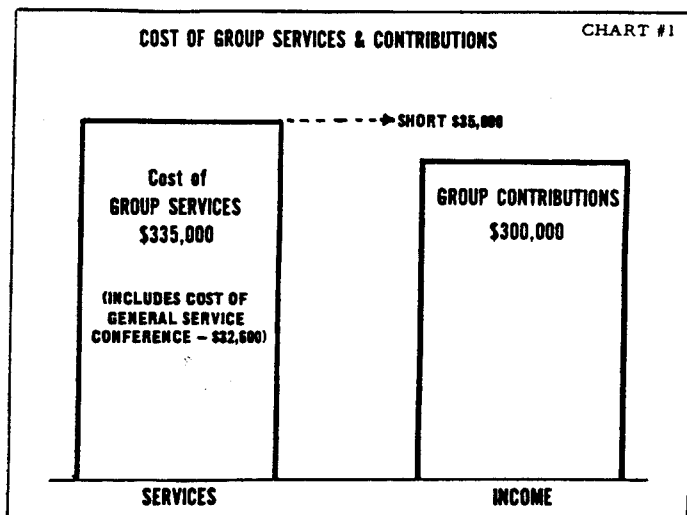
PRESENTATION

Money at G.S.O. - - where it comes from, how it's spent

As businesses go, G.S.O. comes under the head of small business. But in terms of share holders, we are unlike any business on earth. We have 12,000 Groups interested in where the money comes from and where it goes. We have literally thousands of A.A.'s who want to know what, how and why about A.A. money. And they have every right to, since money has been known to cause trouble in our beloved Fellowship.

The financial structure of G.S.O. is simple — but it looks complicated when you try to show it in detail on an income statement, or balance sheet, or budget. I believe these simple charts will help.

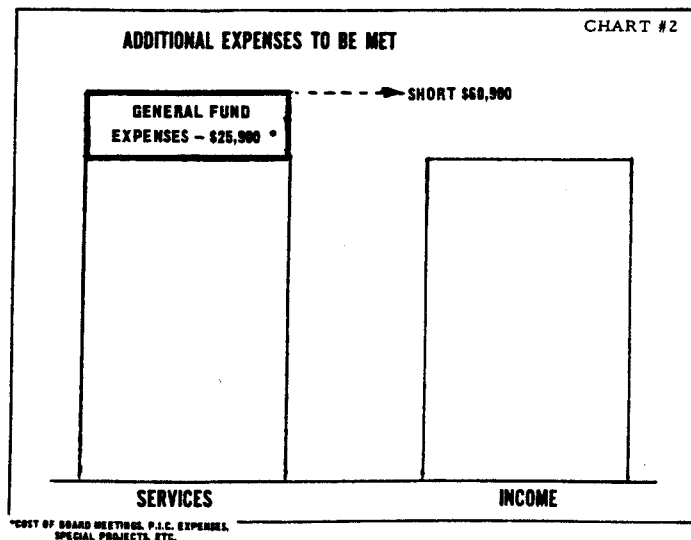
Each of these charts shows Service Costs on the left; Income on the right. Chart #1 shows the cost of Group services as provided for in the 1966 budget — \$335,000. At the right, we see anticipated Group Contributions at \$300,000. Contributions should match Group Services but they haven't for years.



In planning the 1966 Budget, the Finance & Budgetary Committee successfully effected economies in many areas without reducing Group Services. However, growth of the Fellowship and constantly rising cost of living add to service costs year after year.

Chart No. 1 shows that anticipated Group contributions will fall \$35,000 below the cost of Group services. In past years contributions have rarely met cost of Group Services.

Chart #2 emphasizes the fact that there are other expenses to be met: General Fund Expenses of \$25,900 representing the cost of holding Trustee meetings, the P.I.C. budget, writing and research expenses. At this point, we see that we are nearly \$61,000 short of reality. So . . .



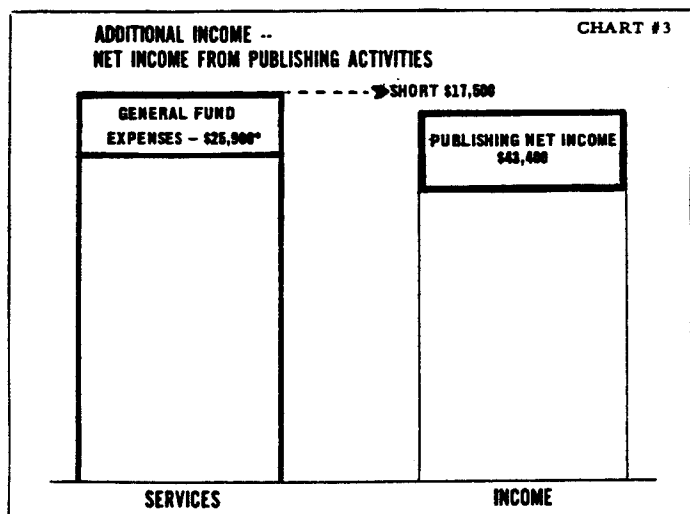
There are other G.S.O. expenses in addition to cost of Group Services. General Fund expenses, totaling \$25,900, represent the cost of Board meetings, Public Information Committee expenses, Special Projects, etc. Combined costs of General Fund and Group Services now exceed income by \$60,900.

Chart #3 shows how the income side is helped by an anticipated \$43,400 from publishing. Our book and pamphlets business, after paying its own share of operating expenses, has this much over to contribute to the pot — thereby cutting the deficit to \$17,500.

Chart #4 now shows how that \$17,500 deficit will be met in 1966 — by using accumulated investment income from the Reserve, without cutting into Reserve principal.

So for 1966 it is possible to work within anticipated income without cutting A.A. services, and without digging into Reserve principal. This is not strictly a balanced budget but it is a practical one, provided . . .

Steps are taken to *increase income* and to keep service expenses from going through the roof. Such steps are being taken.



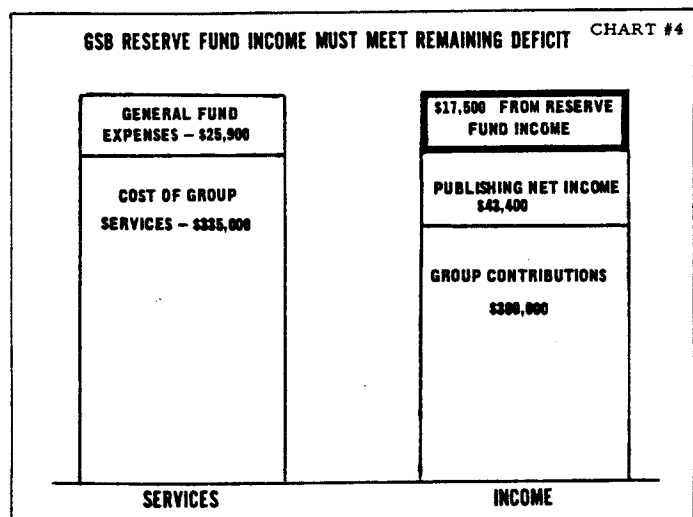
Publishing activity anticipates a \$43,400 net income for the year (after paying its own share of operating expenses). This total amount will be contributed toward expenses, reducing anticipated deficit to \$17,500.

The Monthly or Regular Contribution Plan is well launched now. It may — if we all give it the help it needs — bring Group contributions up to a point where they carry the cost of Group services.

Book and pamphlet distribution is being stimulated in a number of ways; Groups will be kept informed of the existence and importance of Conference-approved literature. The new A.A. READER should increase the net income from publishing.

On the other side of the ledger, we are constantly doing what we can — and asking your cooperation — to cut basic costs so that inflation and the cost of more services to more Groups will still leave us with a workable budget.

For example, in the last five years while printing costs have gone up generally, the costs of printing our literature and directories have been reduced through a regular program of planned production economies. The savings for that period exceed \$130,000.



The Reserve Fund of the Board is invested in income-producing securities. This investment income will be used to meet the remaining deficit (which is expected to total \$17,500).

Similarly, while the Conference has increased in size, in number of days, in total activities, the Conference budget has increased only 4% in the past five years. During that same period, cost of living index has increased more than 7%. It has taken

the work of Kleina and Dennis and many others working on hotel and travel arrangements — and it has taken your full cooperation — to pare costs wherever possible so that we could have the kind of Conference the movement needs on the kind of budget we can afford.

All along the line — in dozens of big and little ways — we have done whatever possible to keep costs in line — to buy wisely — to ask constantly: "Is this expense good for the movement? Will it help the drunk?"

G.S.O. finances are everybody's problem. It is up to us who work at G.S.O. to squeeze as much service as possible from every dollar. It is up to all of us to tell the Groups and A.A.'s everywhere that G.S.O. means worldwide service and deserves the support of every Group. On this program each and every one of us can help — "So that the hand of A.A. always will be there."

—Herb M., G.S.O. Staff.

'Regular Contribution Plan' shows good results

A message from Bill, mailed with the final 1965 contribution statement, said that our financial picture suffered from a big weakness — lack of communication. If all Groups *knew* that the future unity and effectiveness of our whole Fellowship depend on continued world service strength, we would not be lacking the finances to underwrite our A.A. future.

Here's what we are doing to correct this communication weakness. For many years each contribution to support General Services had been acknowledged as received. Last year, we tried another and better way — the Quarterly Acknowledgement. Every Group in the United States and Canada received this statement of contributions for the last three quarters of 1965. Groups who had not contributed found this a reminder that perhaps they were not sharing the costs of world services.

In 1965, a multiple form statement was used, one copy being pulled every quarter and mailed to each Group. The last copy was our permanent office record.

The only way Delegates could be informed of their Area's contributions to date was to compile up to five lists for each state or province (depending on the number of Areas) leaving the Delegate to pick out the Groups in his Area. This was almost like getting out an extra mid-year Directory. This took many hours, and no small effort by the Delegate.

This year a new method has greatly improved our procedure and promises to cut labor costs many hundreds of dollars. A single ledger card, with a current mailing address, is prepared for each Group.

Contributions, as received, are machine posted to this card. Every Group has a record of contributions to date on a cumulative basis. Then, every quarter the ledger cards are microfilmed. Photo copies are taken from the film and mailed to all Groups. Twice a year (first quarter and third quarter) duplicate prints are made and sent to each Delegate for his Area only.

This simple process, taking the place of the time-consuming lists, has been made possible by the wonderful cooperation of some Delegates and their committees in supplying us with a listing of cities and maps where their Groups are located.

Each Group will now know exactly what it is doing in contributions and each Delegate will know what his Area is doing. This method lends itself ideally to the Regular Contribution Plan. Each Statement reminds the Group what the Regular Contribution Plan is. A Group decides to make its contribution to G.S.O. on a monthly basis (or bimonthly or quarterly) rather than twice a year or once a year. The yardstick of \$3.00 per year per member then becomes 25¢ per month per member. The Group can send more if it can afford it. If it prefers to stick to a twice-a-year contribution, of course, it can do so.

Tests show that a change-over to the new Regular Contribution Plan may very well solve our budget problem. For a comparison of results of the method of contributing and acknowledging, the first quarter receipts and transactions for 1966 were compared to those for 1965.

(continued on page 36)

(continued from page 35)

Receipts were: \$59,540 in 1966.
\$40,570 in 1965.
No. of Contributions were: 3,150 in 1966.
1,460 in 1965.

This shows that contributions are being spread on a monthly and bimonthly basis. Whether or not it is adding to the final total of contributions, time will tell. By July, we'll know more — by December 31st we'll know positively.

—Dennis Manders, G.S.O. Staff.

Each member is a part of G.S.O.

We Delegates realize how important it is to support General Service and also how important General Service is for us, in keeping our Groups together and running smoothly. It really was surprising to find how *little* the members know about the workings of General Service.

It should be a *must* that each Group elect a G.S.R. and that financial responsibility be placed in their hands. Each member should feel that General Service had as much of a hand in his

sobriety as his sponsor. He owes support to it as well as to his Group.

The 25¢ a month is good. This was well received by the Groups I talked to. *More emphasis* could be put on literature purchased from G.S.O. The Grapevine, Bill's Own Story on film and also the "Exchange Bulletin," should come up with a plea asking for help from the Groups.

—Robert D., Minnesota.

'Birthday Plan' works, too

The Birthday Plan is as follows:

1. An A.A. contributes on his A.A. birthday one dollar for each year of sobriety (up to ten dollars).
2. He gives the money to his Group treasurer who sends it to G.S.O. and the Group is credited with the contribution; or,
3. He may mail his contribution directly to General Service and an acknowledgment will be forwarded direct. His Group is credited upon request.

As to results, I invite you to look at the record on Oklahoma per capita contributions beginning in 1954 — always among the top. This has been accomplished, we believe, by the individual contributions to the Birthday Plan.

The plan of course is for everyone, but originally especially for the older members who had become inactive, but who were still grateful for their sobriety and wished to help in the 12th Step work among men and women they would never be able to contact personally. It is an exciting idea to think of our world-

wide activities and how that dollar per year that we contribute each birthday helps carry the message to those who still suffer.

In Oklahoma usually each Group appoints a "Birthday Man" who keeps track of each member's birthday, and upon that occasion explains the plan and offers the privilege of participating. I have seen younger members thrilled and excited upon being allowed to participate in this type of 12th Step work on their first birthday.

This Plan does not take the place of Group contributions. It is used for additional contributions from individual A.A.'s. However these contributions can be credited to the Group.

I urge you to see that this Birthday Plan receives the complete and proper presentation in your Area which it deserves. I know you will be pleased with the results. This is another way to say "Thanks" for our own sobriety and continue to "Carry the message."

—Mike R., Oklahoma.

Our personal task

Our guideline must be our 10th Step. Have I, Ray M., contributed my fair share of time, money, and talent? Have I done all I could to instill in my fellow A.A.'s a sense of obligation and a desire to fulfill it? I was fortunate to have been introduced at the very beginning of my sobriety to the limitless opportunities of General Service by a sponsor who was not only aware of their importance, but was doing what he could to accept them, and saw fit to share them with me.

Have I always been willing to do the same for the guy still coming down the pike?

How can financial responsibility be expressed better than in our "I Am Responsible" declaration?

Just as we meet and face the financial responsibility of the local Group as individuals, so too, we are bound by our 7th Tradition to accept the burden of financial responsibility at the world level as individuals.

Informed A.A.'s are grateful A.A.'s, grateful A.A.'s are contributing A.A.'s. I think at times we get too statistical with our pie charts and graphs. Let a qualified person present the true life stories of how A.A. is struggling to survive in far distant lands, in terms of suffering individuals, sick and helpless alcoholics; and then take up a collection and you will have something you can see, feel, and count with which to help meet our financial responsibility.

—Ray M., Pennsylvania.

REPORTS

Group contributions down from 1964

1. 1965 Group contributions totaled \$279,000 — 2% (\$5,000) below 1964. Contributions were 7% (\$21,000) less than budgeted. Expenses (Group, General Fund, Publishing) were kept to 1% (\$4,000) below the figures projected by the Budget Committee.
2. The total operating deficit for 1965 was \$27,120 compared to \$15,560 in 1964. However, the situation was helped considerably by \$12,950 net income from the 30th Anniversary Convention. This reduced the 1965 deficit to \$14,170.
3. Publishing activities of A.A. World Services, Inc. earned \$38,190. For 1964, earnings were \$46,480. After paying its own share of operating expenses, the publishing operation contributed \$41,000 to the General Service Board General Fund to help pay the cost of other services.

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

INCOME

Income from sales was 7.3% less than anticipated in the budget. This was due to a downward trend that began at the end of 1964 and continued for the first seven months of 1965. However, sales for the last five months of the year have shown an increase of 6.3% over the same period in 1964.

EXPENSES

Total publishing expenses were under the budget by 2.8%. Shipping and Mailing costs and Publishing Salaries were \$4,700 under budget due to reduced quantity of orders.

The publishing operation netted \$9,000 less than anticipated.

OFFICE EXPENSES—GROUP SERVICES (GROUP FUND)

INCOME

Contributions received were 7% less than budgeted. Here, also, the downward trend began at the end of 1964 and continued through the first seven months of 1965. Contributions for the last five months of 1965 show an increase of 7% over the same period in 1964-65.

EXPENSES

Total Expenses were within 1% of budget.

Group contributions failed to support their share by \$40,000.

GENERAL FUND — COST OF BOARD MEETINGS, P.I.C. AND SPECIAL PROJECTS

INCOME

The net income from the 1965 Toronto Convention, \$12,000, was deposited to this account.

EXPENSES

Total Expenses were \$3,800 less than budgeted. Elimination of travel expenses in connection with the July Board Meeting (plus other economies) made this possible.

Net General Fund expenses were \$12,000.

RECAP

This all resulted in a total deficit of \$14,000 which we were able to meet from the General Fund and through transfer of Reserve Fund investment income.

—Archibald Roosevelt
(Class A) Chairman, G.S. Board Finance Committee.

BILL'S STATEMENT ON HIS FINANCES

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board.

Dear Archie,

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership. Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audits. This practice will, of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilber Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amount I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,
Bill
(Signed in full)

WGW/nw

P.S. I hope the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

Conference Action

Pension Fund, Film Costs O.K.'d

The Conference agreed with its Finance Committee that in the long run education about A.A.'s world services will create interest in G.S.O. and bring forth from members necessary funds to support the services. A.A. members do feel responsible, when they are informed, someone remarked.

Cost of the film, "Bill's Own Story," was charged half to the 1965 Budget (\$5,200) and an equal amount to 1966, the Finance Committee reported. The Conference approved.

ASK-IT BASKET

Q. Elimination of individual receipts for Birthday Plan contributions has caused some disappointment in our Area. There is a psychological advantage for an individual to get a note from G.S.O. Can we reinstate

individual receipt system?

A. G.S.O. has not eliminated this. Acknowledgments continue to be sent to individuals for birthday or individual contributions, when G.S.O. is advised of the fact.

Q. Does G.S.O. look to the Group or to the individual for the suggested annual average contribution of \$3.00?

A pension plan for G.S.O. employees, described by Robert W. P. Morse, new Class A Trustee, was also approved. The Grapevine will pay \$3,500 annually and A.A.W.S. the balance, from book discounts waived. The General Fund will be tapped for deficiency if it should ever be necessary. The plan will be administered by the Bank of New York, on advice of the G.S. Board's Retirement Committee. Surplus book discounts will be put into deferred pension accounts.

A. G.S.O. looks to the Group, but money is collected regularly from individuals at meetings, or a percentage set aside from each meeting collection, or a percentage taken periodically from the Group treasury. Groups use many methods to collect the suggested \$3.00 per member average.

Q. Can the Group Contribution Chart be broken down instead of by state, by Delegate Area?

A. Delegates will receive duplicates of the statements sent to each Group in the Area, and are asked to forward any statements for Groups not in their Area to the proper Delegates.

Q. How can we stimulate more interest in the "Birthday Plan"? How many of the Delegates participate?

(continued on page 39)

1965 GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. M.C.P.	% of Gps. on M.C.P.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita	CANADA	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. M.C.P.	% of Gps. on M.C.P.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alabama	60	8	13.3%	40	67%	\$ 2,112.00	1,267	\$ 1.68	Alberta	123	3	2.4%	64	52%	\$ 3,035.34	1,205	\$ 2.52
Alaska	31	4	12.8	20	65	1,376.80	315	4.38	Atlantic Prov.								
Arizona	102	10	10.0	54	53	2,690.44	1,317	2.04	New Brunswick	33	5	15.2	24	73	730.39	453	1.61
Arkansas	55	7	12.7	32	58	1,729.15	926	1.87	Newfoundland	10	1	10.0	7	70	281.06	139	2.02
California	1,113	162	14.6	675	61	34,582.16	23,586	1.47	Nova Scotia	55	3	5.5	33	60	1,126.64	657	1.71
Colorado	80	9	11.3	53	66	2,634.23	1,453	1.81	Prince Ed. Is.	15	1	6.7	11	73	472.00	246	1.92
Connecticut	136	13	9.6	74	55	4,735.06	2,430	1.95	Brit. Columbia	178	11	6.2	108	61	5,620.97	2,111	2.66
Delaware	20	2	10.0	16	80	1,250.00	360	3.47	Manitoba	69	3	4.3	36	52	2,691.28	1,321	2.04
Dist. of Columbia	29	10	34.7	24	83	2,410.00	1,404	1.72	N.W. Territories	3	—	—	1	33	21.00	21	1.00
Florida	258	35	13.6	152	59	10,139.54	3,919	2.59	Ontario	381	17	4.5	220	58	10,962.03	5,049	2.17
Georgia	138	16	11.6	82	59	3,186.07	1,951	1.63	Quebec	255	10	3.9	131	51	3,994.66	4,622	.86
Hawaii	27	2	7.5	16	58	570.00	309	1.84	Saskatchewan	117	1	0.1	59	50	2,231.64	1,312	1.70
Idaho	31	1	3.2	20	74	786.50	420	1.87	Yukon Terr.	2	—	—	2	100	86.20	44	1.96
Illinois	558	22	4.0	183	33	8,663.09	10,608	.82	TOTAL for CANADA	1,241	55	4.4%	696	56%	\$ 31,253.21	17,180	\$ 1.82
Indiana	185	15	8.1	102	55	4,662.00	2,414	1.93	TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	9,062	752	8.3%	5,205	57%	\$274,109.05	150,966	\$ 1.82
Iowa	97	10	10.3	48	49	3,725.52	1,814	2.05	FOREIGN								
Kansas	97	3	3.1	53	55	2,493.15	1,763	1.41	Foreign	2,136					\$ 2,593.63	43,239	
Kentucky	97	1	1.0	65	67	1,545.95	1,053	1.47	Lone Members						134.42	628	
Louisiana	102	1	0.1	49	48	3,081.16	1,728	1.78	World Hello								
Maine	47	1	2.1	28	60	868.00	502	1.73	International						100.00		
Maryland	99	16	16.2	81	82	4,224.50	1,604	2.63	Doctors						1,089.23	10,774	
Massachusetts	198	12	6.1	120	61	6,292.25	3,943	1.59	Hospital Gps.	569					411.18	26,157	
Michigan	361	40	11.1	210	58	13,452.14	5,754	2.47	Prison Groups	677					767.15	341	
Minnesota	278	4	1.4	189	68	7,594.73	4,759	1.60	Internationalist								
Mississippi	36	1	2.8	24	67	1,826.00	686	2.66	GRAND TOTAL	12,444					\$279,204.66	232,105	
Missouri	141	10	7.1	82	59	4,146.29	2,795	1.48									
Montana	46	3	6.5	28	61	1,009.24	550	1.84									
Nebraska	65	1	1.5	45	69	2,127.99	611	3.48									
Nevada	57	5	8.8	28	49	1,135.46	867	1.31									
New Hampshire	30	2	6.7	17	57	948.50	448	2.12									
New Jersey	239	23	9.6	152	64	7,454.54	3,253	2.29									
New Mexico	48	1	2.0	34	71	1,480.89	864	1.72									
New York	497	75	15.0	331	67	23,466.78	9,233	2.54									
North Carolina	192	3	1.6	102	53	4,252.05	2,680	1.59									
North Dakota	44	1	2.3	28	64	800.00	517	1.55									
Ohio	427	23	5.4	246	58	12,236.29	8,300	1.47									
Oklahoma	94	28	29.8	61	65	5,118.66	1,311	3.90									
Oregon	112	11	10.0	61	54	2,706.74	1,126	2.40									
Pennsylvania	291	21	7.2	176	60	9,370.49	4,769	1.96									
Rhode Island	28	4	14.2	15	54	1,256.00	454	2.77									
South Carolina	77	4	5.2	42	55	2,426.65	1,135	2.14									
South Dakota	48	1	2.1	25	52	1,295.30	776	1.67									
Tennessee	66	2	3.0	39	59	1,914.00	1,107	1.73									
Texas	387	25	6.5	196	51	12,240.21	7,037	1.74									
Utah	54	3	5.6	30	56	1,059.83	714	1.48									
Vermont	26	2	7.8	16	62	918.26	317	2.90									
Virginia	126	18	14.3	77	61	5,546.50	2,366	2.34									
Washington	213	21	9.9	104	49	5,100.14	2,516	2.03									
West Virginia	35	1	2.9	27	77	1,461.00	430	3.40									
Wisconsin	183	1	0.6	108	59	5,021.84	2,412	2.08									
Wyoming	29	1	3.5	14	48	674.75	359	1.88									
Commonwealth of P.R.	31	2	6.5	14	45	652.00	499	1.31									
Canal Zone	2	—	—	1	50	425.00	55	7.73									
TOTAL for U.S.	7,821	697	8.9%	4,509	58%	\$242,855.84	133,786	\$ 1.82									

GROUP CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1964-65

	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
U.S.A. 1965	7,821	4,509	58%	\$242,855.84	133,786	\$ 1.82
U.S.A. 1964	7,534	4,581	61	251,085.82	128,498	1.95
Increase (Decrease)	287	(72)	(3%)	\$ (8,229.98)	5,288	\$ (.13)
Canada 1965	1,241	696	56%	\$ 31,253.21	17,180	\$ 1.82
Canada 1964	1,146	645	56	27,145.11	15,928	1.70
Increase (Decrease)	95	51	—0—	\$ 4,108.10	1,252	\$.12
U.S.A. & Canada '65	9,062	5,205	57%	\$274,109.05	150,966	\$ 1.82
U.S.A. & Canada '64	8,680	5,226	60	278,230.93	144,426	1.93
Increase (Decrease)	382	(21)	(3%)	\$ (4,121.88)	6,540	\$ (.11)

(continued from page 37)

- A. There is information on this plan in our folder, "You, Your Group and A.A. Worldwide." G.S.O. has available a container for the Birthday envelopes. One Delegate said it is a custom in his Area to send on A.A. anniversaries a personal birthday card, a packet of the Grapevine's "Best of Bill," and a birthday envelope. A show of hands showed only about 20% of the Areas use the plan.

Coffee Break

(continued from page 26)

of us who had the privilege of meeting them really wonder about A.A.s who don't care about alcoholics overseas.

Why didn't Kleina and Dennis stand up when "civilian" Staff took bows at the dinner?

Ben B. and Paul R. from the Wild West said they feel so much great big wonderful work is being done that they're the only two A.A.'s left who carry the message by Pony Express!

Some of the best laughs: "Working at G.S.O. is different from working in other offices—we don't have to compete for anything!" "I wasn't the town drunk—there were three of us!" "I had a terrific capacity for alcohol, but always got drunk before I reached it."

There were some tears, too. Lots of people were seen rubbing their eyes when the lights went up at the finish of the film showing that long, lanky Vermonter strolling away through the woods. And when Trustee Frank R. said, "I knew walking down the aisle that October afternoon to give away my niece in marriage with the sun streaming through those church windows that the grace of God had come to this old Bowery bum" but we laughed when he told of his association with then-Governor Coolidge: "I was assistant executive messenger."

Other former A.A. Trustees seen at the dinner: Tom K. and the handsome Mrs. K. from Englewood Cliffs, N.J., and Sumner and Hilda C. from Casa Serena, N.Y.

Among the better looking guests: Gene K.'s daughter and Dr. John Norris's clergyman son. Lois also introduced Henrietta S., Sue L., and Holly C., from Al-Anon Headquarters.

One of the loveliest prayers was Mike R.'s: "God take me to someone, or bring someone to me, in order that I may give him a portion of myself." It sums up what the Conference is all about, and what A.A. is, really.

Bill

(continued from page 8)

We all know that publication of that volume marked a vast turning point in our affairs. Before, we were preoccupied with our small Group, and ourselves. These motivations prevented our relapse into the old days of dog eat dog, and competition for money. We wound up with no money but we wound up with a message carrier.

At each major turning point in our affairs, when radical decisions had to be taken — not so much changing our fundamentals, but enlarging them and increasing chances of others to survive and walk through that ever-widening gateway into a new life — at every single turning point we have gone through the same paroxysm and it never has hurt us one bit!

I say, on the basis of this experience, no longer should we fear each other. I remember a line from the Big Book. I think it says that fear is the evil, corroding thread that ran through our lives. It is but a step from fear to prudence, from fear to one of the greatest virtues that men know. Prudence is rational concern without worry, and to me that is the meaning of that slogan, "Principles before Personalities." Development and adoption of our Traditions (not founded on our good behavior, but upon bad behavior) teach us this same lesson. There wasn't any wide acceptance of the Traditions at first. The only justification for printing them was a few of us in G.S.O. knew of the terrible strife in those days among the Groups. Valiant attempts

were being made to maintain unity, and all of this vast experience poured across our G.S.O. desks. So the Traditions were a teaching by those of us who behaved badly, and that was most of us sometimes.

The Traditions were hard learning, based upon what not to do. From there we could proceed on what to do.

The same fears arose when this Conference was suggested — the risks were too great, the cult of personality with the professional politicians would take over.

Nothing of the sort happened. We have these guys and gals; sometimes I join them myself. But we cannot withstand the tide of truth and dedication. Not a virtue of our own, but a gift of God, which suffuses this society from one end to another.

So as we move into the years ahead, let us not be fearful. Let's not in fear or ultra-conservatism put absurd constructions on things. Right now we are going through a constant and very healthy debate on the subject of attraction versus promotion. If you wish, you can have promotion spelled "press agency," "sound trucks," and all that. Or attraction can simply mean sitting still and waiting for people to come.

There are very few absolutes in the A.A. program. We shoot for absolute sobriety, absolute anonymity at the public level, and an absolute right for a member to be a member if he says so. But the rest are open to interpretation. So let us not put an interpretation on this valued slogan, "Principles before Personalities," that would make us for one moment suppose that personality is *always* to be eliminated, that the more we resemble meek ciphers the greater the virtue, the greater the comfort, the greater the stability.

I don't think so. Because, you see, really from beginning to end all of our relationships, all of the fruitful ones, are very personal business. And you are entitled to use all of your powers of example and persuasion with a prospect. You cannot do less — it is a highly personal business.

You are not here because you are the acme of meekness. You are individuals and each of you has a personality.

But the difference between these personalities here and so many in the world around us is this: we are operating in a frame of principles truthful enough under God's grace to cause us to survive, to live, to love, and to grow. So we must leave room for something called leadership. Let us never be hasty to say when somebody is loudly in the minority that he is necessarily wrong, because he belongs to the cult of personality. Let us not say, we must not try to persuade each other.

After all, this is the way of democracy. This is the way really of the Group conscience, the way of trusted servants. It means the exercise of such gifts as each has. This sort of exercise of personality within the framework of the principles is the very essence of our life and of our growth. This we know from 30 years of experience. So let us trust our servants, and let us trust each other.

—Bill W.

A.A. BEQUEST OF \$100 O.K.

The G.S. Board can now accept a bequest of no more than \$100 left to it by an A.A. member, the 16th Conference decided. (All such bequests have previously been declined.) However, the 1966 Conference reaffirmed that G.S.O. should continue *not* to accept any bequest from non-A.A.'s.



- Q. Many members are overwhelmed when expenses of \$335,000 (sic) a year are shown. How about stressing an expected deficit of \$3.00 per Group in 1966?

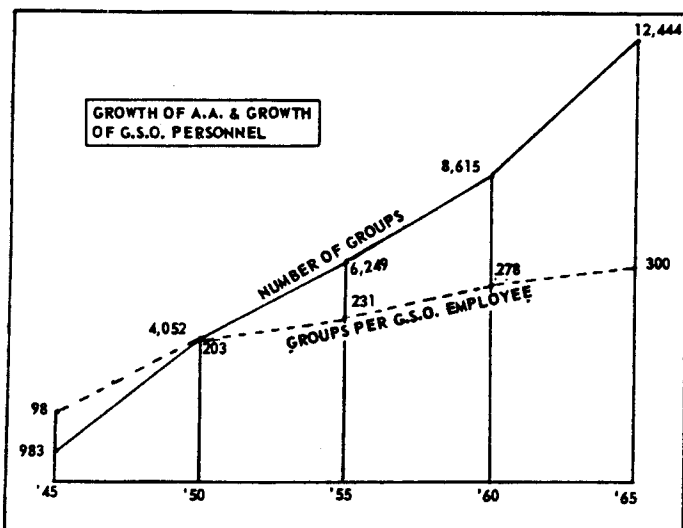
- A. Any time the budget can be explained in simpler terms, the better.

GROWTH & MONEY AT G.S.O.

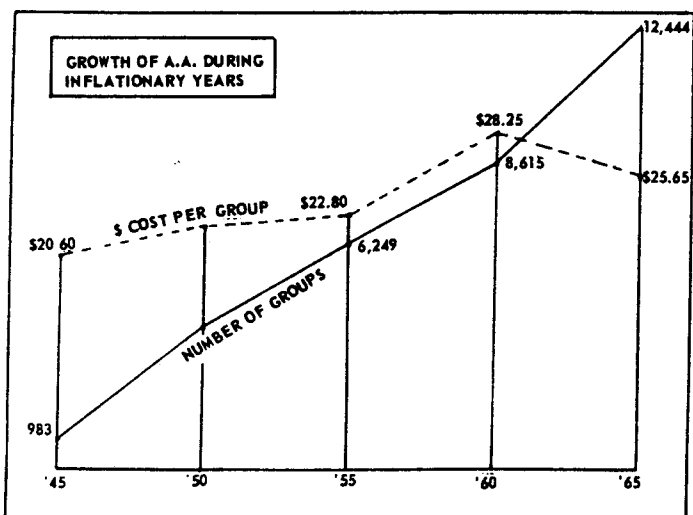
How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel — In 1945 there was one employee for each 98 Groups. Today, one employee serves each 300 Groups.

During the past twenty years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$20,000 to \$335,000 for services charged to the Group contribution account. During that same period, cost of living increased 72%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per Group actually showed a decrease from \$20.60 to \$14.92.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Employee	Living Cost
1945	983	10	98	\$ 20.60	100
1950	4,052	20	202	22.06	139
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	148
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	165
1965	12,444	41	300	25.65	172



1. (Above) There are more than 12 times as many Groups today as in 1945. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 300 Groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 98 in 1945.



2. (Above) During the years 1945 through 1965, the cost of living increased 72 percent. Constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per Group to \$25.65 in 1965 compared with \$20.60 in 1945, an increase of only 25 percent.

1966 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1966 Operations of G.S.O. activities — exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine — is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$292,300*
Less: Cost of Products	114,000
Gross Profit from Sales	178,300

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	\$ 43,400
----------------------------	-----------

*Based upon the sale of:

- 31,500 Books—"Alcoholics Anonymous"
- 11,550 Books—"12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Reg.)
- 5,000 Books—"12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Pocket)
- 3,700 Books—"A.A. Comes of Age"
- Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

OFFICE EXPENSES — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$300,000**
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TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	\$(35,000)
----------------------------	------------

**Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$32,600.

GENERAL FUND—TRUSTEES' EXPENSES

INCOME

\$ —0—

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	25,900***
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***Board Meetings, PIC Expense, Special Projects, etc.

The Publishing activity will contribute \$43,400 to the total budgeted deficit of \$60,900. The Balance totaling \$17,500 will be covered by income earned by the Reserve Fund.

1966 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and bulk sales.....	\$174,000
Estimated expenses.....	172,650
Net income from operations.....	1,350
Interest on savings accounts	3,000
Net income.....	\$ 4,490

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

EXHIBIT A

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1965

	December 31, 1965		December 31, 1964	
OPERATING FUNDS	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash	\$125,210	\$ 97,561	\$109,454	\$ 79,630
Accounts Receivable	9,965	2,415	13,430	2,252
Due from Reserve or Convention Fund	5,800		13,545	
Inventories	68,900	2,162	66,900	536
Prepaid Expenses	15,042	7,754	8,979	7,171
Total Assets	<u>\$224,917</u>	<u>\$109,892</u>	<u>\$212,308</u>	<u>\$ 89,589</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	10,315	3,353	14,232	2,452
Due Reserve or Retirement Fund	19,884	3,500	1,510	
Unearned Income — Prepaid Subscriptions		68,190		67,639
— Other	619		619	
Total Liabilities	<u>\$ 30,818</u>	<u>\$ 75,043</u>	<u>\$ 16,361</u>	<u>\$ 70,091</u>
NET WORTH				
Balance, January	195,948	19,498	211,806	934
Income (Expense) for Year (Exhibits B and C)	(14,149)	15,351	(15,859)	18,564
Refund from Convention Guarantee Fund	6,500			
Transfer from Reserve Fund	5,800			
Balance, December 31	<u>\$194,099</u>	<u>\$ 34,849</u>	<u>\$195,947</u>	<u>\$ 19,498</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
World Service Office — Group Fund (Note B)	\$ 10,972		\$ 11,045	
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	127,239		130,025	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Notes A and B)	55,888		54,877	
Total Operating Funds — as above	194,099		195,947	
Reserve Fund	313,403		307,776	
Employees' Retirement Fund	23,384			
Total Net Worth	<u>\$530,886</u>		<u>\$503,723</u>	
RESERVE AND RETIREMENT FUNDS	<u>Reserve</u>	<u>Retirement</u>	<u>Reserve</u>	
Cash	\$ 27,301		\$ 14,815	
Due from A.A. World Services, Inc.		\$ 19,884	1,510	
Due from The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		3,500		
U.S. Treasury Obligations	279,176		279,244	
Corporate Bonds	9,356		9,356	
Accrued Interest	3,370		2,851	
Less: Due to General Fund	(5,800)			
Net Assets	<u>\$313,403</u>	<u>\$ 23,384</u>	<u>\$307,776</u>	

() Denotes Red Figures.

In the attached financial statements amounts under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The EMPLOYEES' RETIREMENT FUND was established in 1965 to provide retirement benefits for employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. Groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Conference.

(continued on page 42)

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1965

	1965	1964
INCOME		
Net Sales, after Book Discounts of \$19,884 in 1965 and \$20,383 in 1964	\$274,954	\$282,641
Less: Cost of Printing	78,070	79,948
Royalties	28,372	28,790
Gross Profit from Literature	168,512	173,903
Contributions — The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	750	
— A.A. Groups, etc.	278,996	284,009
Net Income of 30th Anniversary Convention	12,948	
Total Income	\$461,206	\$457,912
EXPENSES		
Salaries	\$240,435	\$227,758
Rent	33,877	32,044
Exchange Bulletin	11,975	12,351
World Directory	18,487	16,914
Other Service Office Printing	7,214	6,797
Shipping and Mailing	29,966	32,621
Other Office Expenses	37,513	44,508
Insurance and Taxes	19,516	18,425
Professional Services, Gifts	12,518	12,242
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	8,362	11,827
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	12,345	12,937
P.I.C., Travel	7,265	5,817
General Service Conference	31,530	32,851
Foreign Literature Aid	1,850	3,220
Film, Film Strip, Display Boards	2,502	3,459
Total Expense	\$475,355	\$473,771
EXCESS OF EXPENSE (Exhibit A)	(14,149)	(15,859)
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
World Service Office — Group Fund	(\$ 40,074)	(\$ 29,962)
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc.	38,214	46,186
General Fund — General Service Board	(12,289)	(32,083)
CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS		
	<u>Retirement</u>	<u>Reserve</u>
Balance, January 1		\$276,388
Book Discounts Donated	\$19,884	20,383
Investment Income (net)		11,005
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	3,500	
Transfer to General Fund		(5,800)
Balance, December 31	\$23,384	\$307,776
() Denotes Red Figures		

(continued from page 41)

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other Funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

In the attached statements the net worth and net operating results for the year of A.A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office, and of the other Funds by their names.

NOTE A — After transfers of \$41,000 in 1965 and \$35,000 in 1964 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B — Advances of \$40,000 in 1965 and \$30,000 in 1964 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in Group contributions in those years. Advances to the Group Contribution Fund in these and prior years remaining unpaid at December 31, 1965 totaled \$166,765.

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1965

	<u>1965</u>	<u>1964</u>
INCOME — SUBSCRIPTIONS AND SALES	<u>\$173,862</u>	<u>\$169,269</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING COSTS		
Salaries	32,676	30,302
Printing	38,984	39,998
Mailing	17,773	17,253
Rent	5,230	5,253
Telephone	1,106	1,150
Office Supplies and Expense	2,765	2,194
Office Cleaning	500	500
Total	<u>\$ 99,034</u>	<u>\$ 96,650</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	\$ 29,116	\$ 27,372
Stationery and Supplies	1,475	1,527
Rent	5,230	5,253
Telephone	832	898
Office Expense	2,110	1,894
Bad Debts	259	351
Conference and Convention	955	137
Selling	3,354	2,055
Postage	3,143	3,111
Office Cleaning	500	500
Total	<u>\$ 46,974</u>	<u>\$ 43,098</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	\$ 2,879	\$ 2,562
Legal and Accounting	2,500	2,400
Taxes	4,342	4,222
Meetings	354	611
New Equipment and Depreciation	908	2,969
Total	<u>\$ 10,983</u>	<u>\$ 12,764</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>\$156,991</u>	<u>\$152,512</u>
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	<u>\$ 16,871</u>	<u>\$ 16,757</u>
Add: Interest Received	2,730	1,807
Less: Contribution to G.S.B.	(4,250)	
NET INCOME FOR PERIOD (Exhibit A)	<u><u>\$ 15,351</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 18,564</u></u>

Conference Action

Conference Leaves Preamble Wording Unchanged

"There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership" was left in the Preamble when 16th Conference members loudly voted down a suggestion to change the wording to give more emphasis to "self-support."

If the new wording had been accepted it would read like this:

...The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking. The fellowship is self-supporting through

the voluntary contributions of its members. A.A. is not allied. ...

It was widely reported by Delegates at the Conference that the Preamble is often read aloud at meetings and used to explain A.A. to newcomers and to nonalcoholics. It appears in much Conference-approved literature.

From time to time the Preamble has been changed, as was revealed in the Presentation.

PRESENTATION

Reinforcing our tradition of self-support

The "Preamble" came into being in the June, 1947, Grapevine to describe A.A. to nonalcoholics. It was then:

Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship of men and women who share their experience, strength and hope with each other that they may solve their common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism. The only requirement for membership is an honest desire to stop drinking. A.A. has no dues or fees. It is not allied with any sect, denomination, politics, organization or institution. Does not wish to engage in any controversy. Neither endorses nor opposes any causes. Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety.

Later, *honest* was taken out to conform with Bill's book **TWELVE STEPS AND TWELVE TRADITIONS**. (Experience had shown that many people sober for years had *not* had an "honest" desire when they first approached A.A.)

Another change was made in 1958 by the Board. Instead of "A.A. has no dues or fees. It is not allied, etc.," the following was substituted: "There are no dues or fees for A.A. member-

ship. We are self-supporting through our own contributions." This was believed to reflect the truth more accurately.

It came from a revision of the old pamphlet "Helpful Ally," designed to describe A.A. to those outside A.A.

The new wording proposed for discussion today would not imply that dues or fees *are* levied for A.A. membership. Instead, it would indicate that most members contribute financially to support A.A. services at the Group, Intergroup and world (G.S.O.) levels, because they feel "when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I Am Responsible."

In 1961 two Florida Committeemen suggested that "no dues or fees for A.A. membership" be deleted from the Preamble. The Conference did not favor the change.

We are considering it again now. A delegate from Texas suggested it. The Board approved and asked the 1966 Conference to consider it because "no dues or fees," when used out of context, does not accurately reflect A.A. members' sense of responsibility for maintaining vital A.A. services.

—Ann M., G.S.O. Staff.

'Self-supporting' implies obligation

The suggested change in the Preamble drew much discussion in Central Michigan. The disadvantages of deleting the words "no dues or fees" seemed to outweigh the advantages of retaining them.

The Preamble is of great value to the nonalcoholic and the new member, because they are definitely informed that they are not expected to pay. The only advantage of the deletion of the words "no dues or fees" was the money angle: if these words were deleted, it would be easier to collect money for G.S.O., local Central Offices, and individual Groups. This advantage is in reality a disadvantage because the Fifth Tradition suggests

the dangers of being diverted by problems of money, property and prestige.

The words "no dues or fees" assure me I have no financial obligation. If these words were omitted this assurance would be lacking, even though no differences actually exist. "Self-supporting" implies a kind of obligation.

When nonalcoholics tried to help me, I always used this excuse to the fullest: I could not afford anything. A.A. destroyed this excuse by telling me there were no dues or fees. The Preamble is a clear, true, and complete description of the Fellowship. I see no reason for change.

—Ralph M., Michigan.

Pennsylvanians like wording

- (1) The Preamble is an established procedure embedded in the hearts of thousands of alcoholics. Even though we might make the change, there is strong doubt that the change would be accepted by the current membership.
- (2) Many people believe A.A. *does* require dues or fees because this is the pattern in our American way of life. Therefore

our continual reiterating, even insistence, upon "no dues or fees" reaffirms to the newcomer in A.A. that we are a *fellowship* and not a club or group that one must join.

However, if this Conference decides to change the Preamble, Eastern Pennsylvania will support the Conference action.

—Gail J., Pennsylvania.

BTM-MISSING. 'Let us not open the door'

The Chicago Area feels we would be doing a disservice to future members of A.A. by deleting "no dues or fees."

It could open the door, through misinterpretation or poor advice, to the establishment of non-voluntary dues or fees. This could become a deterrent to membership, rather than emphasize "self-supporting."

We are pledged first to aid the suffering alcoholic and make it attractive and simple for him (or her) to establish membership. Many times I have heard A.A.'s say these words in the

quirements for membership other than a desire to stop drinking. Without these words this assurance would disappear. Those who follow us would be deprived of this very important guarantee.

The new, suffering recovering alcoholic, coming into A.A. and faced with this could completely collapse, feeling that his contribution is more important than his recovery.

We know this is not true, but let us not open the door, even a little, in the mind of the newcomer.

—Jim G., Illinois.

'So we can feel responsible'

I gather that putting emphasis on self-support is a hope of getting more money for our world services.

I suggest that G.S.O. circulate some of the personal help cases we hear about. The general A.A. public looks at the reserve of \$300,000 and thinks that G.S.O. is loaded. We Delegates know this is not true. We know that much more could be used to help the thousands still unreached by A.A.

"I am Responsible" is good. It does not say I am responsible

for my neighbor if he is an alcoholic and asks for help, it does not say I am responsible for the person I Twelfth Step. It says: "When *anyone, anywhere* reaches out for help, I am responsible."

I suggest that we Delegates go back to our Areas and get each member to put even one lousy dime above his regular contribution into the basket — so he, too, can feel responsible for the alcoholic, anywhere, anytime, that reaches out for help.

—Butch C., Hawaii.

Conference Action

Conference Applauds Public Information Work, Changes Name of 'Other Agencies' Committee

By changing the name of its "Committee on Relations with Other Agencies" to the "Conference Committee on Public Information," the 16th Conference tacitly gave warm approval to work now being done by local P.I. Committees and the G.S. Board's Public Information Committee—to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, but without publicizing personalities.

The Committee change of name was recommended by the "Other Agencies" group itself (Jim H., Alabama, chairman), as well as the Conference Policy Committee (Mike R., Oklahoma, chairman). Ginny D., Maryland, was named new Chairman of the Conference P.I. Committee.

Special praise was heard for the new one-minute TV film about A.A. produced by the G.S. Board's P.I. Committee for showing on local TV stations. G.S.O. makes the film available at \$20 per print to local P.I. Committees, Intergroup Offices, or

Groups. The soundtrack, for radio use, is available for \$5.

The new pamphlet, "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community," produced to replace "Helpful Ally" as an explanation of A.A. for nonalcoholics, was also well received.

In accepting the report of the "Other Agencies" Committee, the Conference also—

- (1) Again urged all Delegates to establish good lines of communication with tax-supported and voluntary alcoholism programs in their areas.
- (2) Suggested that Delegates screen requests for the World Directory from outside A.A.
- (3) Reaffirmed that the color-sound film, "Bill's Own Story," is for use by A.A. Groups only, not for outside agencies.
- (4) Recommended that when problems of A.A. relationships with other agencies arise in one area, all members of the new Conference P.I. Committee be informed.

PRESENTATION

"Having had a spiritual awakening as a result of these steps we tried to carry this message to alcoholics" (Step 12).

"Each Group has but one primary purpose — to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers" (Tradition 5).

The injunctions of Step Twelve and Tradition Five seem clear enough.

But we have Tradition Eleven which says, "Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films." I believe the last half of that Tradition is what is meant by promotion.

It would be a shame if the dogma of "no promotion" caused us to allow nothing but half-baked, distorted pictures of A.A. to reach the public. I have read many times, as I am sure you all have, TWELVE STEPS AND TWELVE TRADITIONS. I find things like this:

Without its legion of well-wishers, A.A. could never

A good look at A.A. attraction

have grown as it has. Throughout the world, immense and favorable publicity has been the principal means of bringing alcoholics into our Fellowship.

Then, in contrasting attraction and promotion, Bill writes:

Much of the political, economic and religious life of the world is dependent upon publicized leadership. People who symbolize causes and ideas fill a deep human need — but being in the public eye is hazardous, especially to us. Obviously A.A. had to be publicized somehow, so we resorted to the idea that it would be better to let our friends do this for us. That has happened to an unbelievable extent.

He explains that first the press couldn't understand our refusal of all personal publicity. Finally they got the idea and they were delighted with a "society which said it wishes to publicize its principles and its work but not its individual members."

—Murray W., Chairman,

G.S. Board Public Information Committee.

Reaching alcoholics in Michigan

Our Public Information Committee consists primarily of the General Service Committee members, thereby covering all districts. We have two long-standing Public Relations men who pass information to nearly 200 newspapers, approximately 3.4 million readers.

Does the prospective member ever read this information? Perhaps he avoids anything that mentions A.A. or alcoholism. However, his helpmate or employer is probably reading everything

on the subject.

Local "sob sisters" do a splendid job of reporting the program and referring prospects to A.A. and Al-Anon. Of course over-enthusiastic reporters and editors break anonymity.

Here we can act as G.S.R.'s and explain the importance of anonymity.

Radio is one medium where we have quite a bit of success. A local radio station put on a program entitled, "Ask an Alco-

holic." The switchboard at the radio station was swamped.

We have four TV stations. They on occasion use information received from G.S.O. and give us spot announcements on local activities. We will buy a copy of the film produced by G.S.O. and present this to the TV stations.

We try to have speakers who are to speak to outside meetings contact the local P.I. Committee. We hope he will convey to the

audience that he speaks for himself as a recovering alcoholic, not for A.A. and not as an authority on alcoholism.

But let's never edit too strongly, guide too rigidly, or influence individuals so that we remove their original intent or thoughts. A camel is a horse that was designed by a committee.

—Scotty S., Michigan.

Connecticut works hard

Our P.I.C. has been a part of our State G.S. Committee since 1961. The functions were two-fold at first:

1. To furnish, on request, information on A.A. to newspapers, magazines, radio and TV stations.
2. To provide, on request, qualified A.A. speakers for non-A.A. meetings.

A letter was sent to all Groups, explaining the function of the Committee and asking for volunteers to speak at non-A.A. groups. The Committee established working contacts with the newspapers, magazines, and air media within the state. Every one of these has a reference card on file with a local name, address and telephone number.

In 1964, a third function was added:

3. Aggressively to seek out requests from non-A.A. groups for A.A. speakers.

The daughter of a P.I.C. member, a nurse, asked her dad if something could be done to better inform the nursing profession about alcoholism and A.A. Our State Committee sent a letter to all Schools of Nursing in Connecticut. Requests came from all. Letters were sent by G.S.R.'s to church and civic groups in their communities.

Not counting radio audiences, P.I.C. handled in 1965 over 40 non-A.A. groups which totaled over 5,000 people.

Our State Police Academy includes an A.A. talk during the course of training for each new class. At least six different radio stations presented A.A. programs. Some of our Groups present public meetings. One Group just recently presented a community relations meeting to which professional people and the general public were invited. Many newspapers carry A.A. meeting schedules.

Last May at our Delegate's Conference Report Dinner meeting we had three invited guests: Mr. Ernest Shepherd, Chief of the Alcoholism Division of our state Mental Health Department; Dr. Sidney Kligerman, Deputy Commissioner of Mental Health, and Mr. William Knaut, Chairman of our Governor's Council on Alcoholism.

The P.I.C. effort is Twelfth Step work. It is carrying the message about A.A. and alcoholism to the uninformed. We believe we have been given life and it behooves us to make this life available to as many people as possible.

—"Tommy" D., Connecticut.

A.A. attraction in Colorado

Like many of us, I found my way here through one of our good nonalcoholic friends of the press. I happened across a column in the *Chicago Daily News*, about an A.A. meeting. The first lines hit me between the eyes.

A.A. attraction was working on me. Me, who had thought he was crazy, had been told he could never work again. A.A. was available. I hardly needed to read more. I found an A.A. meeting and a new world opened up.

Are we making full use of A.A.'s attraction to let people know we are here, what we and our Fellowship are like and how it works? Are we letting people know what we can't do?

After working for some time with our Denver Intergroup P.I.

Committee and spending 60 weeks with our "Ask An Alcoholic" radio program I feel such projects attract folks to A.A.

Probably the greatest attraction our Fellowship has are the 12 Traditions. Anonymity, self-support, non-affiliation, non-controversy, humility, and unity are things that do the most to attract our still drunken brethren to us.

As individual members we can convey the attraction of our program by being attractive ourselves. I do not think we can just sit in our meeting places waiting for a drunk to lean against our door and fall in. Too many are dying or ending up in institutions who could have been helped if they had known the true story of A.A.

—Jack M., Colorado.

Professionals like A.A. in Manitoba

We are most grateful for the wonderful relationship that exists between A.A. and other agencies who deal with alcoholism, because they are to a great degree responsible for the growth of A.A. in Manitoba. It has given us much opportunity for 12th Step work, and added insurance for our own sobriety.

The need of co-operation was first seen and started in Manitoba by a wonderful friend of A.A., a nonalcoholic doctor of psychiatry.

A.A. members made contacts with the medical profession, hospitals and clergy, and distributed A.A. pamphlets.

The Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba may have been one of the first to discover it was desirable to hire recovered alcoholics — not as members of A.A. but for their understanding of alcoholism, and for the example they set by their practice of "Principles before personalities."

The professional people in the provincial program, along with the recovered alcoholics on the Staff, have built a bridge of wonderful understanding, and have therefore been able to help many people.

Recently I spent a day at the Foundation Office and it was a revelation to witness the number of 12th Step calls resulting from referrals to A.A.

Some A.A. Groups work real hard at organizing public meetings, quite often held in conjunction with annual Round-Ups or Anniversaries. These meetings have some measure of success.

Best results occur when a public meeting is broadcast via radio, preceded by adequate advertising.

Cooperation is really working both ways and the rewards and blessings received are many — seeing the sick alcoholic recover, and the joy of working with others, alcoholics and non-alcoholics alike. We constantly remind ourselves of our primary purpose to carry the message. Cooperation with other agencies does not come by wishing for it. It comes by working for it.

—Jim P., Manitoba.

oOo



- Q. Do the members of this Conference feel that an Assembly, an Area, or a Group should choose as its servant an individual A.A. member who earns his living as a paid employee of a State Commission on Alcoholism or

Council on Alcoholism?

- A. By a show of hands, about two to one favored choosing such an individual if the local Group or Groups so desire. (See Tradition on autonomy.)

A.A. census, TV spot, exhibits, and Convention mark Public Information report

New data for public use in describing the scope of A.A. were approved by the G.S. Board's Public Information Committee in 1965. They are:

Total number of Groups	more than 12,000
Groups in hospitals	more than 500
Groups in prisons	more than 600
Loners	about 600
Countries	A.A. in 90
Estimated membership	more than 350,000

During the year your P.I.C. also produced a one-minute TV film about A.A. for use by local P.I.C.'s, Intergroups, and Groups (soundtrack available for radio); issued a new pamphlet to describe A.A. to nonalcoholics; prepared two new exhibits on A.A. for use at national professional gatherings; and furnished information to news media covering the Toronto Convention.

To go with the exhibits, a new pamphlet, "A.A. in Your Community," has just been issued to replace "Helpful Ally." It explains to professionals and to non-A.A. laymen just how the Fellowship can work with others to help sick alcoholics.

Other P.I.C. activities involving cooperation with news media included:

- (1) The fifth *Annual Report to the Public*, released June 30, 1965.
- (2) News releases on the election of Dr. Vincent Dole and Robert W.P. Morse as nonalcoholic trustees.
- (3) News releases sent to 652 newspapers, magazines, scientific and other specialized journals about two new A.A. pamphlets, "The A.A. Group" and "A.A. in Hospitals."

In 1965 we asked all local P.I.C.'s to send us a brief account of their activities. We have shared this wealth of experience, by sending reports to local P.I.C.'s. They cover: formation and procedures of local P.I.C.'s, use of material on radio, television, and newspapers, public meetings and talks to non-A.A. groups, and cooperation with Alcoholism Centers.

During the Convention we worked with Canadian press, radio and TV people with the very able help of Roy M., chairman of the working P.I.C. for the Convention. Our coverage in Canada during that Convention was very good in all media.

— MURRAY W., Chairman
G.S. Board Public Information Committee

G.S.O.'s hand was there when 4,687 reached out for help

G.S.O. answered 4,687 inquiries in 1965 from students, teachers, nurses, clergymen, church groups, libraries, state commissions on alcoholism, public health agencies, family and friends of alcoholics, and alcoholics themselves.

Ten national professional conferences saw our A.A. exhibits. G.S. Delegates and local Public Information Committees manned the exhibits, and distributed the pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous in your Community."

We received 4,457 newspaper clippings which mentioned Alcoholics Anonymous. When 28 anonymity breaks came to our attention, a letter on A.A.'s anonymity Tradition was sent to the media and individuals involved. Delegates received copies.

Eight cases of apparent misuse of the A.A. *Directory* were handled the same way. Where the A.A. name was involved in solicitation of funds, letters were written about our Seventh Tradition.

We have P.I. Kits prepared at G.S.O., including all of the Public Information material available.

During the past year, a number of A.A. members as well as non-members have inquired about programs to help the alcoholic in industry. We have the pamphlet, "A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee" as well as a listing of industries that have an alcoholism program. They welcome inquiries.

—BETH K., G.S.O. Staff.

Interview Time

Do members understand P.I. work or mistake it for 'promotion'?

"Do A.A.'s in your area feel Public Information activities are promotional, not attraction? Do you explain the importance of Public Information to them?"

When Delegates were asked those questions during Interview Time, it was learned that some A.A.'s are still so fearful of being known as recovered alcoholics that they condemn all P.I. work as "promotion."

Others, however, remember that they learned how A.A. could save their lives through newspaper, magazine, radio and TV information about A.A. It was generally agreed that when Public Information work is properly understood, almost everyone approves of this method of carrying the message.

It was also revealed that P.I. work is handled in almost as many ways as there are Groups! Some local Central Offices do it; some state or area G.S. Committees do it; some Groups do it on their own; and in many cases, co-operative efforts seem to work best.

The importance of the Public Information Kits from G.S.O. was stressed; and so was the pamphlet, "Speaking at Non-A.A.

Meetings." Some Delegates said that the G.S.R. could do a good job of explaining Public Information, and that Public Information Committees should go to all Groups and describe their work.

"As long as we promote principles, not personalities, we can save lots of lives," one Delegate summed it up.

'Bill's Own Story'

A.A. Groups in more than 161 localities have seen the color film, "Bill's Own Story," in Canada, New Zealand, Australia and South Africa, as well as the United States, since April, 1965.

It also had a good showing before A.A. Groups in prisons. During the first week in February, five prison Groups in North Carolina alone, totaling 475 people, viewed it.

The film is providing A.A. members worldwide with a unique opportunity to hear from Bill and Lois directly how A.A. was born and how it grew.

—N.W.

ASK-IT BASKET

has sample ads.

- Q.** Is it "kosher" to advertise a special A.A. meeting with a paid ad in the classified section of a paper?
- A.** Yes, if the ad breaks no Traditions. The P.I. Kit available from G.S.O.
- Q.** What is being done to attract the "solvent" alcoholic? Much good work is being done for the down-and-outer and the inmate, but what of those who cannot identify at this level?
- A.** More and more alcoholics not the Skid row type speak as A.A. members on radio and TV and at public meetings. The P.I. kit carries a story on the "early bottom" alcoholic. The Fortune article (reprinted as a pamphlet by G.S.O.) is still useful for this purpose. Grapevine carries material of this sort, too.
- Q.** Would it be against Traditions to ask for a collection at a big public meeting, provided visitors were asked not to contribute?
- A.** A show of hands revealed a majority of the Delegates were against taking such a collection. (G.S.O. has a list of suggestions for Public Meetings.)
- Q.** Is it against Traditions to take up a collection at any open meeting held during a weekend annual conference, providing

all visitors are requested *not* to contribute?

- A.** Majority of Delegates did not consider it against Tradition to take up such a collection, but felt it ought not to be done. (G.S.O. has a list of suggestions for planning and financing conferences and conventions.)
- Q.** Various Delegates say they talk in high schools. Has P.I.C. considered a helping hand in this area?
- A.** The P.I. pamphlet, "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" (available at G.S.O.) was prepared for this purpose.
- Q.** Should open meetings become public meetings occasionally?
- A.** Some areas do turn open meetings into public meetings. They send out information in advance and invite community officials. "The A.A. Group" tells about open meetings, closed meetings, and public meetings. It was suggested however, to avoid confusion, that a public meeting should not take the place of a regularly scheduled open meeting. The public meeting should be held on a different night, prepared in advance for a different purpose. One Delegate said in his Area a public meeting is held once a month.
- Q.** Should Public Information be handled by Central Service Offices or by the General Service Committee in each state?
- A.** This question was answered during Interview Time (see Page 47). Generally, this is a matter for local autonomy.

Conference Action

Conference Again Takes Sharp Look at Self, Shuffles Committees

The 16th Conference, like preceding ones, sharply took its own inventory and made several Committee changes to meet the needs of a growing Fellowship.

(As Conference size and work load have grown over the years, more and more specialized Committees are depended on to handle the responsibility of detailed chores and studies for the whole Conference body.)

G.S.O. Staff Members agreed unanimously that never before have Committees been so interested and well-informed in advance, or worked so hard. Delegates gave credit to the new procedure of naming Conference Committee members. (The Trustees' Policy Committee draws names at its January meeting.)

Under the new plan, Committee members had time to do their homework before coming to New York, and they arrived well-versed in the responsibilities their Committees were expected to handle.

AGENDA-ADMISSIONS COMBINED

The job of the Conference Admissions Committee—which in most years has a variable work load—was given by the 16th Conference to the old Agenda (now called Agenda-Admissions) Committee.

This was a recommendation by both Committees involved, as well as the Conference Policy Committee. Bob W., Indiana, was named new chairman of Agenda-Admissions.

The practice of naming *ex officio* Committee members was retained, as was the tenure of Committee chairmen—that is, each new Chairman takes office immediately at the close of the Conference during which he is elected.

Panel 16 members of the Admissions Committee, it happens, are all experienced and knowledgeable about A.A. in institutions. They will therefore all be named to the new Institutions Committee established by the Conference (see P. 13).

The new alignment of Conference Committees (nine in all) can be found on PP. 4 and 64.

COMMITTEE WORK: AN ELEVATOR VIGNETTE

"For a bunch of non-joiners, we sure do join hands a lot to get work done," one weary Delegate was heard to say as he left his Committee's meeting late one afternoon.

An older Delegate smiled and said, "I know. We never expected all this when we just came to A.A. to get sober, did we?"

The younger man looked solemn. "Nope," he said at last. "But it's so worthwhile. I wouldn't have missed the privilege of this service fatigue for anything! Somebody in A.A. has to care and work. Aren't we lucky to get to share in it?"

That seemed to typify Delegates' obvious feeling of responsibility at A.A.'s 16th Annual General Service Conference meeting, and everybody noticed it.

Conference Action

"How do you present the spiritual side of the program to a newcomer?" will be a discussion subject for the 17th (1967) General Service Conference meeting.

The 16th Conference decided this by accepting the report of its Agenda Committee (Jim B., Missouri, chairman). The report also recommended that —

(1) Panel 17 Delegates be asked to give 3-minute "Area

ASK-IT BASKET

Q. On what basis are topics for presentations given to Delegates?

A. *Participation is requested on the basis of a Delegate's familiarity and experience with the agenda subject.*

Highlights" in 1967, each to choose his own subject.
(2) "Interview Time," with Conference members divided into six regional groups, be used again in 1967.
(3) "Workshops and Sharing Sessions" on Third Legacy structure and procedures be repeated in 1967, but with Conference members divided alphabetically into four groups instead of two.

Q. Understood we would receive copies of the presentations within the year. Might we receive them sooner to help with Conference Reports or specific problems?

A. *You have already been given most of them. Delegates might find these too bulky to take with them. Most Delegates would like them as soon as possible. Will be mailed within a month.*

AREA DELEGATES ONLY

Virgil W., Georgia, was chosen by the Area Delegates to chair the Area Delegates Only session of the 1967 Conference (Bob P., Newfoundland, was 1966 chairman), to be held on Tuesday evening of the Conference week.

Conference Action

Fourth Delegate from Ontario To be Admitted to 17th Conference

A Delegate from Northwest Ontario will be admitted to the 1967 Conference, it was decided when the 16th Conference unanimously approved the recommendation of its Admissions Committee (Clarence T., Wisconsin, chairman). This gives Ontario a total of four Delegates.

The Committee reported that the decision was based mostly on the vast territory to be served. They also considered possibilities of redistricting the Area and getting G.S.R.'s to become more effective. Some members believed election of a Delegate

for the Northwest Ontario Groups will spur A.A. growth there.

The Committee admitted that this new admission might spark additional requests for more Delegates from other areas, but said that each request would have to be considered on its individual merits.

Paul H., New Jersey, was elected new chairman of the Admissions Committee (to be reconstituted as an Institutions Committee—see P. 48).

Conference Action

Committees Recommend Changes In MANUAL and 'Report'

Several changes in the THIRD LEGACY MANUAL and Conference Reports were recommended by the Committees of the 16th Conference, and approved when the Conference accepted their reports.

Each seems designed to save time, labor and paper work, as well as to improve communications and members' knowledge of the Third Legacy.

The suggested changes and the Committees that proposed them are:

1. When the THIRD LEGACY MANUAL is updated, it should carry a glossary of terms such as *Area, District, Assembly*, etc., so terms can become more uniform throughout the continent (Agenda).
2. The summary of all previous Conference "Advisory Actions," now mimeographed and sent yearly to all Conference members, should include only the actions of the first fifteen Conferences (1951-65) and should be a chapter in the new THIRD LEGACY MANUAL when it is written. Then only the most recent actions will have to be compiled and distributed annually, and all readers of the MAN-

UAL can see what actions the Conference took in its first formative years (Policy, and Report and Charter).

3. The digest of "Questions and Answers" of previous Conferences (also mimeographed and sent each year to all Conference members) is to be condensed more.
4. Permanent records of the minutes of all Conference Committee meetings should be established at G.S.O., available as needed, but such detailed reports need not necessarily be printed in the *Final Conference Report* unless acted upon by the entire Conference (Report and Charter).
5. State Chairmen as well as Delegates should receive the mailings mentioned in 2, and 3, above (Report and Charter).
6. The "Grapevine" deserves commendation for continuing to carry to its readers news of Conference meetings, and is requested to notify readers they can get copies of the *Final Conference Report* from G.S.O. (Report and Charter).
7. Delegates are urged to see that Area G.S. Committees purchase and distribute *Final Conference Reports* to all Groups, or get G.S.R.'s to do so (Report and Charter).

Hank E., Kansas, was elected Chairman of the Conference Report and Charter Committee for 1967.

Conference Action

Delegates' Expense Set-up To be Re-studied in 1967

A suggested way for Conference expenses to be more equally shared by all Areas that send Delegates was tabled by the 16th Conference, for further study.

Because Areas farthest removed from New York now have to dig up much more money than others to pay Delegates' Conference expenses, Areas closest to New York do not pay an equitable share of the overall Conference expenses.

Therefore Delegates voted that the question should be studied by all Areas during the next year, to find some fairer distribution of financial responsibility for the Conference.

Under the present system, retained by the 1966 Conference, each Area is asked to pay the first \$100 of its Delegate's travel expense only. G.S.O. (from its budgeted Conference funds) reimburses him for the additional travel expense, and also provides \$96.00 per Delegate for meals, incidentals, and the hotel room for five nights.

The new formula, not accepted by the Conference, was recommended 11 to 2 by the Conference Finance Committee (Bob D., Minnesota, Chairman), and also by the Conference Policy Committee (Mike R., Oklahoma, Chairman).

Under it, every Area would have been asked to pay the first \$125 of its Delegates' total expenses, instead of the first \$100 toward travel only; in addition each Delegate would have an extra night at the hotel paid for by the Conference. The overall saving to the Conference could have been about \$2,700 per year.

Examples of both systems are:

1. A West Coast Delegate might have these expenses:

Fare	\$305.75
Hotel, meals	96.00
Extra hotel night	14.00
Total	\$414.75

Under the old formula, if the Area pays only the first \$100 of travel expense and for the one extra hotel night (a total of \$114), the Conference has to pick up the tab for the balance—\$300.75.

Under the new formula, this Area like every other would have paid a total of \$125, leaving the Conference to pay only \$289.75.

2. An East Coast Delegate might have these expenses:

Fare	\$ 24.00
Hotel, meals	96.00
Extra hotel night	—
Total	\$120.00

Under the old formula, his Area pays only \$24 while the Conference foots the rest of the bill, \$96.

Under the proposed new system not endorsed by the 1966 Conference, his Area like every other would pay \$125 toward his total expenses, and the Conference would be stuck for only \$9, even if it did provide him the badly needed extra night's lodging, at \$14.

BEHIND THE VOTING

Some Delegates from near New York (whose Areas would have to share more of the Conference financial responsibility under the new system) said they voted against the new plan because their Areas cannot or will not pay the expense of sending a Conference Delegate, and he often pays his own travel expense.

Some Delegates from Areas farther away pointed out that no Area should ever have to reject a good Delegate because he isn't rich, and be forced to choose a less qualified "trusted servant" just because he has the money to foot his own bill.

The whole idea of having the Conference itself pay part of Delegates' expenses is to make it possible for Areas to send the best Delegate possible, whether he's rich or not.

Frank C., Southeastern New York Delegate who lives in Brooklyn, announced that his whole travel expense is two subway tokens, or 30¢. He suggested that all fares be added and divided by the number of Delegates, and then each Area could pay the same amount—its fair share of the total travel expenses.

Another East Coast Delegate said he did not see why West Coast A.A. Groups should subsidize the East Coast Groups that won't dig up enough dough to send a man to New York once a year. "We love A.A. as much as Alaska does," he declared, "and I think we ought to do whatever is necessary to carry our fair share of the load."

The 1967 Policy Committee (Ed D., Oregon, chairman) and the 1967 Finance Committee (Roger L., Massachusetts, chairman) were asked to reconsider the whole question for next year's Conference.

Conference Action

Miami First Choice For 1970 Convention

Miami, Florida, was picked by the 1966 Conference as the place for A.A.'s 35th Anniversary Convention in 1970.

In accepting the report of the "Site Committee" (the Policy Committee, the Chairman of World Services and three Coordinators of the 1965 International Convention) the Conference also designated Chicago, Illinois, as second choice.

The Site Committee — meeting in accordance with the *Procedures Affecting A.A.'s International Conventions*, outlined in 1965 — had high praise for all Delegates who made presentations in behalf of their cities. Those heard were from Chicago, Washington, D.C., Miami, New York, San Antonio and Seattle. Average July temperature in Miami is 82.3 degrees.

REPORT

Toronto 1965: 'I am Responsible' - all this and profit, too!

More than 10,435 A.A.'s and their families gathered in Toronto, Ontario, Canada, July 2, 3 and 4, 1965, to record in history the Fellowship's 30th Anniversary Year. Their gratitude found expression in the Convention theme, "Responsibility," and the hearts of all seemed to be stirred as they joined 58 Delegates and 15 A.A.'s from around the world declaring individually and in unison at the big Saturday meeting: "When anyone, anywhere reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that 'I AM RESPONSIBLE.'"

These glorious days came about through a loving God as he expressed himself through the Group Conscience of the hundreds involved:

The Convention could not have happened without their help. And, without every A.A. who took the action and assumed the responsibility of being there.

Where did the 10,435 A.A.'s come from?

First — 1,200 came from within a 50-mile radius of Toronto. Probably Jerry came the least distance — he works at the Royal York!

Second — Each State and Province was represented. 3,700 from Ontario, and 4,900 from all of Canada. United States sent a total of 5,400 divided regionally: 1,600 from the Northeast — the same from the East Central — 800 from the Southeast — 500 from the West Central — 450 from the Pacific and 350 from

the Southwest.

From outside North America came a total of 127 — the largest number (43) from Finland. The farthest distance — two from Australia and one from New Zealand. They all added much to our feeling of gratitude for A.A. now reaching truly 'round the world.

"I AM RESPONSIBLE" seems to be permeating and stirring A.A.'s everywhere to action. Service had a rebirth.

All this and heaven too — YES — the Convention was a financial success. Registration fee of \$5.00 plus \$3.00 for

Dance and Show, and the profit from the sale of "A.A./30" Convention souvenir books made it possible to pay all expenses totaling \$51,000 and clear nearly \$13,000 which was used to help meet service costs on the 1965 G.S.O. budget.

A.A.'s 30th was the best anniversary year yet. The message was carried — but we know there is more and better to come as we continue to live A.A. and carry the message to the thousands of still sick alcoholics who will join us in 1970!

—Herb M. and Hazel R., G.S.O. Staff, (Convention Committee).

PRESENTATION

Anonymity Within A.A.

Traditions Eleven and Twelve are related. Tradition Eleven states: "Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and film."

Tradition Twelve states: "Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all of our Traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities."

As Bill reminded us in his article, "Why Alcoholics Anonymous is Anonymous" (the May, 1966 Grapevine): "Our book, TWELVE STEPS AND TWELVE TRADITIONS, states that anonymity is the greatest protection our Society can ever have. It says also that the spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice."

Some A.A.'s equate anonymity at the *public* level with anonymity *within* A.A. Bill's Grapevine article emphasizes: "Of course, no A.A. need be anonymous to family, friends or neighbors. Disclosure there it is usually right and good. Nor is there any special danger when we speak at Group or semi-public A.A. meetings provided press reports reveal first names only."

At times, we find so much anonymity *inside* A.A. that . . .

1. Members never have an opportunity of knowing one another except at meetings, and then only by first names.
2. It is difficult for anyone wanting information about A.A. to obtain it because everyone is so anonymous that A.A. is actually unknown in the community.
3. Twelfth Step work becomes difficult because members are unwilling to reveal their identity to other members or to make their full names, addresses and telephone numbers available to Group officers.

The Holiday (1965-66) issue of the "Exchange Bulletin" had these comments about anonymity within the Fellowship:

Within A.A. itself we stop being ashamed of our illness, and freely exchange our full names.

We keep address books of A.A. names and telephone numbers,

and we publish a confidential A.A. World Directory — all so we can keep in touch with, and help, each other.

In personal, private, face-to-face relationships with nonalcoholics we are not ashamed to say we are recovered, or recovering, alcoholics.

Besides, this often helps carry the message to others.

This in no way violates our Tradition about *public* anonymity. When you tell the facts about yourself, *privately*, it's not an anonymity break.

Besides, passing on our experience, strength and hope to other alcoholics is too important to let any fear of discovery or stigma stand in our way. If Bill and Dr. Bob had said, "People wouldn't understand," and hadn't passed the message on, where would we all be?

We do not hide our alcoholism in guilty secrecy out of fear and shame. That would actually strengthen even further the cruel stigma that unfortunately surrounds the victims of our illness.

We remain anonymous in public for two reasons: 1) our promise of privacy to the still-suffering alcoholic and his family, and 2) a spiritual reason, summed up in Tradition Twelve, or in the word humility.

With anonymity, we renounce personal prestige for our A.A. recovery and work, and place the emphasis on our principles — the Power that really heals us — not on our personal selves. That's why Dr. Bob, discouraging plans for a massive A.A. memorial mausoleum, said, "I want to just get buried like anybody else." That's why Bill turned down the dream of his life, an LL.D. degree from one of the world's mightiest, proudest universities. Those two men set the example for all of us.

For the good of A.A. as a whole, then, and for every alcoholic in it (or on his way to it), don't you think we need to keep thinking deeply and spiritually about anonymity for a long time to come?

—Ann M., G.S.O. Staff.

'Makes little sense to me'

There was no such thing as "anonymity within A.A." in my Group in Canton, Ohio, where I first became associated with A.A., or in the Groups in the surrounding area. So I'm not used to anonymity *within* A.A. and I don't have much enthusiasm for it. In fact, I think it might preclude warmth and enthusiasm at meetings, and encourage coldness or apathy.

In the Big Book (which I understand was entitled ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS only because in 1939 the name A WAY OUT had been preempted) the only reference to the words "anonymity" or "anonymity" I can find are in the foreword:

It is important that we remain anonymous in order to more effectively handle the overwhelming number of personal appeals which may result from this publication. Being mostly business or professional folks some of us could not carry on our occupations if known. We would like it known that our alcoholic work is an avocation. The idea was not individual anonymity as an end in itself. Later, anonymity at the public level was emphasized for A.A.'s protection, not the individual's. Bill wrote: We simply couldn't afford to take the chance of letting self-appointed members present themselves as messiahs representing A.A. before the whole public . . . If even

one publicly got drunk or was lured into using A.A.'s name for his own purposes, the damage might be irreparable.

On the other hand, the promise of anonymity has great appeal to many newcomers, and I believe vehemently that each member has a right that other members respect his anonymity.

In trying to carry the message to prospective members some of us indulge in name-dropping to make the program appear more respectable. This is not to be condoned, but I am not so naive as to think that it will not continue.

To sum up —

- 1) Anonymity at the public level is essential to protect A.A. as a whole.
- 2) Anonymity outside of A.A. itself of an individual is his right and should be recognized and respected.
- 3) Anonymity within A.A. makes little sense to me and may make more difficult for some the all-important job of staying sober.
- 4) I see no indication in my area of any trend towards anonymity within A.A. and would indeed be sorry if such a trend were to exist.

—Bruce M., Ohio, Class B Trustee.

Let us take 'Tradition Inventory'

With the help of people acquainted with Central Office work, we compiled a procedure list:

1. Strict adherence to the Traditions.
2. Never give out names or phone numbers without permission.
3. When employers or family call in, requesting information regarding the A.A. activities of members, it is explained that we do not keep records or check on people.
4. When requests come in for speakers, the member chosen for the job gets in touch. He uses his own judgment regarding anonymity.
5. Minutes of meetings and reports are kept to first names, the same for bulletins. All volunteers for speakers and

Twelfth Step calls are treated the same way.

6. Everyone who has business of any nature with the Central Office is made aware of our Tradition of anonymity, and efforts are made to assure everyone that this trust will not be broken.

Step Ten has played a vital part in my recovery. I do it today with consideration of how I stand with the other eleven. And so it is with our Traditions. I must inventory here, too. I am not someone special, and all the principles were here before I came. They have all met the test of proper investigation. My concern at the moment is, can I measure up too?

—Sheldon B., New York.

'A spiritual foundation . . .'

We try in a stumbling way to continue to give away what we have received through the goodness of another. If this is done for personal recognition, conflict exists. Our foundation and principles would certainly be weakened.

In recent years we have been called upon by "outside agencies" or groups concerned with alcoholism in the community. With all this activity, anonymity has never presented a deterrent to communication *within* A.A.

As of now the general membership has not strayed from our Tradition.

Anonymity within A.A. in small towns in our Area is rarely practiced; everyone knows everyone else and a genuine fellow-

ship is evident.

In cities the attitude is somewhat different. Many separate themselves completely from all activities to guard their anonymity, contributing little or nothing to carry the message.

Can you imagine anyone being around this wonderful unorganized organization and not make some friends or at least have a few names to call? We admitted that we are alcoholics, to ourselves and to other members. This acceptance and disclosure is privileged and should remain privileged to each member if he or she wants to remain anonymous within A.A.

—Maurice R., Louisiana.

'Mutual trust and admiration...'

After more than thirty years of A.A. growth, much of the stigma which once was inherent in alcoholism has been dissipated. This is manifest in almost universal public acceptance and esteem of our Fellowship.

Many with long, successful, unbroken periods of sobriety have records of service, growth and achievement which bring to the Fellowship the highest public recognition. This encourages maximum service on the part of A.A. members. We feel in the Area I represent that maximum service could not be rendered under strict anonymity *within* A.A. and at levels below the press, radio and films.

Years ago, in a small city where I still live, the decision was made to invite the leading citizens to the first A.A. meeting held, and to ask a leading citizen to preside.

This was a forerunner of scores of similar ones. Often non-alcoholics were invited to speak. Through this practice a partnership involving genuine respect and understanding developed between A.A. members and interested non-A.A.'s. This feeling of mutual trust and admiration unquestionably had its influence on the degree of anonymity practiced below the Traditional levels, and encouraged a liberal interpretation of anonymity.

Anonymity below the Traditional level should be a matter of personal choice; no member, however, should divulge the name of another without express consent and direction.

The consensus in my Area is that if the dropping of anonymity is not for personal praise or gain, but makes the individual A.A. member more effective in carrying the message, then, and only then, should full names be used. —E. Morris M., Texas.

ASK-IT
BASKET

- Q. Would it be within our Traditions to wear a pin like the symbol used on our Conference-approved literature, the circle enclosing the triangle?

- A. Sense of the meeting was that wearing of these pins is within our Traditions, does not break anonymity at the public level.

oOo

Conference
Action

Directory not for Commercial Use, Conference Stresses

In quick and loud unanimous votes, the 16th Conference reaffirmed the present policy of listings in the *World Directory*:

"Traditionally, any two or more alcoholics meeting together for purposes of sobriety may consider themselves an A.A. Group, provided that, as a Group, they are self-supporting and have no outside affiliations. Groups listed in the *Directory* are registered at their own request. A *Directory* listing does not constitute or imply approval or endorsement of any Group's approach to, or practice of, the traditional A.A. program."

It also reaffirmed the policy of "no commercial use," defined thus in the *Directory*:

"The *World Directory* is confidential to A.A. members for sharing A.A. information and activities. It is not to be used as a mailing list for any form of solicitation or any commercial venture."

It was the sense of the Conference that information concerning tokens, pins, etc., not be considered an A.A. purpose and the *Directory* should not be used.

* * * * *

These followed a presentation on the subject meant not only for G.S.O., but for all who use the *Directory*.

PRESENTATION

G.S.O. seeks advice on 'Directory' questions

The first list of A.A. Groups published by G.S.O. was mimeographed in November, 1940.

A bulletin was sent to all Groups on May 15, 1945, seeking guidance: "There is some discussion about the use of our confidential Group list for matters not strictly about A.A. Inasmuch as your Central Office (G.S.O.) and the Trustees feel it is up to the membership to decide such questions of policy, we are asking for your opinions."

As a result, the following statement was added to the list of A.A. Groups issued in February 1946: "This confidential list, to be used for A.A. purposes only, is distributed to Secretaries for the use of Group members and to a limited number of A.A.'s who travel extensively."

The Spring, 1950 *Directory* had these words on the front cover, "It is confidential — to be used for A.A. purposes only and not as a mailing list for promotion."

Several Conferences have discussed the misuse of the *World Directory* by A.A. members, urging that Groups observe the purpose of the *Directory* as stated on the inside cover of the book. However, Conferences have cautioned against interfering with free communication among A.A.'s.

In regard to misuse of the *Directory* by non-members, it has been recommended that a letter be sent to the person or agency misusing the *Directory*, pointing out that the book is confidential and for A.A. use only.

The fifth (1955) Conference suggested that A.A. members protest individually in writing when misuse of the *Directory* comes

to their attention.

During the past year, the *Directory* has been used as a mailing list by several organizations selling vitamins, literature, jewelry, etc. We now ask, "Should the present policy of 'no commercial use' be followed?"

Another question arises. G.S.O. has received many requests from A.A.'s for information concerning the purchase of pins, emblems, key rings and other novelties. Also manufacturers of these items are frequently in touch with G.S.O., requesting use of the *World Directory* for their mailings.

G.S.O. keeps a list of such manufacturers' names to answer inquiries from members and Groups. But now we ask, "Should the announcement of the availability of tokens and novelties be considered an A.A. purpose or service?"

In 1957 the present policy for listing Groups was established and described on the *Directory* cover.

G.S.O. has been guided by that statement ever since. Groups are not screened, but listed as the information reaches the Records Department.

Recently the eligibility of some Groups to be listed has been questioned by their Areas. For example, one Group accepted funds from a source outside A.A. So we ask:

1. Do you wish to reaffirm the present policy on listings?
2. If the policy, or the Traditions, are not being observed by a Group, please advise G.S.O. what action to take.

—Beth K., G.S.O. Staff.

Let's keep it wonderful

I look forward eagerly each year to my copy of the *World Directory* and spend a pleasant evening looking through it, marveling at A.A. growth the world over, smiling or frowning at certain Groups' contributions to G.S.O., and always awed by the vast coverage of our program.

These things are all nice, and in a sense this is putting the *Directory* to use, but let's see just why the *Directory* is given to us. On the first page is a paragraph telling us, "The *World Directory* is a permanent source of information for the Group as a whole, with each succeeding G.S.R. or Secretary acting as a temporary custodian."

A very definite implication of responsibility is present. If it's a source of information, that information must be accurate. This places the responsibility on the Secretary or G.S.R. or somebody to see that the necessary data reaches G.S.O. on time. He must be conscientious. His responsibility is not so much to his Group as it is to every A.A. in the world.

When we look at the thousands of Groups listed, it rarely occurs to us that some Groups may possibly not be quite as qual-

ified to receive this service as others. Heaven forbid that any of us should actually sit in judgment. Nevertheless there is good reason for the paragraph on the cover.

Just as there is one requirement for A.A. membership, it is also necessary for Groups to meet a few requirements. Do all Groups meet them? Does this Conference feel any concern about possible irregularities? Perhaps the policy statement could be included in a letter accompanying each Group Registration card, to serve as a reminder of the responsibility each Group bears in this matter.

I urge this Conference to reaffirm the Traditional requirements for Group listings, and to impress upon G.S.R.'s and Secretaries the importance of accuracy in filling out registration cards. I know of no other facility given to us in A.A. that requires the cooperation and feeling of "I am Responsible" by more individuals.

We have something pretty wonderful. Let each of us do his part to keep it that way.

—Jack M., West Virginia.

'More precious than profit...'

Any member of A.A. can go to any jewelry store and describe the emblem or design he has in mind and get it. Use of the *Directory* for such a purpose would not serve any need that a member cannot handle himself.

Misinformation or frustrated authors could use it to distribute literature not approved by the Conference or Trustees.

One of the prime motivating factors in my sobriety was that nobody tried to cram anything down my throat or promote me in any way.

I feel we should not allow the *Directory* to fall into the hands of people who desire to promote their own products, material or literary.

The primary purpose of the *Directory* is to assist the traveling alcoholic to retain his sobriety, something far more dear and precious than any profit from the sale of any type of goods, to any individual, anywhere, at any time.

—Raymond F., Nevada.

'For unity and enlightenment'

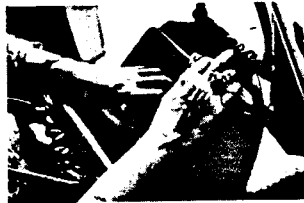
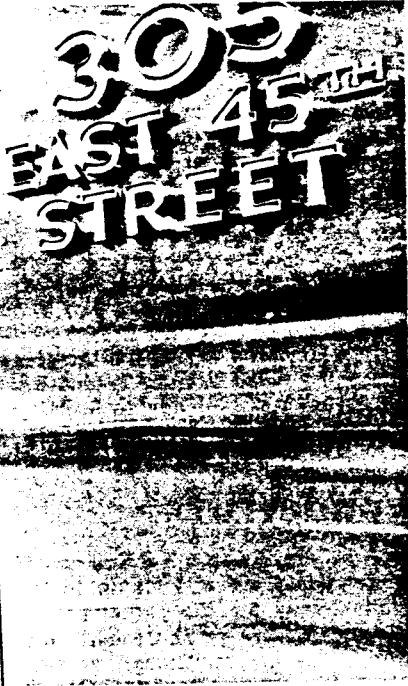
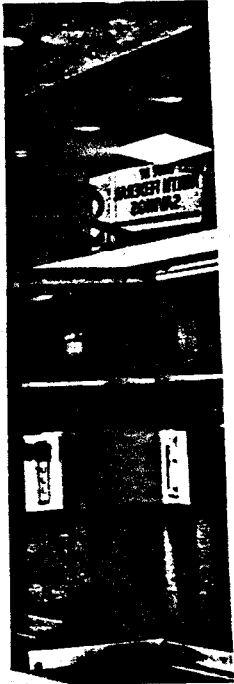
The *World Directory* is a vital service to each Group — a means of communication between the Groups, and an aid to unification in the over-all picture of A.A.

The *Directory* gives information which is definitely confidential, and should not be made publicly available.

I believe the present policy should be kept. First, there is danger of information being falsified or exaggerated to someone's personal advantage. Second, there is danger of information being used for the solicitation of funds, or for sale of "gimmicks" in the name of A.A.

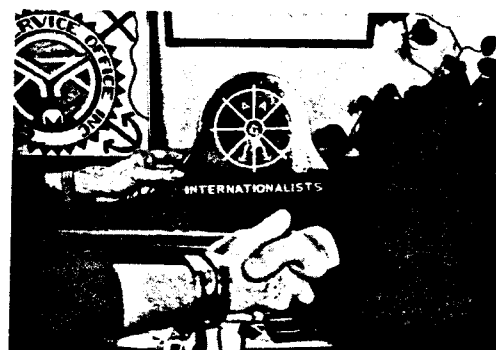
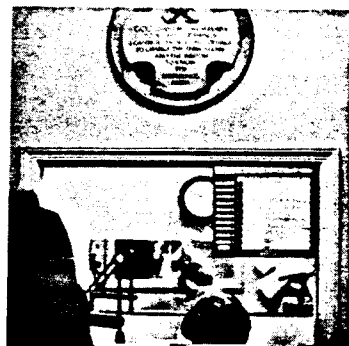
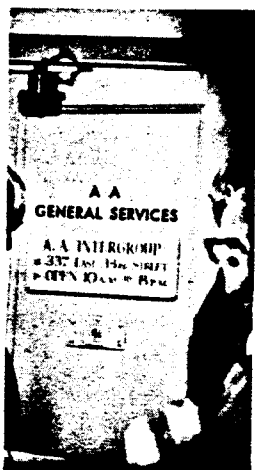
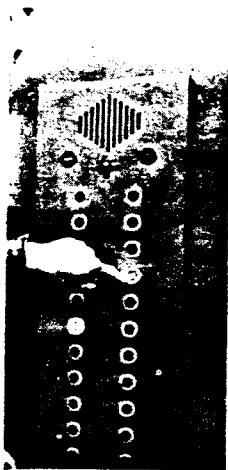
—Ralph S., Utah.

The Hands of



A. A.

An informal, pictorial,
anonymous record of the
1966 Conference



These pictures—and those on Pages 65-66—were all made during the 1966 meeting of the General Service Conference of A.A. by Anne F. No faces of A.A. members are shown; the only recognizable people are nonalcoholics.

Following the order of the pictures, you go into G.S.O., tour the office, meet the Staff, and register. Then you see the Terrace Room of the Hotel Roosevelt, New York City, where Conference members met April 18-23, 1966.

Boy, did I get fooled!

Last year I came here full of fears. It was one of the most rewarding spiritual experiences I have ever had. This year I thought, "Now, I am a veteran; I know what will happen."

Boy, did I get fooled! The first session I saw on the Agenda I was supposed to be up here today. I knew nothing about it. Hazel said, "Sorry there was a mix-up. Can't you just ad lib?"

At the opening dinner I saw a man with a brown envelope. He opened it, and that was my first glimpse of this year's *Directory*. Beautiful! I love the shape of it.

When I looked up my home Group, there was the right contribution listed — but after the name of the Group it says, "in-

active." Back home I will have a little explaining to do.

Anyway, I realize what a terrific job it is to compile this — especially when some of us don't send information until six months too late. G.S.O. is doing a terrific job here, which we all appreciate.

I have friends all over the world. I may never see them, but I know wherever I go I won't be alone as long as I have the *Directory* with me. Last year I enjoyed just looking at the Delegates' names and remembering them and the contributions they made to the Conference.

—Harold H., Ohio.

Interview Time

Is a better record of Groups possible?

Suggestions on how we can get a more accurate and complete *World Directory*, a better mailing list for G.S.O. mail to Groups, and a better return of Group Information Cards were made by Delegates during Interview Time. Here are some of their ideas:

1. Delegates should personally see each Group card is accurately completed and promptly returned.
2. G.S.R.'s should personally handle it.
3. Area G.S. Committee Members should personally see to it.
4. Area G.S. Committee should handle this.
5. Personally calling G.S.R.
6. G.S.O. use a stamped, self-addressed return envelope.

7. Some Areas have Secretary of Area G.S. Committee handle Cards. In some Areas, G.S.R.'s and Committee Members work together.

Note: By Conference action, G.S.O. mail now goes to G.S.R.

ASK-IT BASKET

Q. How should you dispose of old *World Directories*?

A. File them, as part of a Group record of history, or destroy them.

Closing Session

Last Session Perked Up By Lively Speakers

When our two new Canadian Trustees (Tom B., Manitoba, and Dr. Travis Dancey, Montreal), our own beloved "Dr. Jack" Norris and Bill himself stirred us with their words at the closing brunch of the 16th Conference, most of us forgot fatigue.

The joy of A.A.'s spirit at work didn't just crowd out memories of drudgery, but reminded us how worthwhile it all is. Here are excerpts from their closing remarks:

'Responsible for what I am free to do . . .'

One of the fellowship, president of a company with about 500 employees, was talking about some of his experiences. He has a three-step program. First, a warning and a talk by the boss; second, a little discipline; and third, lower the boom.

With one of his employees he had taken step one and it hadn't worked; step two hadn't worked, and he was creeping up to step three — when this particular fellow had a baby and made the boss the baby's Godfather!

This is one of the things you do to us that are trying to help you. You folks are past masters of manipulation. You con us all over the place. Some of us get a little mad about it. Can you blame us?

One thing has impressed me about our Staff at G.S.O. We all love them, we all depend on them, but one thing hasn't been said. It has importance, particularly for those of us who have the privilege of being "trusted servants." Keep this in mind: Herb is a busy guy, and yet he is still doing Twelfth Step work on an individual basis. The gals in the office are doing it, too.

When I work with people like you, they frequently come in and say, "Doctor, I am free."

Those of us who stop at that point usually lose the freedom. The next step is to come back to Carl Becker's law: "Since I am free to do as I please, I am responsible for that which I am

pleased to do."

If we don't take that responsibility, if we don't learn how to live by the Toronto Declaration, we can lose our freedom.

Make A.A. attractive. Attractive in the way we individuals live it. Attractive in the way Groups — of which we are a part — meet new people. It seems to me that we have to try to see where A.A. is not being attractive.

It is gratifying to me to hear how often professionals in the field of alcoholism point out the dependence we all have on A.A. It has given us hope, rather than complete hopelessness.

The best way I can think of to change the helping professions in our communities is for those of you fortunate enough to have recovered through A.A. to go as individuals to the doctor who struggled with you and say, "Here I am. I'm the guy who didn't give you an accurate history. Who told you all I drank is two beers, who didn't follow instructions. I'm in A.A. and this is what A.A. is like." Invite him to a meeting, or several meetings with you so that the picture he gets of A.A. is the most attractive one can get. Do it also with your clergymen.

Just as a last note, may I again say how rewarding it has been for me personally and for Mrs. Norris to be accepted so wholeheartedly into the Fellowship? Thank you.

—John L. Norris, M.D., Chairman, G.S. Board.

'If we share enough . . . care enough . . .'

A.A. is one area of life where regional, international, and political boundaries do not exist. I never feel like a "Trustee from Canada"; I just feel like another member of A.A. For this our regions, areas, provinces, districts, Groups, cliques, and bunches thank you from the bottom of our hearts.

I am indeed a lucky human being, not just to be free from the necessity to drink — but to be allowed the most priceless privilege granted to those of us in A.A. I mean the privilege of service. There is no greater gift any God can give anybody, than the privilege of service to one another and to the God that brought this about.

One of the great things in my life is our ability to identify one with another. Bill calls it, "the language of the heart." I came to Alcoholics Anonymous not in too good health. But when I came to it I did not have to identify with who you were, where you have been or what you had lost or not lost. The man I called on — or happened to fall into, which is more the truth — when I ran out of time, had very little in common with me. But everybody I had talked to previously had given me long talks on backbone, will-power, standing up and being a man, turning over a new leaf, pulling up my socks — and sin and salvation, which I was an authority on. But there wasn't any communication.

This chap, who I knew had joined something called Alcoholics Anonymous, was tending bar at a party on New Year's, which seemed to be logical, but he wasn't drinking and he had a smile on his face. He poured me a drink. I said, "Bernie, I want to talk with you. How do you quit drinking? I can't quit drinking."

Everyone I had ever asked that question — and I had asked a great many — had always given me, "Well, now!" Then they give you that look, with the chin on the navel.

But Bernie turned around and grinned at me! I said, "Damn it all, this is serious!" Of course I know now why he was grinning, don't you? He was surrounded by booze, it was New Year's Day and everybody was half or all full and out of the woodwork comes a Twelfth Step call and I wondered why he was grinning

and you have been smiling and grinning at me ever since, and thank you.

The thing that made me feel I belong with you was that beautiful humor I have been listening to all week.

I think this is one of the great gifts of Almighty God, the medium that He has allowed you and me to have for communication with one another. Let's not ever get so blown up with our own importance, our own genius, our own piety that we forget to smile at one another.

It has been my experience in A.A. that the people who stumble and fall are the people who forget our one primary purpose, to carry the message. I am firmly convinced that A.A. has always been, is now and I hope will always be one drunk talking to another in the process of sharing our experience, strength and hope with each other — and love.

And everything else in this Society is there for one purpose — to allow all of us to do this one job just a little bit better.

Two words have come to mean much to me in A.A. One is in the Third Step. "Turn our will and lives over to the *care* of God, as we understand Him." The word *caring* is warm and wonderful, but when I first read it I didn't pay much attention. I thought it meant over to the *authority* of, over to the *domination* of something. But it doesn't say that. It says, "over to the *care* of God . . ."

The other word is in our Preamble, where it says "we are a fellowship of men and women who share . . ." The two words *caring* and *sharing* have taken a great meaning in my life because I firmly believe that I am an individual drunk who doesn't have to drink any more if I continue to *care* enough and *share* enough.

I am fully convinced in my own individual A.A. life, my Group, my Area, and my Fellowship, that I no longer ever have to fear change — so long as I never forget that there is but one ultimate authority — a God who *cares* and *shares* enough — Almighty God, the Father of Life.

—Tom B., Manitoba, Class B Trustee.

'As a psychiatrist, I was a little scared . . .'

I "broke my anonymity" when I left Montreal. (Ed. note: Dr. Dancy is a nonalcoholic Trustee.) I was coming through the U.S. Immigration, and this man in uniform asked me, "What are you going to do?"

I have answered this question many times. I say, "Medical meeting." But this time I said, "Alcoholics Anonymous meeting" — it just came out like that. He said "Good for you," stamped the thing and passed me through!

Why they put me at the last part of this program, I don't know. You people are masters at rationalizing, at taking various aspects of any given problem, picking out the one you want, and using it.

A psychiatrist is a little different. He *reasons*, you know. So I sat down. I wasn't going to rationalize, I reasoned.

I thought about Abu Ben Adam. You know, they put his name last, and he wondered why. "Well," they said, "you haven't done much for your fellow men." So he went out and worked harder and his name was at the top. I suppose you want me to work harder.

In a hospital I met a man called Dave. He was a very fine man when he was not drinking, which wasn't very often. We had wonderful talks and I was going to cure him of this thing because it didn't make any sense that a young man like this should drink so much.

I was invited in January, 1946, to go to a meeting by this

very sameman.

I was absolutely astounded. Here was this wicked, evil fellow that I had looked after, leading this meeting. He was talking about spiritual values. So were others, and I have never gotten over that.

It impinged upon me with a force that will live with me as long as I live. Dave has been one of my closest friends ever since, and he indoctrinated me with the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous.

As a Class A Trustee I was among an amazing group of people. You frightened me. Because, you know, as a psychiatrist, I am accustomed to hostility and all this warm friendship you tossed at me made me feel like a visiting pontiff without any good references.

If a stranger had gone into any of the Toronto big meetings he would have sworn all of you people were inebriated. You acted that way, but this wasn't alcohol, this was understanding and affection.

In closing, I would like to quote a verse from the Bible, which I hope is relatively accurate . . . distorted a little bit I think for our purpose, "God give his angels charge over you that in their hands they bear you up lest at any time you dash your foot against a stone."

—Travis Dancy, M.D., Montreal,
Class A Trustee.

A decision for humility

This is one of the most moving hours of my entire A.A. life. We have passed through another great hour of decision, a decision that I doubt we shall ever have to take again in these dimensions.

On behalf of A.A.'s everywhere, I thank God.

I began to ponder our history respecting decisions, and a series of yesterdays came before my eyes.

In Dr. Bob's case, there was a decision, after immense anguish, to "turn our will and our lives over to the care of God as we understand him." That decision held for us a view of the gateway to a new life of freedom under God.

But then we found we would have to make *collective* decisions, as distinguished from *individual* decisions. And we had not gone very far before, being human, we doubted our ability, even under God's Grace, to do this . . .

Well, these collective decisions were made, but not because we laid hold of lofty principles or virtues. They were taken out of the school of very hard knocks. Awful news began to come over the desks of that little office, of the brawls, of the dissension. We thought we had had a benign anarchy, but this really began to look malign. When we tried to unify and function, could we erstwhile deformed people stand it?

So the Traditions began to take shape, based on suffering, anguish and grief of every description . . .

We had in 1938 set up a board of our friends, an independent one, a sort of guardianship of A.A. as a whole. It was to see

that A.A. had over-all service, but we weren't satisfied with a Board just of ourselves. We knew that we would require voluntary contributions under the Traditions to support these world services. What drunk in his right mind would send any dough to a bunch of drunks in New York?

Then came the idea of a Conference. Why should anybody suppose that if you elected a body of delegates and sat our trustees down in the midst of them, there would not be an explosion? This posed to us, collectively, a tremendous challenge to responsibility.

But the collective decision in favor of the Conference was risky and it has worked out more wonderfully than we could have dreamed . . .

Our nonalcoholic trustees are now here, as they always were in fact, as our associates. They are not our guardians, and very truly A.A. can now say, not only man to man, but from top to bottom "We are responsible."

And who do you suppose God appointed to really frame a readiness for this latest collective decision of ours? Not us of A.A., but our friends in the majority on the Board said "yes, the time is here. It is better to try to be responsible than to say, 'we dare not.'" For Dr. Jack and the nonalcoholic majority of the Board, this was a decision for humility . . .

Our great decision as to the final shape of the functional structure of this Society has now been taken.

—Bill W.



Trustees, A.A.W.S. Directors, G.S.O. & Grapevine Staffs

Bill Wilson — Co-founder

G.S.B. TRUSTEES

NONALCOHOLIC

- Dr. John L. Norris (Chairman)
Associate Medical Director
Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, New York
- Dr. Travis E. Dancey
4015 Wilson Avenue
Montreal 28, Quebec, Canada
- Dr. Vincent Dole
Rockefeller Inst.
67th St. & York Ave.
New York, New York
- Leonard V. Harrison (Trustee Emeritus)
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Old Lyme, Connecticut
- Austin H. McCormick
Osborne Association
114 East 30th Street
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- Robert W. P. Morse
Cove Road
Oyster Bay, L.I., N.Y.
- Hon. John Murtagh
Administrative Judge
Criminal Court of the City of New York
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New York, New York 10013
- Archibald B. Roosevelt (Treasurer)
Roosevelt & Cross
40 Wall Street
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- R. Fay Brown
118 Ave. B. West
Bismarck, N.D.
- Eugene S. Kelley c/o Patricia Kelley
565 Fulton Avenue
Hempstead, L.I., N.Y.
- Charles E. Lalanne, Secretary
420 Lexington Avenue
New York, New York
- D. Bruce Mansfield
Ohio Edison Company
47 North Main Street
Akron 8, Ohio
- Jim Masterson
2525 Landwood Way
Carmichael, California
- Frank Russell
159 Wentworth
Lowell, Mass.
- Murray Whitsett (2nd Vice-Chairman)
67 Sylvan Road
Norwalk, Connecticut

A.A. GRAPEVINE DIRECTORS

- Thomas White, Editor
Charles E. LaLanne, Jr. (Chairman)
Lee Beckwith
Rev. Yvelin Gardner
Jay Jacobs
Barry Leach
Austin H. McCormick
Ruth Weir (Treasurer)
Paula Carpenter (Secretary)

A.A. WORLD SERVICES DIRECTORS

- Herb Morse (Chairman)
Eugene Kelley (1st Vice-Chairman)
Midge McFadden (2nd Vice-Chairman)
Murray Whitsett (Treasurer)
Robert Hitchins
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Fred Waters
Hazel Rice (Secretary)

GRAPEVINE STAFF

- Lee Beckwith
Paula Carpenter

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE STAFF

- Herb Morse
Cora Louise Belford
Beth Kuhlmann
Ann Macfarlane
Eve Marsh
Midge McFadden
Waneta New
Hazel Rice

OTHERS ATTENDING CONFERENCE

G.S.O. DEPT. HEADS

- Al Cryan
Rose Failla
Kleina Jones
Dennis Manders
Nell Wing

CONSULTANTS

- Barry Leach
(Public Information)
Wilbur A. Smith
(Ind. C.P.A.)

A.A. GRAPEVINE

- Jack Morley
(Art Director)

Two Observers from: Public Information Committee
Two Observers from: International Committee
Two Observers from: Grapevine Editorial Board

*Members of Conference other than Area Delegates

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

APRIL 1966

Nonalcoholic Trustees (Class A)

John L. Norris, M.D. ... is Chairman of the General Service Board and the Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January, 1951. "Dr. Jack" is Associate Medical Director of the Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, New York. . . Chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism. . . President of the Industrial Medicine Association. As his record in and out of A.A. suggests, he has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics.

Travis Eugene Dancey, M.D. ... Elected to the Board in January 1965. Dr. Dancey is Chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital and Senior Psychiatrist at Montreal General Hospital. He has been a good friend of the fellowship since the formation of the first A.A. Group in Quebec. Now he will be the first Class A Trustee to come from Canada to serve regularly.

Vincent P. Dole, M.D. ... Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1965. He is a Professor & Senior Physician at the Rockefeller Institute Hospital. Dr. Dole developed method used in the treatment of narcotic addiction; he is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves as co-Chairman of the International Committee, a subcommittee of the General Services Board's Policy Committee.

Austin H. MacCormick ... Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October, 1949 to April, 1951. He left in 1951 to become a Professor of Criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as Executive Director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a Director of the A.A. Grapevine and a member of the Editorial Board.

Robert W. P. Morse ... Elected to the General Service Board in July 1965. He is Executive Vice President & Treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of Brooklyn. Born in Nova Scotia, Canada he became a U.S. citizen in 1921. During World War II he served as a Finance Officer in the U.S. Army in the Chinese Theatre Area. He is a director of the Mutual Savings Bank Fund & married and the father of three children.

John M. Murtagh ... Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963, is the Administrative Judge of the Criminal Court of New York, a new court with 78 judges replacing Magistrates' Courts and Court of Special Sessions. Previously, he had been Chief Justice of the Court of Special Sessions, Chief City Magistrate, and Commissioner of Investigation of New York. He is married and the father of four children. The Judge has long been a good friend of A.A. and comes to the Board with a sure understanding of the alcoholism illness.

Archibald B. Roosevelt (Treasurer of the General Service Board and the Chairman of the Board's Finance & Budgetary Committee) ... was elected to the General Service Board in January, 1953. He is a partner in the investment firm of Roosevelt and Cross, Inc., and is well known for his interest in philanthropic affairs.

Bernard B. Smith ... is 1st Vice-Chairman of the General Service Board — was elected to the Board in June, 1944 and has been very active, serving as Chairman of the General Service Board and General Service Conference from January, 1951 to April, 1956. He is an attorney and author and has made an outstanding contribution in the cause of Anglo-American understanding. In October, 1957 he received a decoration, Honorary Commander of the Order of the British Empire from the hands of Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth II, on her visit to the United States.

Harrison M. Trice, Ph. D. ... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1957 and has served there, and as a member of the Literature Committee, with great enthusiasm. He is an Associate Professor in the School of Industrial Labor Relations at Cornell University. He has been a frequent contributor to professional journals, and a consultant to various study groups and to private companies on the subject of alcoholism.

Leonard V. Harrison (Emeritus) first came on the Board in 1941 and, with the exception of his resignation from October, 1950 to January, 1953, has been continually active in A.A. affairs. He served as chairman of the General Service Board from April, 1956 to April, 1961. For many years he served as Director of Public Affairs of the Community Service Society in New York City, but is now retired and living in Old Lyme, Connecticut.

A.A. Trustees (Class B)

Tom Breen ... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1965. He was nominated by the A.A. Groups in Manitoba, Canada. Has had 10 years of sobriety. He is a Counselor & Public Relations Representative on the Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba.

R. Fay Brown ... was elected as Trustee to the General Service Board from the West Central Region in April, 1965. He was the first Delegate to serve the General Service Conference from North Dakota, 1952-1953. An active member of the Bismarck-Mandan Group with continuous sobriety since 1948. Currently serving in the North Dakota State Legislature.

Eugene S. Kelley ... (2nd Vice-Chairman of the General Service Board)—was elected in April 1963. Had served as Director of

A.A. World Services, Inc., since April, 1960. He has served on the Finance Committee of the General Service Board for two years. Has been an active member of the Manhattan Group of New York City since March, 1942. He served as President of New York Intergroup Association Steering Committee from January, 1955 to June, 1956. He has cooperated with the Medical Director of a large corporation in the formation of a policy and plan for the rehabilitation of their alcoholic employees. In non-A.A. life, he has been employed in Industrial Sales — with the same company for 43 years.

Charles E. Lalanne, Jr. ... was elected to the General Service Board in July 1965. He is Chairman of the A.A. Grapevine, has had 10 years of sobriety. He was admitted to the New York State Bar in 1936 and has his own law firm.

D. Bruce Mansfield... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1964, following nomination at a Conference electoral session where he was Ohio's candidate for the East Central Region. He is presently President of Ohio Edison Company, Akron, Ohio, with which he became associated as General Counsel in 1948. He has been an active member of Ohio Groups since 1945; his current Group is the King School Group of Akron.

Jim Masterson... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963, following nomination at electoral session of the General Service Conference where he was California's candidate for the Pacific Region. Has had over 12 years of continuous sobriety. Continuous activity in Northern California Conference Committee, serving his area as Alternate Delegate and Delegate. Is an Executive with the Department of Motor Vehicles in Sacramento.

Frank E. Russell... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1965 as Trustee from the Northeast Region. He came to A.A. in 1954, in 1954 he helped form the Bridge Street Group of Lowell, Mass. and now the Nashoba Group of Chelmsford. From 1961 - 1962 he served as Delegate to the General Service Conference from Eastern Massachusetts.

Murray Whitsett... (Secretary of the General Service Board) was elected to the Board in April 1964 following two years of service as a Director of A.A. World Services, Inc. He is presently Chairman of the Public Information Committee and a member of the sub-committee of the Finance Committee to study pension programs. Murray has 14 years in A.A., is a member of the New Canaan, Conn. Group. He is a newspaper advertising executive.

Trustees' Committees

APRIL 1966

FINANCE & BUDGETARY

A.B. Roosevelt, Chairman
Robert W.P. Morse
R. Fay Brown
Eugene S. Kelley
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
D. Bruce Mansfield
Herbert A. Morse
Wilbur A. Smith, ex-officio
Cora Louise Belford, Secretary

Investment Committee

A.B. Roosevelt, Chairman
Graham Blaine
Thomas D. Flynn
Robert W.P. Morse
Chester A. Rude
William G. Wilson
Cora Louise Belford, Secretary

LITERATURE

Austin MacCormick, Chairman
Paula Carpenter
Yev Gardner
Tom Breen
Robert Hitchins
Jim Masterson
Bayard Pope
Ruth Weir
Tom White
Murray Whitsett
Waneta New, Secretary
Barry Leach, Consultant

NOMINATING

Eugene S. Kelley, Chairman
Tom Breen
Dr. Travis Dancey
Robert Hitchins
Barry Leach
Austin MacCormick
Jim Masterson
Herbert A. Morse
Frank Russell
Hazel Rice, Secretary

POLICY

Jim Masterson, Chairman
Tom Breen, Co-Chairman
R. Fay Brown
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
D. Bruce Mansfield
Herbert A. Morse
Hazel Rice
Frank Russell
Harrison Trice
Murray Whitsett
Midge McFadden, Secretary

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Murray Whitsett, Chairman
Lee Beckwith
Janet Graves
Robert Hitchins
Rex Moody
Herbert A. Morse
Bayard Pope
Ruth Weir
Barry Leach, Consultant
Beth Kuhlmann, Secretary

INTERNATIONAL

Niles Peebles, Chairman
Dr. Vincent P. Dole,
Co-Chairman
Allan Bachman
Adrian Frylink
Emma Gardner
Herbert A. Morse
Don Reynolds
Joseph Besch
Norman Crowley
Jean Reed
Paul Youngs
Ann Macfarlane, Secretary

(The International Committee is a subcommittee of the G.S.B. Policy Committee.)

Trustees' Meetings

The Board of Trustees will meet during the coming year on the following dates: July 25, October 31, 1966; January 30 and April 22, 1967.

U.K. Starts Own Conference

The first General Service Conference meeting for A.A.'s in the United Kingdom will convene at Manchester, England, Oct. 29-30, 1966. Delegates will attend from North Ireland, England, Wales, Scotland, and the Republic of Ireland.

1966 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA & N. W. FLORIDA	(15) Jim Hawkins, 2505 22 Street Bes- semer, Alabama
ALASKA	(16) O.C. "Pav" Pavelin, Box 499, % R.C.A., Clear, Alaska
ARIZONA	(16) Paul Roberts, Star Route, Sedona, Arizona
ARKANSAS	(15) Hollis Akins, P.O. Box 222, Dumas, Arkansas.
CALIFORNIA	(15) Southern—*Jack Oney, 2007 Argyle, Hollywood, California
	(15) Northern Coastal — Ed Hartsock, P.O. Box 463, Pittsburg, California
	(16) Northern Interior—Ken Kott, Route #2, Box 2025, Loomis, California
	(16) San Diego — Rosa Burwell, 4193 Georgia, San Diego, California
	(16) Southern Coastal — Joe Kirk, 38- 132 Charlesworth Way, Cathedral City, California
COLORADO	(15) Jack Mohr, 755 Holly Street, Den- ver, Colorado
CONNECTICUT	(15) Mrs. Cora "Tommy" Dayton, 39 Williams Road, Cheshire, Conn.
DELAWARE	(16) Grover Surratt, P.O. Box 387, New- ark, Delaware
D.C.	(15) Hal Potter, 10207 Calumet Drive, Silver Springs, Maryland
FLORIDA	(15) Northern — Bert Lynch, 1204 East SilverSprings Blvd., Ocala, Florida
	(15) Southern — Walter Thompson, 2848 Northwest Tenth Avenue, Fort Lauderdale, Florida
GEORGIA	(16) Virgil Warren, 624 Clairmont Circle, Decatur, Georgia
HAWAII	(15) Butch Cline, 47-339 Luloni Street, Kaneohe, Hawaii
IDAHO	(16) Wilford Wilcock, 296 Hill Street, Idaho Falls, Idaho
ILLINOIS	(15) Chicago — James T. Griffin Jr., 1569 N. Green Bay Road, Lake Forest, Illinois
	(16) Northern — R. A. "Bud" Welch, 4005 38 Street, Rock Island, Ill.
	(15) Southern — Wes James, 1608 Whit- tier Avenue, Springfield, Illinois
INDIANA	(15) Northern — Ross Stanton, 1235 North Wells Street, Gary, Indiana
	(16) Southern — Robert Wagener, 4422 South Meridian Street, Indianapolis, Indiana

What Do Panel Numbers Mean? Delegates to each Confer-
ence are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered
and includes those elected to start serving in an even year.
The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to
start serving in an odd year. This 16th Conference is made
up of Panel 15 — the old Delegates — and Panel 16 —
the new Delegates.

STATE	PANEL
IOWA	(15) Thomas Pickens, 500 Polk Street, Des Moines, Iowa
KANSAS	(16) Henry J. Ellenberger, 1600 East Wilman Court, Emporia, Kansas
KENTUCKY	(16) Bernie Schutte, 1206 Larue Avenue, Louisville, Kentucky
LOUISIANA	(15) Maurice Reilly, Jr., 7726 Jeannette Street, New Orleans, Louisiana
MAINE	(16) Gordon Pierce, 69 Central Street, Gardiner, Maine
MARYLAND	(16) Ginny Donders, 4713 Mawani Road, Baltimore, Maryland
MASSACHUSETTS	(15) Eastern — Bill Coogan, 40 Court Street, Boston, Massachusetts
	(16) Western — Roger LaCharite, 22 Percy Street, Chicopee Falls, Massachusetts
MICHIGAN	(15) Southeast — Everett P. "Scotty" Sewell, 6852 Longworth, Waterford, Michigan
	(15) Central — Ralph McPherson, Box 162, Whitmore Lake, Michigan
	(16) Western — Clarence Knittel, 97 Elkenburg, South Haven, Michigan
MINNESOTA	(16) Northern — Arno Adams, 439 8th Avenue, Waite Park, Minnesota
	(15) Southern — Robert Daly, 515 4th Avenue, S.W., Rochester, Minnesota
MISSISSIPPI	(16) Tyson Lassiter, Box 973, Corinth, Mississippi
MISSOURI	(15) Eastern — Jim Barber, 4220 Sweet Gum Drive, St. Louis, Missouri
	(15) Western — Keet Rader, West High- way #76, Branson, Missouri
MONTANA	(16) Earl Poirier, P.O. Box 615, Shelby, Montana
NEBRASKA	(16) Kerry Leggett, 305 So. 16th Street, Ord, Nebraska
NEVADA	(15) Ray Free, 150 North Center Street, Reno, Nevada
NEW HAMPSHIRE	(16) George Jordan, Cedar Point, Dur- ham, New Hampshire

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
NEW JERSEY	(15) Northern — George Dvorak, 371 Pine Avenue, Manasquan, New Jersey		(15) Southeast — Jerry Wilson, P.O. Box 66416, Houston, Texas
	(16) Southern — Paul Hutchins, 7 Shepherd Road, Haddonfield, New Jersey	UTAH	(16) Southwest — Phillip Schraub, 4302 Ocean Drive, Corpus Christi, Texas
NEW MEXICO	(16) Robert Flynn, 206 South Tin, Deming, New Mexico	VERMONT	(15) Ralph Searle, 3601 Monroe Blvd. Ogden, Utah
NEW YORK	(15) Central — Sheldon Bradshaw, 16 Hannum Avenue, Homer, New York		(16) Lee Barre, 168 Weaver Street, Winooski, Vermont
	(16) Mohawk-Hudson-Berkshire — Joe Curran, 17 Pleasant Avenue, Amsterdam, New York	VIRGINIA	(15) Earl Felton, 1223 Duke Street, Portsmouth, Virginia
	(15) Southeastern — Frank Chase, 1213 East 88 Street, Brooklyn 36, New York	WASHINGTON	(15) *Eric Bergman, 8435 47th South, Seattle 18, Washington
	(16) Western — Johnny Hutton, 628 25th Street, Niagara Falls, New York	WEST VIRGINIA	(15) Jack McCarthy, 1027 Ann Street, Parkersburg, West Virginia
NORTH CAROLINA	(15) Harry Barrett, 701 Museum Drive, Charlotte, North Carolina	WISCONSIN	(16) N. Wisconsin & Upper Michigan — Bert Chapman, P.O. Box 150, Medford, Wisconsin
NORTH DAKOTA	(16) Miss Milly Iverson, 708½ Main Avenue, Bismarck, North Dakota		(15) Southern — Clarence Topel, 8321 47th Avenue, Kenosha, Wisconsin
OHIO	(15) Central & S.E. — Harold Hayhurst, 291 Columbian Avenue, Columbus, Ohio	WYOMING	(16) Ben Butler, 816 McKeehan Avenue, Rock Springs, Wyoming
	(15) Northeast — Charles Gresser, 721 Fairlane Avenue, Canton 10, Ohio	PUERTO RICO	(16) Guillermo Campos, Calle 5, P 26, Urb. Sta. Monica, Bayamon, Puerto Rico
	(16) N.W. Ohio & S.E. Michigan — Elmer Larson, 106 So. Lynn Street, Bryan, Ohio		
	(16) South-Southwest Ohio & Northern Kentucky — Bill Johnston, 112 Wrenwood Lane, Terrace Park, Ohio	CANADA	
OKLAHOMA	(15) Mike Rainbolt, P. O. Box 248, Cordell, Oklahoma	ALBERTA	(16) Ted Knight, 414 15th Street, N.W., Calgary, Alberta, Canada
OREGON	(16) Edward Drozda, 7509 S.E. Reedway, Portland, Oregon	BRITISH COLUMBIA-YUKON	(15) Jan Armstrong, 1340 West 12 Avenue, Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada
PENNSYLVANIA	(15) Eastern — Mrs. Gail S. Jones, 27 Braxton Road, Rosemont, Penna.	MANITOBA	(16) J.E. "Jim" Philipps, P.O. Box 334, Boissevain, Manitoba, Canada
	(15) Western — Ray Murphy, 482 Jefferson Street, Meadville, Penna.	NEW BRUNSWICK & PRINCE EDWARD ISL.	(16) Russell Scott, P.O. Box 208, Sackville, New Brunswick, Canada
RHODE ISLAND	(16) Hiram A. Long, Box 235, Barrington, Rhode Island	NOVA SCOTIA — NEW-FOUNDLAND & LABRADOR	(15) Bob Pritchard, 51 Prince of Wales Street, St. John's, Newfoundland, Canada.
SOUTH CAROLINA	(16) H.B. "Squire" Jones, P.O. Box 193 Taylor, South Carolina	ONTARIO	(15) Eastern — Alf McGowan, 86 5th Street, Ottawa, Ont., Canada
SOUTH DAKOTA	(16) Marty Carlisle, 316 East Pipestone Avenue, Flandreau, South Dakota		(16) Western — Clare Grand, 8 Pavey Street, Chatham, Ont., Canada
TENNESSEE	(16) Ray Dunkin, 724 Teasel Drive, Kingsport, Tennessee		(15) N. Northwestern — Garfield Kyer, 4 Janmar Ct., Sudbury, Ont., Ca.
TEXAS	(15) Northeast — Morris McFarland, 416 South College, Tyler, Texas	QUEBEC	(16) English — Belle Holland, P.O. Box 65, Lac Carre', Co. Terrebonne, Quebec, Canada
	(16) Northwest — Joe Cleary, 1900 Holloway, Midland, Texas		(16) French — Telesphore Bouchard, 7624 Casgrain, Montreal, Quebec, Canada
		SASKATCHEWAN	(16) Ed Laurence, 90 Bailey Drive, Yorktown, Saskatchewan, Canada

* Alternate Delegate

ROSTER

1966 CONFERENCE COMMITTEES*

Agenda-Admissions

1. Arno Adams, N. Minn.
2. Russell Scott, N.B./P.E.I., Can.
3. Grover Surratt, Delaware
4. Bob Wagener, S. Indiana, *CHAIRMAN*
5. Virgil Warren, Georgia
6. Jim Barber, E. Mo.
7. Frank Chase, S.E. New York
8. Walter Thompson, So. Fla.
- *9. Jack Oney, So. Calif.
10. Wes James, So. Illinois
- Ex. Robert Roy, Que., Canada
- Ex. Claude Millsap, Alaska
- Ex. Donald Formo, N. Minn.
- Ex. Heflin Daniel, Georgia
- Secretary — Midge McFadden

Grapevine

1. Marty Carlisle, S. Dakota
2. Joe Cleary, N.W. Texas, *CHAIRMAN*
3. Joe Curran, (H.M.B.) New York
4. Bill Johnston, S.W. Ohio & No. Ky.
5. Wilford Wilcock, Idaho
6. George Dvorak, No. N.J.
7. Bob Pritchard, N.S. & Nfld. & Labr.
8. Ed Hartsock, N. Coastal, Calif.
9. Hollis Akins, Arkansas
- Ex. Bruce Wight, N. Illinois
- Ex. Ralph Gordon, N.W. Texas
- Ex. Ceth Mason, S. Carolina
- Ex. Jake Steinberg, S. Dakota
- Ex. Bob Zeugner, N. Wisconsin
- Secretary — Paula Carpenter

Policy

1. Ken Kott, N. Int. Calif.
2. Bert Chapman, N. Wisc. & Upp. Mich.
3. Ed Drozda, Oregon, *CHAIRMAN*
4. Tyson Lassiter, Miss.
5. Kerry Leggett, Nebraska
6. Gordon Pierce, Maine
- *7. Eric Bergman, Washington
8. Keet Rader, W. Missouri
9. Harry Barrett, N. Carolina
10. Mike Rainbolt, Oklahoma
11. Bert Lynch, N. Florida
- Ex. Martin Elgeti, Alberta, Canada
- Ex. Ed Laubenthal, W. Michigan
- Ex. David Thompson, Wyoming
- Ex. Ruth Day, S. New Jersey
- Ex. Kenneth Sanders, Maine
- Secretary — Ann MacFarlane

Conference Report and Charter

1. Lee Barre, Vermont
2. Henry Ellenberger, Kansas, *CHAIRMAN*
3. Earl Poirier, Montana
4. Paul Roberts, Arizona
5. Bud Welch, N. Illinois
6. Cora "Tommy" Dayton, Conn.
7. Tom Pickens, Iowa
8. Garfield Kyer, N.N.W., Ont., Canada
9. Ralph McPherson, Cent. Michigan
10. Alf McGowan, E. Ontario, Canada
- Ex. Gordon LaMont, N. Dakota
- Ex. Rickey Schreiber, N. Int. Calif.
- Ex. Cliff Morris, W. Ontario, Canada
- Ex. Frank Hogan, (H.M.B.) N.Y.
- Ex. George Schnatz, W. N.Y.
- Secretary — Nell Wing

Institutions

1. Ray Dunkin, Tenn.
2. Belle Holland, Que., Can.
3. Paul Hutchins, So., N.J. *CHAIRMAN*
4. Milly Iverson, N. Dakota
5. Jim Philipps, Man., Canada
6. Clarence Topel, S. Wisc.
7. Hal Potter, D.C.
8. Jerry Wilson, S.E. Texas
9. Ross Stanton, No. Indiana
- Ex. John Tkachuk, Sask., Canada
- Ex. Bill Burns, Quebec, Canada
- Ex. Darrel McCleskey, New Mexico
- Ex. Harold Stump, S.W. Ohio & N. Ky.
- Ex. Richard Boyce, Delaware
- Secretary — Cora Louise Belford

Public Information

1. Ginny Donders, Maryland, *CHAIRMAN*
2. Johnny Hutton, W. New York
3. Joe Kirk, S. Coastal Calif.
4. Elmer Larson, N.W. Ohio & S.E. Mich.
5. Hiram Long, Rhode Island
6. Jim Hawkins, Ala. & N.W. Fla.
7. Jan Armstrong, B.C. Canada
8. Morris McFarland, N.E. Texas
9. Harold Hayhurst, Cent. & S.E. Ohio
10. Bill Coogan, E. Massachusetts
- Ex. Bish Mathis, Mississippi
- Ex. Bob Clayton, N.B.—P.E.I.
- Ex. Ross Marr, Man., Canada
- Ex. Arnold Teeple, Idaho
- Ex. Milton Hause, Maryland
- Secretary — Beth Kuhlmann

Finance

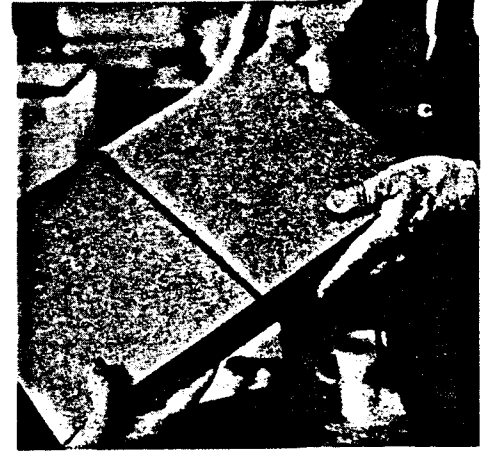
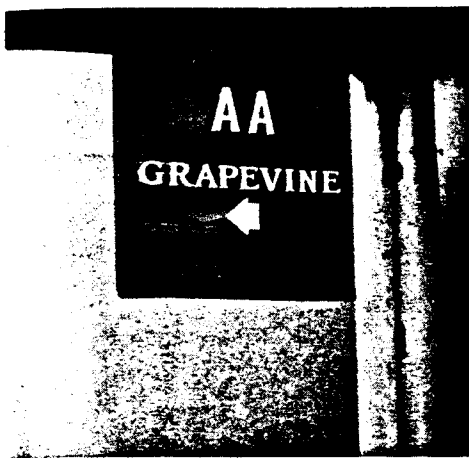
1. Robert Flynn, New Mexico
2. Clare Grand, W. Ont., Canada
3. Ted Knight, Alberta, Canada
4. Roger LaCharite, West. Mass., *CHM.*
5. O.C. "Pav" Pavelin, Alaska
6. Bob Daly, S. Minn.
7. Ralph Searle, Utah
8. Jim Griffin, (Chicago) Ill.
9. Sheldon Bradshaw, Cen. N.Y.
10. Jack McCarthy, W. Virginia
- Ex. Tom Allen, So. Coastal, Calif.
- Ex. Wayne Reed, Tenn.
- Ex. Hugh Alderson, Kentucky
- Ex. Judy Machler, Montana
- *Ex. Jack Kirk, New Hampshire
- Secretary — Cora Louise Belford

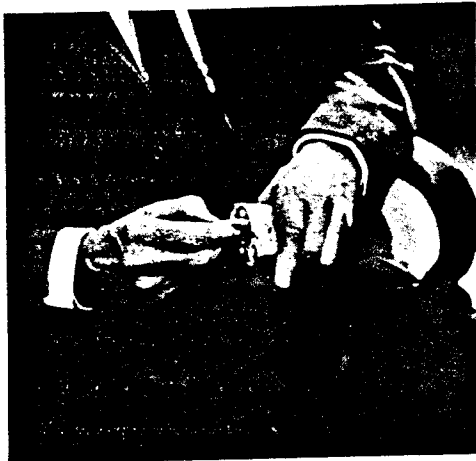
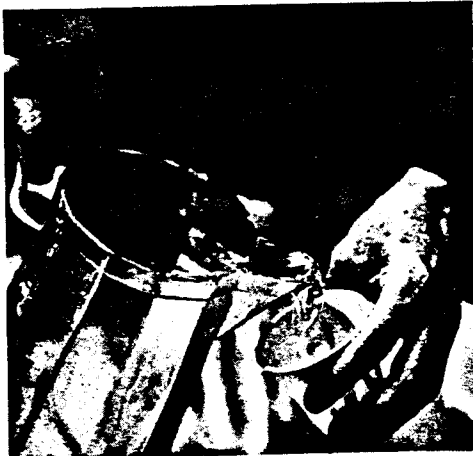
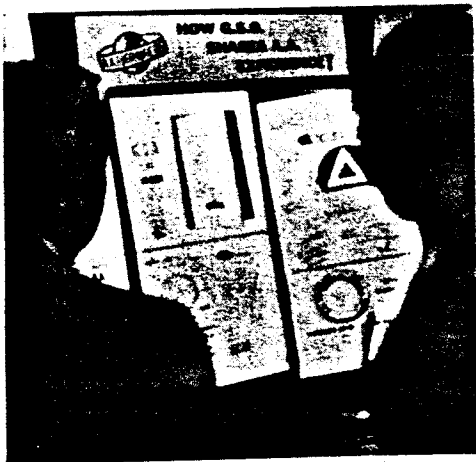
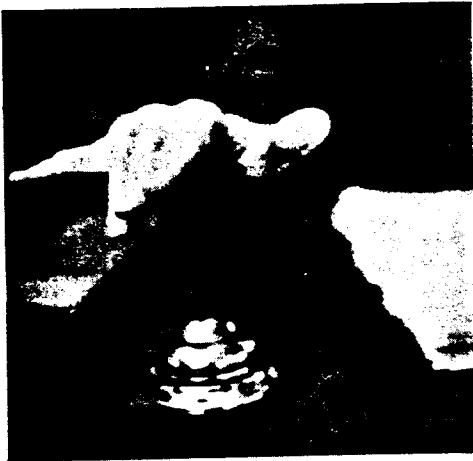
Literature

1. Rosa Burwell, San Diego, Calif.
2. Guillermo Campos, Puerto Rico
3. Clarence Knittel, W. Michigan
4. George Jordon, New Hampshire
5. Phillip Schraub, S.W. Texas, *CHM.*
6. Ray Free, Nevada
7. Scotty Sewell, S.E. Michigan
8. Gail S. Jones, E. Pennsylvania
9. Earl Felton, Va.
10. Ray Murphy, W. Pennsylvania
- Ex. Leo Rayburn, Arizona
- Ex. Tommy Thompson, S.W. Texas
- Ex. Ray Haneline, N.W. Ohio & S.E. Mich.
- Ex. Fred Watson, Rhode Island
- Secretary — Waneta New

Trustees

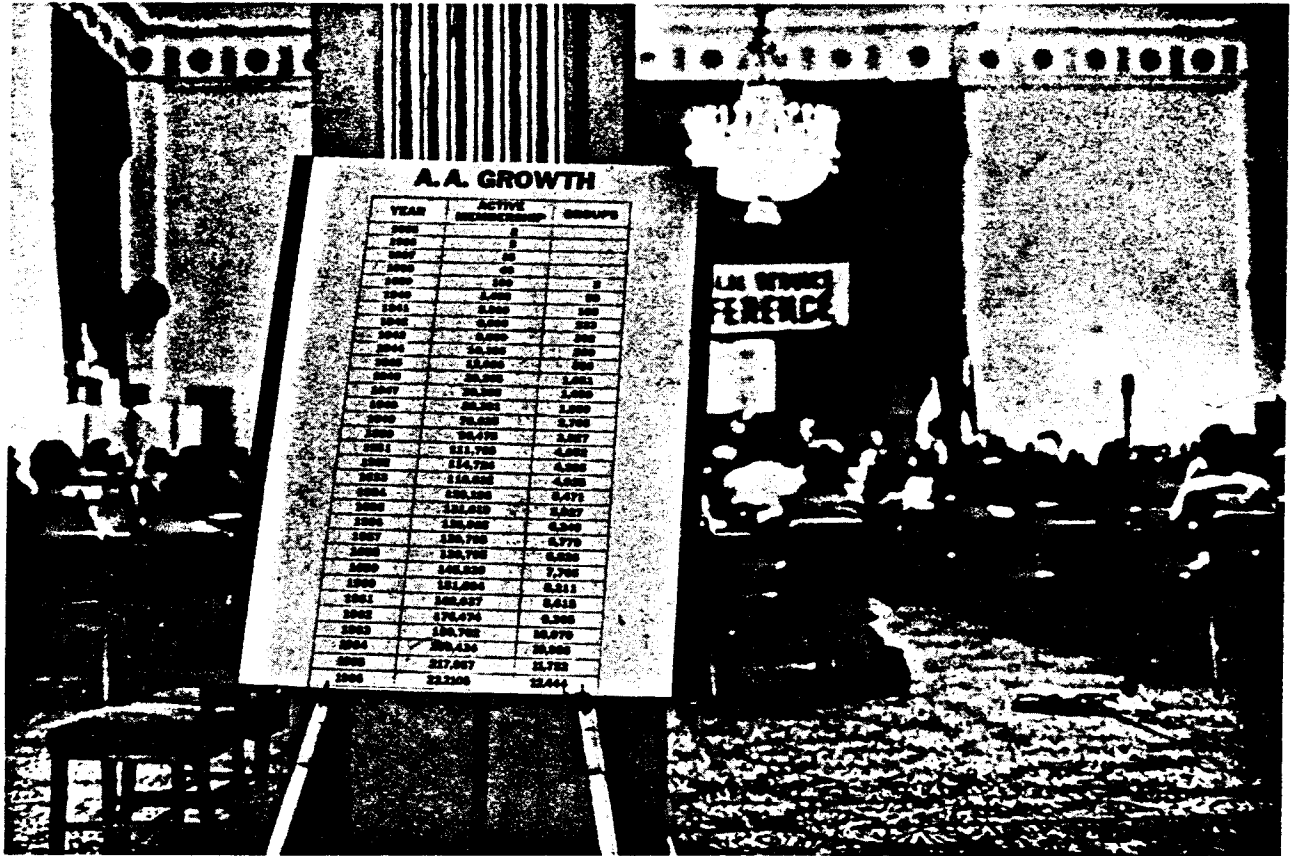
1. Ben Butler, Wyoming
2. Telesphore Bouchard, Que., Can.
3. H.B. (Squire) Jones, S. Carolina
4. Ed Laurence, Sask., Canada, *CHM.*
5. Bernie Schutte, Kentucky
6. Jack Mohr, Colorado
7. Charles Gresser, N.E. Ohio
8. Maurice Reilly, Louisiana
9. Butch Cline, Hawaii
- Ex. Leo Burns, W. Massachusetts
- Ex. Charlie Carballo, Puerto Rico
- Ex. Don Marquard, Nebraska
- Ex. Frank Surman, San Diego, Calif.
- Ex. Pete Dewey, Vermont
- Ex. F. Sharon Foster, Kansas
- Ex. Bill Griffith, Oregon
- Secretary — Hazel Rice







'Principles Before Personalities'



'I Am Responsible'

I am responsible...

When anyone, anywhere,
reaches out for help, I want
the hand of A.A. always to be there.
And for that: I am responsible.



The Twelfth Tradition...

Anonymity is the spiritual foundation
of all our Traditions, ever reminding us
to place principles before personalities.